



I.R.E NOTES

FORM ONE



SUMMARIZED TEACHING AND LEARNING NOTES FORM ONE



Form one

CHAPTER 1

QURAN

Read [Q: 36:2]; [Q: 85:21];[Q: 17:9]

Meaning of the Quran

The Quran is a religious book used by Muslims all over the world as a book of guidance. Most of the world religions have their specific books which they use for reference. Do you know any religious books used by members other faiths? Can you mention any of them? Just as every religion has its own religious book, Muslims have the Quran as their main source of reference and they have a duty to learn, understand and constantly refer to it. As a Muslim, have you read the Quran? Muslims believe that the Holy Quran is the last book to be revealed by Allah. It is because of its important position in the Islamic faith that throughout our course we shall be using the Quran as our immediate source of reference.

Can you remember the meaning of the word Quran from your Islamic Religious Education in Primary school?

This word comes from an Arabic root *qara'a* which means "to read or to recite." Quran in Arabic therefore literally means recitation or something that is continuously recited. It is equivalent in meaning to *qira'ah*, as both come from the same verb '*qara'a*.' This name is specifically mentioned in the text of the Quran as a reference to itself in several places. From the verses you have read, you will learn that the Quran has been referred as a book of guidance, a book full of wisdom and a Glorious. Read the following verses:

In Islam the word Quran is defined as the divine speech of Allah Subhanahu Wa Taala (S.W.T), sent down upon the last Prophet Muhammad Peace be Upon Him (P.B.U.H), through the Angel Jibril Aleihi Swalatu wa Salaam(A.S) to human kind. Since its revelation the Quran has remained the same without being distorted.



Other Names of the Quran

Do you know that the Quran is referred to with other different names? Mention some of these names. For the names you have mentioned, it can be seen that some of the names of the Quran have been referred to in the Quran itself while others are derived from the functions of the Quran. Among these names are:

- *Furqaan* (criterion) ***“Blessed is He Who sent down the Criterion to His servant, that it may be an admonition to all creatures.”*** [Q: 25: 1]
- *Nadhir* (warner) ***“Verily this Quran Doth guide to that which is most right (or stable), and giveth the Glad tidings to the believers who work deeds of righteousness, that they have a magnificent reward.”***[Q: 17:9]
- *Rahma* (mercy) ***“A guide and a Mercy to the doers of good”***[Q: 31:3]
- *Tanzil* (revelation) ***“Verily this is a Revelation from the Lord of the Worlds.”***[Q: 26: 192]
- *Dhikr* (reminder) ***“We have without doubt, send down the message; And We will assuredly guard it (from corruption)”***[Q: 15: 9]
- *Kitab* (The book) ***“We have revealed for you (O men) a Book in which is a message for you: will you not then understand.”***[Q : 21:10]
- *Hudan* (Guidance) ***“We gave Moses the book, and made it a Guide to the children of Israel, (commanding): “Take not other than Me as disposer of (your) affair.”***[Q:17: 2:5]

All these names reflect one of the various aspects of the revealed words of Allah. Other names include *Nur* (Light), *Majid* (Glorious), and *Mubarak* (Blessed) *Bashir* (Announcer), among others. Can you mention the other names of the Holy Quran that have not been listed above?

a) Ulumul Quran

The term *Ulum* means ‘a science.’ It refers to the detailed scientific study of a subject. If you look at the various subjects you are offered in Form one, you will notice that each of them has a different approach of studying it. These approaches are what we refer to as *Ulum* (the Science). The Quran, being a wide subject area of study also has its unique features that must be studied in a particular way. Therefore, *Ulumul Quran* is a scientific study that includes a variety of fields related to Al – Quran such as it’s:

- Revelation.
- Collection and compilation.
- Order and arrangement of suras.



- Translation of the Quran (tafsir).
- Reasons for the translation of the suras (Asbaabu Nnuzul)
- Characteristics of language
- Style of writing and theme
- Recitation (Tajweed) among other

We are going to look at one of the above areas in our next discussion.

Need for the revelation of the Quran.

In life everything has a reason and a purpose for its being, just as we have a purpose for coming to school. Why do you think the Quran was revealed to humankind? Revelation of the Quran came at a time when there was ignorance and the society was full of social vices, a period referred to as Jahiliya. Some of the reasons for revelation of the Quran are as follows:

- The earlier scriptures were tampered and interfered with by man thus losing their authenticity. Hence the revelation of the Quran was to correct the wrong message.
- The Quran was given to Prophet Muhammad, the seal of the prophet with a universal message unlike the other books which were sent to particular generations at specific time. For example The Torah (Taurat) was sent to the Children of Israel through Prophet Musa (A.S) while Zabur was sent to the followers of Prophet Daud. Read the following two verses from the Holy Quran:

Almighty Allah (S.W.T) Says: ***“To the Thamud people (We sent) Salih, one of their own brethren: He said: ‘O my people! Worship Allah; ye have no other god but Him. Now has come unto you a clear sign from your Lord! This is the camel of Allah is a sign unto you...”***
[Q: 7:73]

Almighty Allah (S.W.T) Says: ***“To the Ad people, (We send) Hud, one of their own brethren: He said: ‘O my people! Worship Allah! You have No other god but Him. Will you not fear (Allah)?”***[Q: 7:65]

- To fulfill Allah’s promise as well as prophesies of the other earlier revealed scriptures on the coming of the Quran and that of prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H).
Almighty Allah (S.W.T) Says: ***“And remember, Jesus, the son of Mary, said: ‘O children of Israel! I am the messenger of Allah (sent) to you confirming the law (which came) before***



me and giving Glad Tidings of a messenger to come after mewhose name shall be Ahmad. But when he came to them with clear signs, they said, 'This is evident sorcery.' [Q: 61:6]

- To narrate and summarize stories and events of the earlier generation in order to offer teachings, lessons, warnings and guidance to shape community.
Almighty Allah (S.W.T) Says: ***"There is in, their stories, instructions for men endued with understanding. It is not a tale invented, but a confirmation of what went before it - A detailed exposition of all things, and a guide and a mercy to any such as believe."*** [Q: 12: 111]
- Believe in One True God: The most important topic mentioned throughout the Quran is the belief in the One, True God. God informs us that He has no partner, no son, no equal, and that none has the right to be worshipped except Him alone. Nothing is comparable to God and none of His creation resembles Him. The Qur'an also rejects the notion of attributing human qualities and limitations to Allah (SWT).

Almighty Allah (S.W.T) says, ***"And your god is One God. There is no god but He, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful."*** [Q 2:163]

- Rejection All False Gods: Since Allah alone is the only One worthy of worship, false gods must be rejected. The Quran also rejects the notion of attributing divine qualities to anyone or anything other than Allah.
Almighty Allah (S.W.T) Says: ***"And worship Allah and associate none with Him..."*** [Q: 4:36]
- To remind us of the Day of Judgment: This Holy Quran reminds us that everyone will taste death and will be held accountable for all their actions and sayings:

Almighty Allah (S.W.T) says: ***"We shall set up scales of justice for the Day of Judgment, so that not a soul will be dealt with unjustly in the least..."*** [Q: 21:47]

- Fulfilling the Intended Way of Life: The purpose of life is to worship Allah alone, and live one's life according to the way of life prescribed by Allah. In Islam, worship is a comprehensive term that includes all actions and sayings (whether private or public) that Allah loves and is pleased with. Therefore, by doing what Allah commands, a Muslim is worshipping God and fulfilling his purpose in life.
Almighty Allah (S.W.T) says, ***"I have only created Jinns and men, that they may serve Me."*** [Q: 51:56]



REVELATION

Revelation is the divine communication of Allah (S.W.T) to his creatures. In this communication, Allah (S.W.T) either uses the Arch Angel Jibril or any by other methods which shall be studies in Form Two. An example of this communication is when Allah (S.W.T) revealed to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) the first five verses of Sura al-Alaqa through Angel Jibril. Refer to [Q: 96:1-5]

The above paragraph shows us that the Almighty Allah (S.W.T) communicates to his Prophets in the form of revelations. Allah (S.W.T) says in the Holy Quran that;

“It is not fitting for a man that Allah should speak to him except by inspiration, or from behind a veil, or by sending of a messenger to reveal, with Allah’s permission, what Allah will; for He is most High, Most Wise.” [Q: 42:51] From the verse we have read we see the Arch Angel Jibril acting as an intermediary between Allah (S.W.T) and the prophets as the bearer of the revelation. Angel Jibril undertook the following duties in the revelation of the Qur’an:

a) The role of Angel Jibril

1. He lowered the Quran from Lauhil Mahfudh (well preserved tablet), the seventh heaven to Baitul- Izza; the lowest heaven.
2. He lowered the Quran from Baitul-Izza to earth and revealed it in portions to the prophet throughout his 23 years of prophet hood.
3. He taught the prophet how to recite the Holy Quran correctly. He would
4. He assisted the prophet in the order and arrangement of the Quran. He used to appear before the prophet at the beginning of every month of Ramadhan and the prophet used to recite all the chapters while Jibril would guide him on the order and arrangement.
5. He played an intermediary role between the Almighty Allah to the prophet (P.B.U.H).
6. He assisted the prophet in memorizing the Quran during revelation; he would only leave after the prophet had grasped the verses.
7. Assisted the prophet in interpreting and understanding the Quran. He was the comforter of the prophet because revelation was a difficult experience. Aisha (R.A.) reported that *Al - Harith bin Hisham asked Allah Apostle (P.B.U.H) how the divine inspiration was revealed to Him. Allah’s Apostle replied; “sometimes it is revealed like the ringing of a bell, this form of inspiration (wahyi) is the hardest of all and then this state passes off after I have grasped what is inspired. Sometimes the Angel comes in the form of a man and talks to me and I grasp whatever he says.”*

What are the other duties that Angel Jibril played in the life of the prophet apart from revealing the Qur’an?



b) REASON WHY THE QURAN WAS REVEALED IN PORTIONS.

We have just learnt that Arch Angel Jibril lowered the Quran from Baitul-Izza and revealed it in portions. What do you think are the reasons why the Quran was revealed in portions? Let us consider the following points:

1. To address the prophet continuously in order to strengthen his heart.
Almighty Allah(S.W.T) says:

“You and those who disbelieve say “why is the Quran not revealed to him all at once?” but it is like that in order that we may steady your heart with it, and I have arranged its component parts in an orderly, consistent manner.”[Q: 25:3]

(It is) a Quran which we have divided (into parts from time to time) in order that you might recite it to men at intervals: We have revealed it by stages.”[Q: 17:106]

2. The process of revelation was a very difficult experience considering human ability and limitations; therefore it was revealed in portions to ease the task.
3. To provide room for spiritual growth and development for the prophet and his companions.
4. To progressively implement the sharia of Allah(S.W.T) that is providing continuous guidance.
5. To make it easy for the believers to understand and apply the rules of the Quran.
6. To make its memorization easier because the Arabs chiefly relied on memory to preserve information.

Allah says (S.W.T) ***“(These are) the ones who wait and watch about you, if you do gain a victory from Allah, they say: were we not with you? But if the unbelievers gain an advantage over you, and did we not guard you from the believers?” [Q: 4:141]***

7. Dealing with problems as they arise whenever a new happening emerges the Quran was there to provide the necessary solutions and answer. Example of this is when the Almighty Allah says(S.W.T):

“And they ask you about Dhul Qarnayn tell them I will read to you a report.”[Q: 18:83]

8. An indication of the true source of the Quran as it was revealed in a period of 23 years without any contradictions.

The Almighty Allah says (S.W.T): ***“Won’t they contemplate the Quran if it had come from other than Allah; they would have found in it many contradictions?” [Q: 4:82]***

SURAT UL FATIHA

Al-Fâtiḥa is the first sūrah (chapter) of the Quran, and was one of the earliest portions of the Quran revealed to the prophet Muḥammad by the angel Jibril. The word ‘Fatiha’ comes from the Arabic root verb ‘Fataha’ which means an *opening*, *beginning* or *commencement*. Therefore it is referred to as “Fatihat ul Kitab” (the opening chapter of the Book) or simply Surat ul Fatiha (The Opening Chapter). The idea of *opening* or *beginning* is significant in several ways: first, this is the opening verse of the Quran, secondly, this is said to be the first complete sūrah that was revealed to the Prophet, but more importantly this name also symbolizes the fact that the grace of Allāh has opened the doors of Life to us and that as we begin to live our lives in harmony with the ways of Allāh, the heart truly begins to open, thereby allowing us to begin to allow the Divine Presence of Allah(S.W.T) to consciously manifest openly through our daily lives, and thus, it is we that have been opened by His Power.

It is also called ‘sab al mathani’ .i.e. the seven ayahs as these are seven ayahs that no equivalent of them has ever been sent to the previous prophets before. It is called ‘Umm ul Kitab’ i.e. ‘the mother of the whole book’ because it encompasses the theme of recognition of Allah, belief in Him and worshipping Him only and genuinely.

Let us now look at the Arabic transliteration and meaning of its verses.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ ١

Bismillāhi r-raḥmāni r-raḥīm

1:1 In the name of Allah, Most Gracious, Most Merciful.

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ ٢

Al ḥamdu lillāhi rabbi l-‘ālamīn

The praiser and praise and thanks be to Allah 1:2 Sustainer of the worlds,

الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ ٣

Ar raḥmāni r-raḥīm

,Most Merciful ,Most gracious 1:3

مَلِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ

Māliki yawmi d-dīn

.Master of the day of Judgement 1:1

إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ

Iyyāka na'budu wa iyyāka nasta'in

worship you alone we 1:1 and You alone we ask for help.

اهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ

Ihdinā ṣ-ṣirāṭ al-mustaqīm

:guide us to the straight path 1:6

صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ غَيْرِ الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا

الضَّالِّينَ

Ṣirāṭ al-ladhīna an'amta 'alayhim ḡayril maḡdūbi 'alayhim walāḍ ḍāllīn

1:7 The path of those on whom you have bestowed your Grace, and not the path of those who earned your anger, nor of those who went astray.

Teachings of the surah

1. Allah is the most Gracious and most Merciful.
2. We should praise Allah for all the favors He has bestowed to us.
3. He is the controller and overall judge of everything during the Day of Judgment.
4. He is the only one worth of our devotion so all our prayers should be directed to Him.
5. Whoever needs any help should seek divine intervention of Allah.
6. Man should ask for Allah's guidance to the path of righteousness.
7. The path of righteousness is a favor from Allah(S.W.T).
8. Man should shun all evils to avoid the wrath of Allah. The worshipper is reminded not to transgress.
9. Mankind should follow the teachings of Allah (S.W.T) in order to avoid His anger.
10. The recognition of the oneness of Allah brings us closer to Allah and keeps us far from Iblis.

Importance of the sura

1. Sura tul Fatiha brings us closer to Allah through the words of praise contained in it.
2. It is a supplication (dua) that the prophet recommended to be used often.

3. It is the opening chapter of the Quran.
4. It's the foundation of faith.
5. It is the mother of the Quran.
6. It is one of the pillars of prayers.
7. It's one among the surahs that no other prophet was given except Muhammad only.

Surat Al-Fil (The Elephant) - سورة الفيل (Q 105)

Historical back ground to the revelation of Suratul Fiil.

Suratul Fiil derived its roots from the incident of the elephants during the period of the birth of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H).

The term Fiil refers to the elephants mentioned in the first verse of the Sura. These elephants were used in the army of Abraha Al Ashram who was governor of Yemen on behalf of the King of Ethiopia. He was sent to go and destroy the Al-Kaaba.

Abraha built a shrine at a place called Sanaa and had wanted the Arabs to perform Pilgrimage at the shrine instead of the Kaaba which they refused. He became furious and decided to send an army to go and destroy the Kaaba.

We shall now look at the meaning of its verses and their transliteration.

الرحيم الرحمن هلا ب سم

Bismillahi rrahmani rraheemi

In the name of Allah, the Beneficent, the Merciful.

أَلَمْ تَرَ كَيْفَ فَعَلَ رَبُّكَ بِأَصْحَابِ الْفِيلِ ۝١

Alam tara kaifa faala rabbuka bi as-haabil fiil

105:1 Have you (O Muhammad) not seen how your Lord dealt with the companions of the Elephant?

أَلَمْ يَجْعَلْ كَيْدَهُمْ فِي تَضْلِيلٍ ۝٢

Alam yaj'al Kaidahum fii tadhliil

105:2 Did He not make their treacherous plan into misguidance?

وَأَرْسَلَ عَلَيْهِمْ طَيْرًا أَبَابِيلَ ﴿٣﴾

Wa-arsala alaihim twairan abaabila.

105:3 And He sent against them birds in flocks,

تَرْمِيهِمْ بِحِجَارَةٍ مِّن سِجِّيلٍ ﴿٤﴾

Tarmihim bihijaa-ratin min sijiil

105:4 Striking them with stones of baked clay,

فَجَعَلَهُمْ كَعَصْفٍ مَّأْكُولٍ ﴿٥﴾

Fajaa'lahum ka'asfinm ma kulin

105:5 Then did He make them like an empty field of stalks and straw,
(of which the corn) has been eaten.

Teachings of Suratul Fiil

There are several lessons that can be learnt from this sura as follows;

- Al-Kaaba is protected by Allah.
- Allah is in position to destroy the plans of anybody who intends to harm others.
- Allah is very powerful and sees everything.
- No creature can fight the might of Allah
- Material possession of a man cannot defeat the Allah's property.
- Mankind should rely on Allah for anything because Allah protects.
- Allah does not allow evil to flourish.
- Allah gives protection to the righteous
- The wrong doers will always be punished by Allah.
- No one can prevail against Allah
- Allah has the ability to end a person's pride and arrogance.
- Allah wanted to honor the birth of the prophet (P.B.U.H).



Surat Al-`Asr (The Declining Day) - سورة العصر (Q 103)

Historical Background

The early Muslims called it Al-`Asr. Also, in most of the books dedicated to explaining the Quran (*tafsir*), this name is given to the *surah*.

The majority of scholars hold that it was sent in the Makkan Period at the early stages of Islam where the Muslim population was small. The surah consists three verses, making it the shortest chapter in the Quran but summarizes all the teachings of Islam because of its vast meaning. Imam Shafi commended that Suratul Asr would have sufficed all the other Surahs of the Quran if they had not been revealed.

We shall now look at the meaning of its verses and their transliteration.

بسم هلا الرحمن الرحيم *Bismillahi rrahmani rraheemi*

In the name of Allah, the Beneficent, the Merciful.

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وَالْعَصْرِ ①

WaalAasri

103: 1By Al-'Asr (the time).

إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لَفِي خُسْرٍ ②



Inna al-insana lafee khusrin

103: 2 Verily! Man is in loss,

إِلَّا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ وَتَوَاصَوْا بِالْحَقِّ وَتَوَاصَوْا بِالصَّبْرِ



Il^{la} allat^{heena} amanoo waAAamiloo alssalihati watawasaw bialhaqqi watawasaw bialssabri

103: 2 Except those who believe (in Islamic Monotheism) and do righteous good deeds, and recommend one another to the truth (i.e. order one another to perform all kinds of good deeds (*Al-Ma'ruf*) which Allah has ordained, and abstain from all kinds of sins and evil deeds (*Al-Munkar*) which Allah has forbidden), and recommend one another to patience (for the sufferings, harms, and injuries which one may encounter in Allah's Cause during preaching His religion of Islamic Monotheism or *Jihad*, etc.).

Teachings of the Surah

1. The surah starts with an oath where Allah swears by the time (Asr) because it is only Allah (S.W.T) who has the sole right to swear by anything because everything belongs to Him.
2. It affirms great loss for those who reject aod's message after it reached them correctly, and for those who accepted it but failed to live according to it. Loss means losing Allah's blessings and favors for the unbelievers.
3. Those excluded from the state of loss include the believers, those who perform righteous deeds,
4. It encourages one to follow the truth and enjoin one another to be patient.
5. They are also be committed to the truth of Islam.

Suratul Nasr (The Divine Support) - سورة النصر (Q110)

Historical Background

The Sura is called Suratul Nasr because it is a word that appears in the first verse of the chapter. It literally means help. And here it refers to Allah's help that caused the conquest of Makkah.

This Sura was revealed after the conquest of Makkah. It was the time when many people were embracing Islam, thus the Sura was to remind the Prophet and the Muslims believers at large to consider the victory from Allah only. The victory in which multitudes of people from different tribes embraced Islam was the victory from Allah (S.W.T) this is believed to be the last surah given to Prophet Muhammad and a sign to his approaching death.

Meaning and transliteration of Surat An-Naşr

Bismillahi rrahmani rraheemi **بِسْمِ هَلَا الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ**

إِذَا جَاءَ نَصْرُ اللَّهِ وَالْفَتْحُ ﴿١﴾

Itha jaa nasru Allahi waalfathu

110:1 When the victory of Allah has come and the conquest,

وَرَأَيْتَ النَّاسَ يَدْخُلُونَ فِي دِينِ اللَّهِ أَفْوَاجًا ﴿٢﴾

Waraayta alnnasa yadkhuloona fee deeni Allahi afwajan

110:2 And you see the people entering into the religion of Allah in multitudes,

فَسَبِّحْ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّكَ وَأَسْتَغْفِرْهُ إِنَّهُ كَانَ تَوَّابًا ﴿٣﴾

Fasabbih bihamdi rabbika waistaghfirhu innahu kana tawwaban

110:3 Then exalt [Him] with praise of your Lord and ask forgiveness of Him. Indeed, He is ever Accepting of repentance.

TEACHINGS OF SURATUL NASR

This surah has the following teachings

- It recognizes Allah as the only source of help and victory.
- It is a sign of victory when people are seen accepting Islam in multitudes.
- For any victory(help) people must glorify the praises Allah.



- People should glorify Allah's name and also ask for forgiveness. They should also seek Allah's forgiveness with confidence, as he is the one who accepts people's repentance.

Suggested study Questions and Activities

Answer the following Questions in your I.R.E revision exercise book.

1. State the lessons Muslims can learn from Suratul Fiil.
2. Define the following term Ulumul Quran.
3. Discuss the need for the revelation of the Quran
4. What are the teachings of surah Asr?

Activity:

Narrate the story of Abraha Ashram in relation to Sura al Fiil.

CHAPTER 2**HADITH**

The literal meaning of hadith is news, statement, report, stories or narrations.



Technically, the term hadith refers to the prophetic sayings, reports, statement which came forth from the prophet's gems or mouth. It also includes the prophet's action and deeds.

The term hadith is sometimes used to refer to Sunnah although there is a difference between the two as follows:

Differences between Hadith and Sunna

Hadith	Sunnah
This is what the prophet said or what he taught	This refers to what he did or his actions
Is what the prophet kept quiet about or approved	Is the way in which he conducted the affairs of the Ummah.
It is the prophet's interpretation of the Quran	It is his actual reading of the Quran
Is the prophet's treaties and declaration	Is the implementation of those treaties and declarations
Is the prophet's guidance on how to behave towards others	Is how he related to other people
This is the prophet's instruction on how to worship	Refers to the demonstrations and how he conducted the religious acts.

EVOLUTION OF HADITH

The term evolution has been used to refer to the origin, beginning or emergence. Therefore, evolution of Hadith traces the origin and gradual development of hadith



It can best be looked into by studying the drivers of evolution. These are the factors that made the Prophet to come up with the volumes of hadith and sunnah Muslims today rely on as a significant code of reference after the Quran.

There are four ways in which contributed to the evolution of hadith:

1. Through the prophets own initiative
2. As a response asked by his companions
3. As a demand of circumstances
4. As an interpretation of the Quran

The prophet's initiative

The prophet was devoted to teaching the MuslimUmma about the right way. He would come up with an issue of which he felt that there was need for the Muslims to know about. In this case he would talk to the Muslims to address it.

One instance is illustrated by the hadith below:

Abu Hureira (RAA) narrates that the Prophet (P.B.U.H) used to say (in supplication), *“O Allah! Set right for me my religion, which is the safeguard of my affairs. And set right for me the affairs of the world wherein is my living. Decree the hereafter to be good for me. And make this life, for me, (a source of) abundance for every good and make my death (a source of) comfort to me and protection against every evil.”*(Muslim)

This is an example in which the prophet took an initiative to teach the Muslims the dua they need to recite.

“Whoever speaks in the Jum’a while the Imam is delivering the khutba is like a donkey who is carrying books, and for he who tells him to be quiet, there will be no (reward for his) Jum’a prayer.” (Related by Ahmad)

The objective of this hadith is to teach about the importance of keeping quiet and attentively listening to the Friday khutba when it is on.

The third instance is when Al Mughira bin Shu’ba said:



I was with the prophet (during an expedition). He started to perform ablution and I was about to remove his socks (khuff), when he said, "Leave them, for I put them on while I was in a state of purity," and he wiped over them. (Bukahari and Muslim)

As a response to questions asked by his companions

The prophet was the leader and sole authority in all matters concerning the Muslims. People would approach him with questions on religion, social, political and any other issues affecting them. He was the resource of reference in addressing people's issues. Therefore, his suggested solutions became part of hadith.

Aisha (R.A) narrated: "I asked the prophet about turning here and there in prayer. He replied: *"It is a kind of theft by which Satan takes away (a portion of) the person's prayer."* (Al-Bukhari and At-Tirmidhi). The latter's wordings are, *"Avoid turning while you are engaged in prayer for it leads to the destruction of your religion. If you have to do it, then do it in the voluntary prayer."*

The hadith is an example that evolved through a question that the prophet had to respond to a question that Aisha, his wife, asked on matters concerning turning during prayers. The other hadith below shows another hadith that was as a result to questions asked.

Abu Huraira narrated that the prophet was asked:

"Which kind of sadaqa was better?" He replied, "That which is given by one who does not have much property. And begin by giving your dependents." (Ahmad, Abu Dawoud. In Khuzaima, Ibn Hibban) Al Hakim graded it as *sahih*.

This hadith is another evidence of evolution of hadith as a respond to questions from the companions.

Ibn Abbas narrated that a woman from the tribe of Juhainah came to the prophet and said, *"My mother vowed to perform Hajj but she died before fulfilling her vow. Should I perform Hajj on*



her behalf?’ The prophet said, “Yes, perform Hajj on her behalf. Had there been a debt on your mother, would you have paid it or not? So pay off her debt to Allah, for He is most deserving of settlement of His debt.” (Al- Bukhari.)

As a demand of circumstances

Circumstances and situations would arise and the companions would demand the prophet’s suggestions and solutions as their leader, hence their suggestions and solutions became Hadith. Ibn Abbas(R.A) narrated that when the prophet sent Muadh bin Jabal to Yemen (as governor); he said to him:

“You are going to a people who are people of the scripture. Invite them to testify that none has the right to be worshipped but Allah and that I am His Messenger. If they obey you in this, then teach them that Allah, the Glorious One, has enjoined five prayers upon them in every day and night, and if they obey you in this, then tell them that Allah has made it obligatory for them to pay zakat upon their assets and it is to be taken from the wealthy among them and given to the poor among them.” (Al- Bukhari).

This hadith shows a situation where the prophet had to give instructions to a potential leader on the duties he should carry out. Another instance is explained in the hadith below:

Jabir bin Abdullah(R.A) narrated that the prophet visited a sick person and found him praying while sitting on a cushion. The prophet pushed it aside and said to him:

“Pray while sitting on the ground if you can, and if you cannot, then pray by nodding your head, and make a lower nodding for prostration than that for bowing (rukuu).” (Al- Baihaqi).

The other hadith below shows another circumstance that the prophet had to give decisions:

Anas narrated that the prophet narrated that the prophet passed by a fallen date in the street and said:

“Were it not for my doubt that this might have been given for charity, I would have eaten it.” (Bukhari and Muslim)

As an interpretation of the Quran

The verses of the Qura’n were revealed to the prophet (h.B.U.H). It was the duty of the prophet to explain the meaning and application of those verses to his companions. Therefore his



explanations and commentaries became Hadith. This proves that prophet had a duty of giving further clarification whenever the need arose as Allah says in the Holy Qura'n:

“With clear signs and books (We sent the messengers). And we have also sent down to you (O Muhammad) the Dhikr [reminder] that is Quran, that you may explain clearly to men what is sent to them that they may give thought.”[Q: 16:44]

Following are examples of how the prophet interpreted the Quran using Hadith.

1. Interpretation on Jumaa prayer

“Oyou, who believe, when the call is proclaimed to prayer on Friday, hasten earnestly to the remembrance of Allah and leave off business: That is best for you but knew.”[Q: 62:9]

Prophet's Hadith

- a) Abdullah bin Umar and Abu Huraira (R.A) narrated that they heard the messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) say while standing on his pulpit, “ Those who are not attending Friday prayer should stop doing so, otherwise Allah the Exalted will seal their hearts and they will be reckoned among the heedless”(Muslim)
- b) Ibn Umar (R.A) narrated that the messenger of Allah said, “whoever catches only one rakat of the Jumaa prayer, or any other, he should then add to it another one, and his prayer will be complete” (AN-Nisai , Ibn-Maaja, Daraqutni)

2. Interpretation on Ribaa

“Those who devour Ribaa will not stand except as stands one whom the Satan by his touch has driven to madness. That is because they say, “trade is like ribaa,” but Allah has permitted trade and forbidden ribaa. For who after receiving admonition from their Lord desist shall be pardoned for their past; their case is for Allah to judge; but those who repeat (the offence) are companions of the fire: they will abide therein (forever).” [Q: 2:275 -276]

Prophet's Hadith



Abu Huraira (R.A) narrates that the messenger of Allah said: “whenever gold is exchanged with gold it should be equivalent in amount and quality, and whenever silver is exchanged for silver it should be equivalent in amount and quality. Whoever gives more or asks for more, this is considered ribaa.”(Muslim)

Forms of Hadith.

Hadith have been classified into four forms determined by the way they were presented by the prophet. These forms are:

- Fiil (what he did)
- Qaul (what he said)
- Iqrar (what he silently approved)
- Sifat(his attributes)

Fiil

This form of Hadith refers to the virtuous deeds or actions done by the Prophet (P.B.U.H). The following are examples of the prophets Hadith:

1. Aisha (R.A) relates, ” *I never saw the messenger of God laughing in a way that the inside of his mouth is apparent, he only used to smile.* ” (Al-Bukhari).
2. Narrated by Jaaber (God be pleased with him) relates that on the day of the Idd (feast), the prophet (peace be upon him) used to go to Idd prayer by one route and come back by another route. (Al-Bukhari).

Qaul

This form of Hadith refers to sayings, reports or what came by word of mouth from the prophet (P.B.U.H). An example of Qaul is the following:

Abu-Huraira (God be pleased with him) relates that the messenger of God peace be upon him said, “*A hypocrite has 3 signs by when he can be known: if he speaks he lies, if give a promise he never fulfill it, if he is entrusted with something he betrays the trust.*”(Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

Iqrar



Iqrar is also referred to as Takrir. It refers the deeds done by the Swahabas when the prophet kept quiet about them instead of disapproving them or rather he silently approved them. His silent approval was like giving them a go ahead to continue with the deeds. An example of this form of Hadith is as follows:

Ibn Abbas (R.A) narrated, *“We used to pray two rak’at after sunset (before the Maghrib prayer, and the prophet would see us, but he did not order us to do so, nor did he prohibit.”* (Muslim)

Give more examples of hadith that emerged through the prophet’s own initiative.

Sifat

This refers to general appearance and especially bodily characteristics and the physical tributes the prophet possessed. It includes the qualities and attributes that the prophet displayed in his life. The Swahabas were able to observe his general conduct and follow them. Mention any attributes of the prophet that you can see being practiced today. The following are examples of hadith that emerged as a result of his Sifat:

1. Narrated by Abu-Huraira (R.A) relates that Al- Hassan Ibn Ali (the prophet’s grandson (R.A) picked up a date from the dates set for charity and put it in his mouth. The messenger of God said, *“Kikh Kikh”* (dirt! Keep away!) Throw it out. Do you not know that we (the Prophet (P.B.U.H) and his household) do not eat from charity?” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim).
2. Narrated by Aisha (R.A) relates that the messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) used to like using the right hand-side in all his affairs: his cleansing, combing his hair, putting on his footwear... (Al-Bukhari and Muslim).

Contributions of hadith to Islamic thought and culture

- 1) The content of hadith provides an explanation of the verses of the Quran thus enhancing its understanding and application of its teachings. For example; the holy Quran gives a ruling that Muslims should pay Zakat without outlining the details of how much, on which items or when to give the Zakat. We learn all these details from the hadith.
- 2) The study of Hadith has made tremendous contributions to the growth and development of Islamic sharia. Muslim jurists like the four imams of the schools of thought studied the sciences of hadith and simplified its understanding and application.
- 3) Hadith have provided a clear guidance on the code of conduct expected from the Muslims. Muslims should adhere to specific mannerisms of walking, sleeping eating among others as taught by our prophet(P.B.U.H)
- 4) Hadith have summarised the prophets exemplary life which Muslims emulate to mould their character.



- 5) Hadith is the second source of sharia after the Quran. This was confirmed by the prophet in his farewell address confirmed when he said “Verily, I have left among you the book of Allah and the sunnah of his apostle which if you hold fast you shall never go astray.”

REVISION QUESTION

Give a brief explanation on the following forms of Hadith.

- 1) Qaul**
- 2) Fiyl**
- 3) Iqrar**
- 4) Sifaat**



CHAPTER 3

Pillars of iman

The literal meaning of Iman is to belief in or to have faith in something.

There are six pillars of Iman as mentioned in the Quran: ***“The messenger believes in what has been revealed to him from his Lord as do men of faith. Each one (of them) believes in Allah, His Angels, His books and His messengers. We make no distinctions (they say) between one and another of His Messengers. ‘And they say ‘We hear and we obey :(we seek) Your forgiveness our Lord and to you is the end of all journeys.” [Q: 2:285]***

The prophet (saw) said *“Iman is to believe in God, and His Angels, and His Scripture, and His apostles, and to believe in the resurrection and the last day and the divine pre-measurement of good and evil, and to have faith in all these things.” (Muslim)*

TAWHEED:

Literally Tawheed comes from the word Wah-hada, which means to make something Waahid (singular).

Technically-Tawheed means attributing oneness to Allah and describing Him as being one and unique. It is the first pillar of the six pillars of Iman and the most fundamental and important teaching of all the prophets and messengers who all taught the belief in the oneness of Allah. It is expressed in the primary Kalima **“LA ILLA ILA LLAH”** Meaning there is no God but Allah, or there is no one who has the right to be worshipped except Allah. Tawheed differentiates between a Muslim and a Kafir.

Allah says – **“Say (O Muhammad). He is Allah the one. Allah, the self-sufficient master, whom all creatures need. He begets not, nor was he begotten. And there is none equal or comparable unto Him.” [Q112]**

Allah says: **“There is nothing like unto him and He is the All-Hearer, the All-seer.” [Q: 42: 11]**



Categories of tawheed

1. Tawheed ar-rubabiyah.

This concept of Tawheed is based on the belief of unifying Allah(SWT) as the sovereign **Lord(Rabbi)**. And that He is the sole Lord of the universe who sustains and maintains all creation with any need for it or for it. According to this category, since God is the real power in existence, it is He Who gives all things the power to move and to change. Allah mentions this concept in many Quranic verses:

“Say: “who is it that sustains you (in life) from sky and from the earth? Or who is it that has power over hearing and sight? And who is it that brings out the living from the dead and the dead from the living? And who is that rules and regulates all affairs? They will soon say “Allah” say, “Will you not then show piety (to him)?”[Q: 10:31]

Allah (S.W.T) says *“And if indeed thou ask them who it is that sends down rain from the sky, and gives life therewith to the earth after its death, they will certainly reply “Allah” say “praise be to Allah!” But most of them understand not.”[Q: 29:63]*

2. Tawheed al-Uluhiyah

This means to believe that Allah (Swat) the most High is the one worth of true worship. Therefore all acts of worship like Salat, working, fasting, among others should be dedicated to Allah alone. Hence it's not permissible to associate anything in worship with Him.

Allah says, *“To the ‘Aad people (we sent) Hud, one of their (own) brethren: He said,” O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but him. Will you not fear (Allah)?”[Q: 7:65]*

Allah (SWT) also says, *“Say; Truly, my prayer and my service of sacrifice, my life and my death, are (all) for Allah, The cherisher of the worlds”.[Q: 6:162]*

3. Tawheed al-asma wasifat. (Names and attributes).



This category helps us to understand who our creator is through His names and qualities through which we know that Allah (SWT) is beyond our imagination and bears no resemblance.

Allah says *“And (All) the most beautiful names belongs to Allah, so call on him by them.”*[Q: 7: 180]

Attributes of Allah

The Prophet said *“Allah has ninety nine names, i.e. one hundred minus one, and whoever guards [or counts] them (i.e. believes in their meaning and acts accordingly), will enter paradise: And Allah is witr (one) ‘and loves the witr.’*

الْقُدُّوسُ

4. AL-QUDDUS
The Holy

الْمَلِكُ

3. AL-MALIK
The Sovereign Lord

الرَّحِيمُ

2. AR-RAHIM
The Merciful

الرَّحْمَنُ

1. AR-RAHMAN
The Beneficent

الْعَزِيزُ

8. AL-AZIZ
The Mighty

الْمُهَيَّمِنُ

7. AL-MUHAYMIN
The Protector

الْمُؤْمِنُ

6. AL-MU'MIN
The guardian of faith

السَّلَامُ

5. AS-SALAM
The Source Of Peace

الْبَارِي

12. AL-BARI
The Evolver

الْخَالِقُ

11. AL-KHALIQ
The Creator

الْمُتَكَبِّرُ

10. AL-MUTAKABBIR
The Majestic

الْجَبَّارُ

9. AL-JABBAR
The Compeller

الْوَهَّابُ 16. AL-WAHHAB The Bestower	الْقَهَّارُ 15. AL-QAHHAR The Subdue	الْغَفَّارُ 14. AL-GHAFFAR The Forgiver	الْمُصَوِّرُ 13. AL-MUSAWWIR The Fashioner
الْقَابِضُ 20. AL-QABIZ The Constrictor	الْعَلِيمُ 19. AL-ALIM The All Knowing	الْفَتَّاحُ 18. AL-FATTAH The Opener	الرَّزَّاقُ 17. AR-RAZZAQ The Provider
الْمُعِزُّ 24. AL-MUIZZ The Honourer	الرَّافِعُ 23. AR-RAFI The Exalter	الْخَافِضُ 22. AL-KHAFIZ The Abaser	الْبَاسِطُ 21. AL-BASIT The Expender
الْحَكَمُ 28. AL-HAKAM The Judge	الْبَصِيرُ 27. AL-BASIR The All Seeing	السَّمِيعُ 26. AS-SAMI The All Hearing	الْمُذِلُّ 25. AL-MUZILL The Dishonourer
الْحَلِيمُ 32. AL-HALIM The Forbearing on	الْخَبِيرُ 31. AL-KHABIR The Aware	الْلَّطِيفُ 30. AL-LATIF The Subtle One	الْعَدْلُ 29. AL-ADL The Just
الْعَلِيُّ 36. AL-ALI The Most High	الشَّكُورُ 35. ASH-SHAKUR The Appreciative	الْغَفُورُ 34. AL-GHAFUR The All-Forgiving	الْعَظِيمُ 33. AL-AZIM The Great one
لِحَسِيبُ 40. AL-HASEEB The Reckoner	الْمُقِيتُ 39. AL-MUQIT The Maintainer	الْحَفِيزُ 38. AL-HAFIZ The Preserver	الْكَبِيرُ 37. AL-KABIR The Most Great

المُجِيبُ

44. AL-MUJIB
The Responsive

الرَّقِيبُ

43. AR-RAQIB
The Watchfull

الكَرِيمُ

42. AL-KARIM
The Generous One

الْجَلِيلُ

41. AL-JALIL
The Sublime One

الْمَجِيدُ

48. AL-MAJEED
The Most Glorious On

الْوَدُودُ

47. AL-WADUD
The Loving

الْحَكِيمُ

46. AL-HAKEEM
The Wise

الْوَاسِعُ

45. AL-WASI
The All-Embracing

الْوَكِيلُ

52. AL-WAKIL
The Trustee

الْحَقُّ

51. AL-HAQQ
The Truth

الشَّهِيدُ

50. ASH-SHAHEED
The Witness

الْبَاعِثُ

49. AL-BA'ITH
The Resurrector

الْحَمِيدُ

56. AL-HAMEED
The Praiseworthy

الْوَلِيُّ

55. AL-WALI
The Protecting Friend

الْمَتِينُ

54. AL-MATEEN
The Firm One

الْقَوِيُّ

53. AL-QAWI
The Most Strong

الْمُحْيِي

60. AL-MUHYI
The Giver Of Life

الْمُعِيدُ

59. AL-MU'ID
The Restorer

الْمَبْدِي

58. AL-MUBDI
The Originator

الْمُحْصِي

57. AL-MUHSI
The Reckoner

الْوَاجِدُ

64. AL-WAJID
The Finder

الْقَيُّومُ

63. AL-QAYYUM
The Self-subsisting

الْحَيُّ

62. AL-HAYEE
The Alive

الْمُمِيتُ

61. AL-MUMIT
The Creator Of Deat

الصَّمَدُ

68. AS-SAMAD
The Eternal

الْأَحَدُ

67. AL-AHAD
The One

الْوَاحِدُ

66. AL-WAHID
The Unique

الْمَاجِدُ

65. AL-MAJID
The Noble

القَادِرُ

69. AL-QADIR
The Able

الأَوَّلُ

73. AL-AWWAL
The First

الوَالِيُ

77. AL-WALI
The Governor

الْمُنْتَقِمُ

81. AL-MUNTAQIM
The Avenger

وَالْجَلَالُ وَالْإِكْرَامُ

85.
UL-JALAL-E-WAL-IKRAM
The Lord
Of Majesty and Bounty

الْمَغْنِيُ

89. AL-MUGHNI
The Enricher

النُّورُ

93. AN-NOOR
The Light

الْمُقْتَدِرُ

70. AL-MUQTADIR
The Powerful

الْآخِرُ

74. AL-AAKHIR
The Last

الْمُتَعَالَى

78. AL-MUTA'ALI
The Most Exalted

العَفُوُّ

82.. AL-'AFUW
The Pardoner

الْمُقْسِطُ

86. AL-MUQSIT
The Equitable

الْمَانِعُ

90. AL-MAANAY
The Preventer

الْهَادِيُ

94. AL-HAADI
The Guide

الْمُقَدِّمُ

71. AL-MUQADDIM
The Expediter

الظَّاهِرُ

75. AZ-ZAHIR
The Manifest

الْبَرُّ

79. AL-BARR
The Source of
All Goodness

الرَّءُوفُ

83. AR-RAOOF
The Compassionate

الْجَامِعُ

87. AL-JAAMAY
The Gatherer

الضَّارُّ

91. AD-DAARR
The Distresser

الْبَدِيعُ

95. AL-BADEI
The Incomparable

الْمُؤَخِّرُ

72. AL-MU'AKHKHI
The Delayer

الْبَاطِنُ

76. AL-BATIN
The Hidden

التَّوَّابُ

80. AT-TAWWAB
The Acceptor Of
Repentance

مَالِكُ الْمَلِكِ

84. MALIK-UL-MUL
The Eternal Owner
Of Sovereignty

الْغَنِيُّ

88. AL-GHANI
The Self-Sufficient

النَّافِعُ

92. AN-NAAFAY
The Propitious

الْبَاقِيُ

96. AL-BAQI
The Everlasting



Significance of tawheed.

- I. It is the first fundamental principal of the Islamic Faith.
- II. It assures the creatures that the creator is near them and ready to answer their request.
- III. It distances mankind from worshipping other than Allah.
- IV. It increases Taqwa since one is aware that Allah sees him wherever he may be and is aware of even what is hidden in ones heart and mind.
- V. It leads one to ensure his respect and maintain his dignity as a respect to his creator.
- VI. It gives an attitude of peace and contentment in a person since he knows that Allah will take care of his needs if he is truly obedient and hardworking.
- VII. It leads to unity and brotherhood amongst human beings.
- VIII. It makes a believer to be dutiful and upright, since he knows that Allah(S.W.T) will ask everybody of his responsibility on the day of the judgment. Therefore he does his duties whole heartedly and this keeps him away from neglecting his duties and from sin.
- IX. It removes the fear of people since one strongly believes that not only his life but everything is in the hands of Allah.
- X. It removes greediness and jealousy and the desire to achieve success through even evil means as one believes in the powers of Allah and not one's endeavor.
- XI. It does not allow him to be proud or arrogant.
- XII. It makes a believer brave and courageous.
- XIII. It makes a believer to be patient and persevering for he will know that whatever the problem Allah(S.W.T) will have to solve it for him gradually.



Shirk (polytheism)

The term shirk comes from the Arabic word sharaka which means to associate or form partners with. In the Islamic context shirk means ascribing a partner or rival to Allah (S.W.T) in worship or His names and attributes.

Allah (S.W.T) says, *“Allah forgive not that partners should set up with Him; but He forgives anything else to whom he pleases; to set up partners with god is to devise a sin most heinous indeed.”* [Q: 4: 48]

Allah (S.W.T) says *“Allah has said: ‘Take not (for worship) two gods. For He is just one God. Then fear me and me alone.’* [Q: 16:51]

Forms of shirk.

There are three forms of shirk, namely:

1. Shirk – al-akbar-major.
2. Shirk al-asghar – minor.
3. Shirk al-khafii – inconspicuous/hidden.

1. shirk-akbar(major shirk)

This form of shirk is manifested in the following four ways:

- a. Shirk ad-dua.
- b. Shirk a-niyaah.
- c. Shirk al-Taah.
- d. Shirk al -mahabah.

I. Shirkad-dua



It implies invoking supplication or praying to others besides Allah(S.W.T) such as to supplicate to the dead in the grave or worship via the ancestors.

Allah(SWT) Says, “And when they embark on a ship, they invoke Allah, making the faith pure for him only, but when he brings them safely to land behold, they give a share of their worship to others”. [Q:29:65]

II. Shirk an- Niyyah wal Irada wal Qasd.

It means intention, determination or purpose in acts of worship not for Allah but towards others. Allah (S.W.T) says, **“Whoever desires the life of the world and its glitters, to them shall pay in full their deed therein, and they will have no domination therein. They are those for whom there is nothing in the here after but fire and ruin is the deeds they did. And of no effect that which they used to do.”** [Q: 11:15-16]

Allah (S.W.T) says:

“Have you seen him whom takes for his God his own passion?” [Q: 25: 43]

III. Shirk Taah.

This type means obeying any other authorities against the will Allah. Allah(S.W.T) says, **“They Jews and Christians took their rabbis and their monks to be their Lords besides Allah, and Messiah son of Mariam while they were commanded (in Taurat and Injil) to worship none but Allah Lailla to Huwa. Praise and glory is to him for having the partners they associate.”** [Q: 9:31]



IV. Shirk al Mahaba

This is showing the love that is due to Allah to others other than Him. Allah (S.W.T) says, *“And of mankind are some who take (for worship) others besides Allah as rivals. They love them as they love Allah. But those who believe love Allah more. If only those who do wrong could see, when they will see the torment that all power belongs to Allah is severe in punishment.”*

2. Shirk al-asghar (minor shirk).

It also termed as Ar-riya.

Ar-riya is any action which is performed in order to receive praise, fame or any other worldly gain. It is performing Ibaada to show off for example performing swalat so that you can be seen or praised. Any actions that are done out of showing off will not be rewarded by Allah (S.W.T) “Those who want but to be seen.” [Q: 107:6]

Allah says *“The hypocrites seek to deceive Allah but it is Allah who deceives them. When they stand up to prayer, stand without earnestness, to be seen of men, But little do they hold Allah in remembrance.”* [Q: 4:142]

3. Shirk al khafi i.e Inconspicuous Shirk.

Have you ever had a feeling of dissatisfaction in something? What are some of the things in life that leave you dissatisfied or make you keep wishing that you had better things than what Allah (S.W.T) has provided you with? Having this feeling may lead you to performing Shirk al Khafi.

This type of Shirk involves being inwardly dissatisfied with the inevitable condition that has been ordained for one by Allah (S.W.T) conscientiously lamenting that had you done or not done such and such or had you approached such and such you would have had a better status. It is one of the most dangerous forms of shirk as people cannot see when they are performing it. This Shirk is so hidden and difficult that even the one committing it cannot recognize it. The prophet said *“ashirk alkhafii in the muslim nation is more inconspicuous than the creeping of a black ant on a black rock in the pitch darkness of the night.”*



While commenting on this Hadith Ibin Abbas said that kind of shirk is like when one tells his friends. *“You and God what you wished is what happened” If it was not so and so”*.

Hadith narrated by Abu Sa'id Al-Khudri that the Prophet (sallallahu alayhi wassallam) said, *“Should I not inform you of what I fear more for you than Al-Masih-ul-Dajjal (the Antichrist)?”* The people said, *“Yes, O Messenger of Allah.”* He said, *“It is the hidden Shirk; a person stands up in Salah (Prayer) and tries to make it perfect when he realizes that others are looking at him.”* (Related by Imam Ahmad)

Why Quran condemn shirk

1. Shirk is the highest of the wrong doing according to the instructions given by Luqman to his son. ***“Behold, Luqman said to his son by way of instructions: ‘o my son join not in worship (others) with Allah: for false worship is indeed the highest wrong doing.”*** [Q: 31:13]
2. When one attaches Allah's attributes to any of his creations, he or she undermines Allah's sovereignty yet Allah is supposed to be sovereign.
3. It is of all the sins, Allah (S.W.T) vows not to forgive anyone who commits it knowingly. This is because a person who commits such a sin undermines Allah's function as the creator, sustainer and destroyer of life. Allah (S.W.T) says, ***“Allah forgive not that partners should set up with Him; but He forgives anything else to whom he pleases; to set up partners with god is to devise a sin most heinous indeed.”*** [Q: 4: 48]
4. Belief in Shirk creates animosity in the society, since people will always be suspicious of each other and they will divert themselves with the belief in Allah as one who predetermines people's destiny.
5. Shirk makes man to have little or no confidence in God but in other things most especially in times of danger which defames the status of man as Allah's vicegerent as the best of his creation.
6. Shirk makes a person to distance him or herself from Allah (S.W.T) yet man is supposed to always be nearest to God pray to him whenever he or she has a problem. Yet those who practice other objects created by Allah. ***“And who is more astray than one who invokes***



,besides Allah,such as will not answer to the day of judgment, and who(in fact)are unconscious of their call(to them)” [Q: 46:5]

7. Shirk makes an individual not to be dutiful and upright, one who performs shirk does not his carry out or her duties whole heartedly and this makes her or him near to sinking all the time.
8. Shirk makes a person behave like a coward as he or she will always be thinking that even objects which have no life can protect her or him from any danger or misfortune e.g. wearing of emulates.

BELIEF IN ANGELS

The belief in the angels is the second pillar of Iman.

Angels are holy and pure creatures of Allah(S.W.T) to whom He Has bestowed the power to perform specific divine duties.

“O you who believe! Save yourselves and your families from a fire whose fuel is men and stones, over which are (appointed) angels stern (and) severe, who flinch not (from executing the commands they receive from Allah, but do (precisely) what they are commanded.” [Q: 66:6]

From the above ayat, Angels do not execute their duties just for the sake of it but are dedicated to their duties for which they were created. They are characterized by the following main features:

- i. They are creatures of Allah that He created from Noor (light). Aisha(RAA) narrates that the messenger of Allah says, *‘Angels were created from light, jinns were created from smokeless fire and Adam was created from that which was described to you (in the Quran, which is clay.)’* (Sahih Muslim.)



- ii. Allah created them outside blood relationship, hence unlike human beings; they are not associated with having such relations as parental (parent to child), fraternal (brother to brother/sister) or any other blood relation.
- iii. They are not associated with any gender like the human beings are. ***“And they make into females Angels who themselves serve Allah Did they witness their creation? Their evidence will be recorded, and they will be called to account.”*** [Q: 43:19]
- iv. Allah has not bestowed unto them the feelings of hunger, thirst or such related desires. This is told in the story of Nabii Ibrahim when Allah (S.W.T) send messengers to him, ***“There came our messengers to Abraham with glad tidings .They said, “Peace!” He answered “peace!” and hastened to entertain them with a roasted calf. But when he saw their hands went not towards the (meal), he felt some mistrust of them, and conceived a fear of them. They said, ‘Fear not: We have been sent against the people of Lut.’”***[Q 11:69-70]
- v. They were relieved by the divine powers of Allah, from fatigue, monotony and the desire to either relax or sleep.
- vi. They have no definite bodies to be identified with but Allah has bestowed them with the ability to be in any form that is relevant with the prevailing circumstance e.g. Birds (when they appeared to Adam to teach him on burial), man (when they appeared to prophets Lut and Muhammad) or invisible (when they helped the Muslims during the battle of Badr).
- vii. Allah has prepared their abode (the place of their convergence) in heaven.
- viii. They diligently praise Allah and glorify Him in deeds and articulation.

ANGELS AND THEIR DUTIES

1. Jibril (Gabriel)

He communicated the revelation to all prophets by taking the divine message with the order of Allah to the relevant recipients.

“Say, (O Muhammad) the Holy Spirit (i.e. Jibril) has brought it down from your Lord in truth in order to strengthen those who believe, and as guide and glad tidings to the Muslims.”[Q: 16:102]



2. Mikail

He is in charge of rain.

“Whoever is an enemy to Allah and His Angels and His Messengers and Jibril and Mikail- then indeed Allah is an enemy to the disbelievers.”[Q: 2:98]

3. Israfiil

Do you know about the day of judgement? On the day the horn will be blown to call every one to account for his deeds. The Angel in charge of blowing this trumpet is known as Israfiil. Even though his name is not mentioned in the Quran his duty has been mentioned when Allah (S.W.T) says,

“And the horn will be blown. That is the day of the threat.”[Q: 50:20]

“The trumpet shall be sounded, behold! When people will rush forth from their graves to their Lord.”[Q: 36:51]

4. Israil

Allah (S.W.T) has said in the holy Quran that every living thing shall test death. During theremoval of the souls, a special Angel called Malakul-Maut (The Angel of death) is sent by Allah to take the soul back to its creator.

He is in charge of removing souls at the time of death.

“And He is the subjugation over His servants and He sends over you guardian Angels until, when death comes to one of you, our messengers (i.e. Angels of death) take him and they do not fail (in their duties).”[Q: 6:61]

Say: “The Angel of death, put in charge of you, will (duly) take your souls. Then shall you be brought back to your lord.”[Q: 32:11]

5. Atid and Raqiib (Kiraman Katibun)

Islam encourage sthe doing of good always thogh at times we may commit mistakes in life. Are we aware that all the things we do in life are recorded? Just as we keep our records in a diary, Allah has his Angels whom he has given the responsibility of keeping every human



beings record. The Quran refers to them as Kiraman Katibun. They are angels in charge of recording good and evil deeds of individuals.

“When the two receivers (recording Angels receive), seated on the right and left....”[Q: 50:17]

“For each (such person, there are Angels in succession. Before him: they guard him by command of Allah. Verily never will Allah change the condition of a people until they change it themselves (with their own souls)” [Q: 13:11]

6. Malik

He is in charge of Hell fire.

“And they will call, ‘O Malik let your Lord put an end to us!’ Indeed, you will remain.”[Q: 43:77]

7. Ridhwan

He is in charge of paradise. In the Quran, Allah (SWT) mentions them as many Angels welcoming those who used to do good deeds in the Janna (paradise). *“Gardens of perpetual bliss: They shall enter there, as well as the righteous among their fathers, their spouses, and their off springs: And Angels shall enter unto them from every gate (with the salutation)”* [Q: 13:23-24]

8. Munkar and Nakir

They are Angels in charge of questioning in the grave. They also discharge severe punishment to the dead people who had committed sin.

Suggested study questions and class activities.

Answer the following questions in your I.R.E revision exercise book.

1. Explain the meaning of term Tawheed.
2. What are the characteristics of Angels?
3. Elaborate on the three types of shirk.

Activity.

Find out how shirk is manifested in your community.

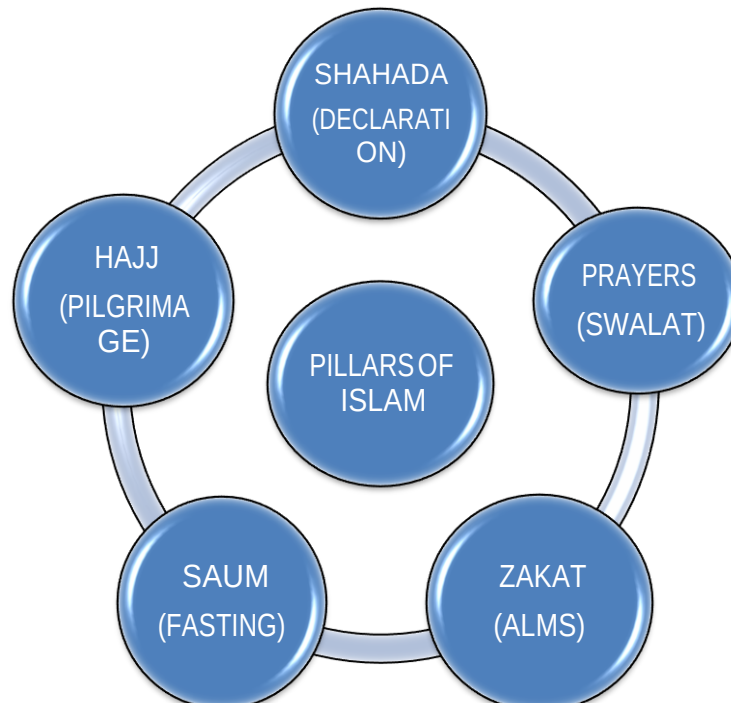
CHAPTER 4

DEVOTIONAL ACTS

Pillars of Islam

There are five pillars of Islam which are the frame work of a Muslim life. These are the basic beliefs that shape the Muslim thought, deeds and society.

Diagram of the pillars of the pillars of Islam:



SHAHADA

Meaning of Shahada

The word Shahada is an Arabic term which means to testify or to bear witness.



Literal meaning: Shahada is a special sentence: La illaha ila Allah wa Muhammadun rasoolollah
(There is no (other) Lord except Allah and Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.
(Lailaha illa-Allahu Muhammad rasul Allah)

Measuring of Shahada.

Shahada is the first pillar of Islam which consists of two main parts.

The first part of the shahada says: (Lailaha illa-Allahu Muhammad rasul Allah)

That there is none worthy of worship except Allah.

This part declares the absolute unity of Allah, his oneness as the only one who deserves to be worshipped. Muslims are not supposed to render complete obedience for no human nor material object possess power and authority equal to Him.

It is the gateway way to Islam.

The second part of the shahada says: Muhammadun rasoolollah Muhammad (P.B.U.H) is His messenger.

The Prophet Mohammad (P.B.U.H) as the messenger of Allah.

His being mentioned in the Shahada confirms that he is the universal and final prophet sent to all mankind.

Mankind has the obligations in following the teachings and commandments of prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H).

They have a duty to adhere to the teachings in order to seek Allah Pleasure although he is the last in the ladder of the prophets of Allah.

Significance of Shahada in the life of a Muslim.

1. Shahada makes a believer to surrender all his/her life to God. This makes a believer to fulfill God's command.
2. It produces in a believer a high degree of confidence and respect towards His creator.
3. Instills in a believer feeling of contentment for he/she will know that Allah (S.W.T) will take care of all his needs.



4. It makes a believer to be brave and courageous as he will know that it is Allah who owns his life.
5. It recognizes and re-affirms that prophet Mohammad (P.B.U.H) is the chosen messenger of Allah (S.W.T)
6. It makes believers develop trust and heed to the guidelines of the prophet.
7. It gives an opportunity to the believers to know how Allah (S.W.T) has honored Prophet Mohammad. (P.B.U.H).
8. Gives Allah the absolute right to be worshipped.
9. It affirms that prophet Muhammad(P.B.U.H) is the chosen messenger of Allah(S.W.T)
10. When uttered by a Muslim on his death will lead one to enter paradise.

4.22 Swalat read Q: 4:103

As-Salah: In the Arabic language it means *prayer* (Invocation).

Salat, which is the second pillar of Islam, may be defined as a special a process of worshipping A which includes supplication of duas, glorification of Allah's name, prostrations in order to seek blessings and forgiveness.

In this process of worship, there are certain known and prescribed invocations and acti systematically performed starting with Takbeer (saying *Allah Akbar*; God is the Great) which ending with Tasleem (saying: *as-salaam 'alaykum wa Rahmatul-lahi wabarakaatuh*; may All Peace, Mercy, and Blessings be upon you) do you perform swalat? Can you demonstrate how sw is performed? If you perform swalat regularly, you will discover that there are two types of sawlat, obligatory and the voluntary prayers. We shall now look at each of these prayers in details.

1. Fardn-ain(obligatory prayers)

These are prayers compulsory for every Muslim under the obligation by the shariah to perf them. Failure to perform them pens one to punishment in the hereafter.

Allah(S.W.T) says in

“And establish regular prayers at the two ends of the day and at the approaches of the night those things that are good remove those that evil: But that the word of the remembrance to th who remember(their Lord)” [Q:11:114]

Let us now look at the obligatory prayers and the times prescribed for there performance accordin Islamic Sharia.



i. Fajr

This is the morning prayer which consists of two rakats(units).It's time occurs when a vertical pillar of faint light appears in the east and spreads on the horizon,distinct from the darkness of night.This is just before sunrise. Quran recitation is loud for the two rakaats.

ii. Dhur

This is the early afternoon prayer.It consist of four raka'at (units) and it's time occurs after the sun has gone (passed over head) after reaching the highest point in the sky.)

iii. Asr

This prayer is said in the late afternoon.It consist of four raka'at(units)

iv. Maghrib

This is the sunset prayer.It consists of three raka'at(units).It has the shortest duration which starts immediately after the sun has set.Quran recitation is loud for the first two raka'ats.

v. Isha

This prayer is performed immediately after Maghrib prayer.It consists of four raka'at in which the first two Raka'at are recited aloud.Its time extends to the later part of the night.

2. Fardh kifaya

These are obligatory prayers which must be performed by atleast one muslim in the community.If it is performed by a single Muslim, then the obligation is lifted from the others.Incase it's not performed by one at all the whole society gets sin.e.g Swalatul Janaza. Can you demonstrate before your friends how this prayer is performed?

3. Sunnah prayers (optional)

These are prayers that are not compulsory for the muslims.They are performed to follow the exemplary teachings of the prophet(P.B.U.H) and are therefore recommended.

Can you give examples of Sunnah prayers and mention the number of rakaats for each? Some of the sunnah prayers are as follows:

I. Tahhiyatul Masjid.

The prayer of tahhiyat al-masjid (greeting of the masjid) is a confirmed sunna once a day, and recommended thereafter. It consists of two rakaats and is best preformed before sitting down even though the sunna is not lifted if one does sit first. One can intend this prayer along with their sunna or fard if they do not have time to pray it. One should not pray the tahhiyat al-masjid during a disliked time.



II. Tahajjud

This prayer is performed at night and it is recommended that it be performed after first going to sleep for some part of the evening. Its time falls between the prayer times of the isha'a prayers and the Fajr prayers. It is also recommended that the prayers be done in the last third of the night. Muslims believe that the reward is greater for those who do this prayer at a later time.

The Tahajjud prayer consists of a minimum of two rak'at and the maximum number is unlimited.

It's reported about the Messenger of Allah (Allah bless him and give him peace) that he said: "Adhere to night prayer, for it is the habit of the righteous before you, and a means of drawing nearer to your Lord; it is an expiation for sins, and a deterrent from wrongdoing." [Tirmidhi & al-Hakim]

III. Tarawih

Tarawih is an optional prayer in that can be done only during the Muslim fasting month of Ramadhan. This prayer can be done alone, in a group, at home, or in a mosque or other public meeting area. Typically, Muslims gather together and perform tarawih as a group. Others may meet in their local mosque, a meeting hall, or even in an outdoor field. The minimum number of rak'at of Tarawih is eight with a maximum of Twenty. It is also customary for the Imam in the main mosque to recite the entire Qur'an during the fasting month by reading approximately one section per day. This practice of reading the Qur'an completely is known as *khatm* (complete recitation).

IV. Witr prayer

Witr prayer starts after a person prays the Isha prayer until dawn. Evidence for this is that the Prophet (P.B.U.H) said: *"Allah has prescribed for you a prayer (by which He may increase your reward), which is Witr; Allah has enjoined it for you during the time between 'Isha' prayer until dawn begins."* (Narrated by al-Tirmidhi)

It is better to pray the witr prayer in the final third of the night because prayer at this time is witnessed by the angels. However, if a person fears that he will not get up at the last third of the night then he or she can pray it straight in the beginning third so that he or she does not miss the prayer.



One should make the night prayers and odd number and thus the Witr prayer is an odd number of rakkats. It may consist of one, three, five, seven, nine or any other odd number. Most Muslims perform three rakaats. If you are praying the witr prayer and dawn is approaching then you should pray one rakkaat so that you can pray witr before the start of dawn.

V. Swalatu-I Istikhara

Istikhara is Arabic word which means to ask Allah to guide one to the right thing. Have you been in a difficult situation especially when you have to choose between two *permissible* alternatives? Mention some of the difficult decision you have had to choose. Allah (S.W.T) provides an answer whenever a Muslim is in such a difficult situation. This is by offering a two rakaat prayer to seek guidance. Sa' d ibn Waqas reported that the hrophet(h.B.U.H) said, *“Istikharah (seeking guidance from Allah) is one of the distinct favors (of Allah) upon man, and a good fortune for the son of Adam is to be pleased with the judgment of Allah. And a misfortune of the son of Adam is his failure to make istikharah (seeking Allah's guidance), and a misfortune for the son of Adam is his displeasure with the judgment of Allah.”*

After completing the two-rak'ats, one praises Allah (S.W.T) and sends salutations to the hrophet (P.B.U.H) and recites the following supplication as narreted by Jabir.

“(O Allah! I ask guidance from Your knowledge, and Power from Your Might and I ask for Your great blessings. You are capable and I am not. You know and I do not and You know the unseen. O Allah! If You know that this job is good for my religion and my subsistence and in my Hereafter—(or said: If it is better for my present and later needs)—then You ordain it for me and make it easy for me to get, and then bless me in it, and if You know that this job is harmful to me in my religion and subsistence and in the Hereafter—(or said: If it is worse for my present and later needs)—then keep it away from me and let me be away from it. And ordain for me whatever is good for me, and make me satisfied with it).” (Sahih Bukhari)



VI. Tahiyyatul-Masjid

This is the prayer of salutation to the mosque and is performed upon entering the mosque .It consists of two rakaats. In case a person who was sitting inside the mosque went out of it, and then returned to it after a short period of time then he is not required to perform the prayer of salutation to the mosque. However, if he performs this prayer he will be rewarded for doing so.

VII. Swalatu-I Dhuhaa

It is the mid-morning Prayer. Its time starts when sun risesto the height of a spear and ends close to midday. The best time is when mid-morning heat has intensified. The minimum number of rakaat is two but can be prayed upto eight rakaats.

VIII. Qabliyya and Baadiya prayers

These prayers are offered before or after the Fardh prayers. The number of rakaats varies from one prayer to another. This can be illustrated by the table below:

Fardh swalat	Number of rakaat before	Number of rakaat after
Fajr	2	None
Dhuhr	2	2
Asr	None	None
Maghrib	None	2
Isha	2	2

TWAHARA

The term twahara is Arabicword which means cleanliness.It is used in Islam to imply a state of ritual purity. This is a requirement in the observance of the acts of worship mention other instances where a muslim is require to be pure.

Ritual purity is attained through three ways;Ghusl(ritual bath),udhu(ablution)and tayammum(dry



ablution) Let us now discuss each of the three ways:

Ghusl

It's a form of a ritual bath which involves the washing of a whole body. The following conditions make it compulsory for a muslim to perform ghusl:

- ☐ After sexual intercourse
- ☐ After completing menstruation (Heidh)
- ☐ Immediately after giving birth.
- When a person dies it's the duty of the Muslims to wash the body.
- ☐ After completing the post birth bleeding (Nifas)
- ☐ Ejeculation of sperms when one is asleep or awake.

There Are other instances when the ritual Baath becomes optional. Can you mention any of them? Let us consider the following occasions:

- ☐ Before going for Friday prayers.
- ☐ Before going for the two Idd prayers (Idd ul adha and Idd ul Fitr)
- ☐ After washing the deadbody.
- ☐ When a non Muslim converts to Islam.
- ☐ Before performing prayers for the rain.
- ☐ Before praying holy city of Makka.
- ☐ Before standing at Arafat during Hajj.



- ☐ Before going round the Kaaba.
- Before running between the two hillocks of swafa and marwa(Sa'i)
- ☐ Before entering the Holy city of Madina.
- ☐ Before throwing pebbles at Mina during the three days.

Steps of performing ghusl.

There are several essential steps that are followed in performing ghusl. These steps are also referred to as **fardh** or integral steps and must be followed for ones Ghusl to be valid. These include the following:

- ☐ Niyyat (Intention)
 - you must declare your intention of cleansing to seek Allah's pleasure and to perform the acts of worship.
- ☐ Removal of impurities. These are those substances that block the penetration of water into the skin. Can you give examples of such impurities?
- ☐ Ensuring that water reaches all the parts of the body from the head to the toe.

Sunna acts of Ghusl

Apart from the Fardh steps, we have some acts that are included in the performance of ghusl but are not compulsory. These are termed as sunnah or optional acts of ghusl and include the following:

- ☐ Starting with the basmallah
- ☐ Performing ghusl.
- ☐ Washing the whole body three times.



- ☐ Passing the hands all over the body.
- ☐ Starting from the right then left.
- ☐ Reciting a dua after Ghusl.

Acts forbidden while in the state of janaba(impurity)

Even though the performance of the acts of Ibada earns a Muslim reward, in the state of ritual impurity, it is forbidden for a muslim to indulge in the following:

- ☐ Recitation of Quran
- ☐ Performing of prayers
- ☐ Entering the mosque
- ☐ Touching the Quran
- ☐ Performing Tawaff during Hajj.
- ☐ In addition, a woman in menstruation is forbidden to perform the following acts:
 - ☐ Recitation of the Quran.
 - ☐ Holding or touching Quran.
 - ☐ Performing swalat
 - ☐ Observing any types of fast whether Fardh or Sunnah.
 - ☐ Having sexual relations with the husband.



- ☐ Entering the mosque.
- ☐ To be divorced.
- ☐ To perform tawwaf.

***Wudhu'* Read [Q: 5:6]**

When you go to any mosque, you will notice people sitting or standing where there are water points or taps performing some preparations for prayers (swalat). Have you ever asked yourself why they do so? The reason is for purification. You can remember what we learnt about Twahara. What did we say about it? In this section, we shall look at wudhu as another way of attaining purity (Twahara).

Wudhu therefore is an Arabic word which means ablution. It involves washing one's face, hands, head and feet in order to perform the acts of ibada. There are essential steps of performing Wudhu.

Essential steps of wudhu

These are fardh or obligatory acts. They must be observed by whoever is performing wudhu. Failure to observe any of them will consequently render the process incomplete and your prayers null and void. A muslim must therefore follow the following steps while performing Wudhu:

- Making the intention to perform wudhu'.
 - ☐ Washing the face from the top of the forehead to the chin and between the two ear lobes.
 - ☐ Washing both arms up to and including the elbows.
 - ☐ Wiping a part of the head with wet hands.
 - ☐ Washing both feet up to and including the ankles.
 - ☐ Following the prescribed sequence without inter-changing any step.

Optional steps of performing wudhu

In the performance of Wudhu, we have some steps that we observe and have not been mentioned in the above essentials. Could you mention any of these to your friend? The performance of these acts is considered as following the example of our Prophet (P.B.U.H). They are referred to as the sunna acts of wudhu and include the following:



- Reciting: “*Bismillahir-Rahmanir-Rahim*” (in the Name of aod, the All-Merciful, and the All-Compassionate) before you starttaking wudhu.
- ☐ Brushing of the teeth.
- ☐ Washing the palms up to the wrists three times, including the parts between the fingers.
- ☐ Cleaningthemouth with a brush or a finger and gargling three times.
- ☐ Rinsing the nostrils three times.
- ☐ Passing ones wet fingers through the beards.
- ☐ To run water through ones fingers and toes.
- ☐ Performingeach act three times.
- ☐ Starting with the right hand side before the left.
- ☐ Wiping the whole head and the back of the neck
- ☐ Wiping the ears in and out.
- ☐ Taking the entire udhu at once without breaking.
- ☐ Reciting dua during and after Wudhu.
- ☐ Performing the acts systematically.
- ☐ Washing the parts one after the other without pausing, so that no part dries up before completion of wudhu.
- ☐ Facing the direction of Qibla during the performance of wudhu.

Recommended acts (mustahab) of wudhu

- ☐ Reciting the kalima(shahada)after ablution.
- ☐ Avoiding worldly talk during the time for wudhu.
- ☐ Avoiding extravagance (wasting water) during ablution.
- ☐ Choosing a clean place for the performance of wudhu.

Nullifiers of wudhu

Wudhu is meant for perfomance of the acts of worship. A Muslim preparing for prayers can perform wudhu and sustain it for the swalat of the rest of the day. However, there are certain acts that invalidate wudhu (often referred to as "breaking wudhu").It is therefore important to note that the absence of wudhu will imply that those intended acts of worship will not be valid.We must therefore



have the knowledge of the things that will 'break wudhu'. These are what we refer to as nullifiers. The following are among the acts that nullify *wudhu*:

1. Coming out of either solid, liquid or gas/wind from the two private parts (front and back)
2. Emission of blood, pus or yellow matter from a wound, boil, pimple, or something similar to such an extent that it flows beyond the wound's mouth.
3. Vomiting a mouthful of matter.
4. Physical contact for pleasure between men and women without any obstacle (e.g., clothes).
5. Loss of consciousness through sleep, drowsiness, and any such condition that may affect the proper functioning of the mind.
6. Temporary insanity, fainting, hysteria, or intoxication.
7. Touching the private parts with bare hands (without any barrier)

Tayammum

Supposing you were travelling and the time of prayer finds you at a place where there is no water, How would you purify yourself for Swalat? Taking into consideration that swalat is a must for a muslim and is performed at prescribed times; Allah (S.W.T) has given a solution to such an eventuality in the Quran. Almighty Allah (S.W.T) says: ***"...But if you are ill, or on a journey, or one of you comes from offices of nature, or you have been in contact with women and you find no water, then take for yourselves clean sand or earth and rub therewith your faces and hands. Allah does not wish to place you in a difficulty, but to make you clean..."*** [Q:5:6]

In reference to this verse, the use of clean sand for purification in preparation for swalat is referred to as tayammum.

Even though the word tayammum literally means an aim or a purpose, in this context it refers to dry ablution where clean sand is used to wipe the face and the limbs as an alternative of wudhu'.

Hudhaifa (R.A) narrated that the Messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) said: *"And the soil of the earth has*



been made for us as a means with which to purify ourselves (for prayer) when we cannot find water.”
(Muslim)

Reasons for performing Tayammum

Even though the sharia allows the use of pure sand for purification, it is only permissible on specific occasions. These occasions may be necessitated by the following reasons:

1. In case there is scarcity of water. This is when there is acute shortage of water or the available water is insufficient for performing ablution.
2. For health reasons. If one is injured or ill and fears that use of water will worsen the condition.
3. If the water is too cold and it is likely to cause physical harm to the user.
4. If the process of getting water is dangerous or life threatening.
5. When the available water is reserved for domestic use.
6. Fear of missing a prayer by the time one gets to the source of water.
7. If the available water is impure.

Conditions of tayammum

When performing Tayammum, you should consider the following three conditions:

1. One must use clean sand.
2. It should be performed at the time of that particular prayer.
3. The tayammum of one prayer ends at the termination of that particular prayer e.g. one cannot use tayammum of Dhuhr for another prayer.

Essential steps of tayammum.

Besides the three conditions of performing Tayammum, the following steps should be followed while in the actual process:

1. You must make the intention of performing tayammum.
2. Strike the first heap of pure soil lightly with the palms of both hands and passing the palms over the face one time.
3. Strike the second heap of pure soil with one's palms and rubbing the right and left arms



alternately from the fingertips to the elbows.

4. Follow the order above.

Nullifiers of tayammum.

As you learnt earlier, wudhu can be nullified by certain acts. Do you remember some of these acts?

Similarly, there are acts that if done will nullify tayammum. These acts include the following:

1. All that nullifies wudhu will also nullify tayammum.
2. As soon as the cause for performing it is removed (i.e., the sick person recovers or pure water is found).
3. Performance of fardh prayer. A Muslim is not supposed to perform two fardh prayers with the same tayammum.
4. When one denounces Islam.

Significance of Swalat- (Prayers)

As already seen, Swalat is the second pillar of Islam. It is a practical pillar since it must be observed by following specific steps. The entire process of swalat which starts right from purification to its actual performance leaves a positive impact on the Muslim and society at large. What is the importance of swalat to you as a Muslim? How different is a society in which prayers are offered from one in which they are not? In this section, we shall look at how prayers benefit the society both spiritually and socially.

Social Benefits

- It trains a Muslim to avoid evil and shameful deeds. Allah(S.W.T) says ***“and established regular prayer for prayer restrains from shameful and evil deeds.”***[Q: 29:45]
- Prayer is a means of leveling all differences of rank, creed, color, status and nationality, thus promoting equality. This is achieved through the use of similar facilities by all, standing side by side during swalat regardless of the differences in status, race or rank.
- Promotes leadership qualities. For example the choosing of an Imam among the Muslims who is given and respect honor by all.
- It encourages a Muslim to enjoin good and forbid evil.
- It brings cohesion and unity among Muslim who will meet at the mosque frequently thus renewing their friendship.



- It encourages a Muslim to be timeconscious since each prayer is conducted at a prescribed time; you are expected to arrive in the mosque or area of conducting the prayers in good time.
- It instills self-respect, self-discipline, self-control, love, peace and harmony.

Spiritual Benefits

- It is the second pillar of Islam which therefore be observed by every Muslim.
- It makes a Muslim realize his duty is to worship Allah (S.W.T) alone. Allah (S.W.T) says: ***“Verily I am Allah; there is no God but I: So serve non other than Me (only) and establish regular player for my remembrance.”***[Q:20:40]
- It is a sign of obedience for all those who perform prayers since it is a command from Allah.
- Is a means through which Muslims communicate directly to God thus discouraging polytheism (shirk).
- Prayers distinguish believers from non-believers since they are only performed by those who believe in Allah (S.W.T) and if performed by the non believer, then it does not become acceptable.

Swalat ul jamaa

Prayers are offered either individually or in congregation. When offered in congregation, it is referred to as Swalat ul Jamaa. It is the performance of prayers together by more than one person. Mention any prayers that are offered collectively. There are several prayers that are performed in congregation, these include the five daily prayers, Friday noon prayers, prayers during eclipse (solar and lunar), the two Idd prayers (Al Fitri and Al Adha), swalatul Janaza (funeral prayers) and Al Istisqai (prayer for seeking rain).

Conditions for Jamaa prayer.

You must have noted during the performance of prayers in congregation, there are certain things that should be observed. Below, we are going to explain to you some of these conditions which you may have performed unknowingly in your mosque or when you were attending a swalat in Jamaa.

- It should be conducted at an accessible place where anybody is not deprived of the chance to attend it i.e. the place should be open and accessible to all.
- The place should be such that people are neither shy nor scared from entering or



attending.

- Performing Jamaa with one's family is highly recommended because it gives a chance to teach the young members how to pray. It encourages members of the family to perform prayers without laziness and enables the head of the family to monitor the attitudes of the family members.
- The Imam should understand the steps to be followed and he should follow them.
- Both the imam and the followers must be at the same place. The followers in two mosques can not be led by the same Imam.
- The followers should not perform any step before the Imam for example one should follow the Imam when going for rukuu, sijda or any other step.
- A female Imam can only be allowed when leading other females otherwise she can neither lead males nor a congregation of both males and females. Generally, the women are not as compelled to perform Jamaa prayers as males because of their roles as mothers and caretakers of the family.
- A non Muslim is not allowed to lead a congregation prayer even if he is knowledgeable and there is no one to lead prayers.
- An insane cannot lead prayers. This is so because he might not comprehend the pronunciation of words and format of the prayer.
- When leading the prayers, the Imam should pronounce the words clearly without substituting the sounds and syllables.
- The Imam should be more knowledgeable over the rest in Fiqh (Islamic Jurisprudence) and aspects of swalat, among other branches of Islamic knowledge. When there is more than one knowledgeable person, other attributes like piety should be considered. Where all of them are pious, then the oldest can be made the Imam.

Importance of swalat ul jamaa

In most communities you will observe that members are encouraged to do most of the activities together and in unity. Usually success is achieved when things are done in unity thus the Swahili proverb; *umoja ni nguvu utengano ni udhaifu* (unity is strength). Can you mention some of the



activities that are done communally in your society? Similarly, in Islam the prophet (P.B.U.H) highly recommended the Jamaat prayers as stated in the following hadiths:

Abu Huraira (R.A) narrated that a blind man came to the prophet (P.B.U.H) and said to him, *“O messenger of Allah, I have no one to guide me to the mosque.”* (He was asking for the permission of the prophet to pray in his house) the prophet (P.B.U.H) gave him permission to pray at home, but when he turned to go back, the prophet called him and said, *“do you hear the Adhan?”* the blind man said, *“Yes”* the prophet then said, *“then respond to it (by coming to the mosque)”* (related by Muslim.)

Ibn Abbas (R.A) narrated that the messenger of Allah said, *“If any one hears the Adhan but does not come to the congregational prayer, the prayer he offers will not be accepted unless he has an excuse”* (Ibn Ma’ja, Ibn Hiban, Al Hakim)

The above two hadith can briefly illustrate to us how the prophet laid emphasis on the observance of prayers in Jamaa. Let us also consider the following benefits of Jamaa prayers:

1. Muslims have a chance of converging five times a day to cement their brotherhood when the prayers are performed at the mosque behind the Imam.
2. One can unite his family members and monitor their performance in ibadah by performing prayers with them in Jamaa.
3. Muslims learn from others how to perform prayers correctly. This is of specific importance to children and new converts who need to learn religious practices from others who are experienced.
4. It promotes confidence in performance of prayers.
5. It promotes discipline since the maamum are not supposed to precede the Imam. Such discipline makes and proves the Islamic system of worship to be orderly.
6. It promotes strictness and concentration.
7. Develops and promotes leadership qualities. For example the selection of one of the members to be an imam shows respect and honor accorded to him.
8. The reward for Jamaa prayer is twenty seven times more than praying alone.
9. It promotes Muslims of different social, political, economic and professional background keep off their differences and converge together for prayers.

Prayers for special occasion



Even though we have prayers prescribed for particular times, Islam gives room for certain prayers to be offered during special occasions. Can you mention any prayers that are offered at times other than the time for the normal daily prayers? How differently are these prayers performed? In addition to what you have mentioned we shall consider the following as special occasions:

Swalatul Musafir: (Prayer of a Traveler)

Read [Q:4:101]

In normal life situation people travel from one place to another for various reasons. Suggest some of the reasons as to why people travel. At one point you must have also travelled from your home area to another place, either far or near. Can you recall the furthest place you have travelled to?

In Arabic language, a traveler is known as a musafir. But in the context of special prayer, a musafir is a Muslim who sets out intending to travel for more than 77 kilometers regardless of the mode of transport. He is regarded a musafir the moment he comes out of the boundaries of his town or city.

During traveling, a muslim may not be in a position to offer the prayers in the normal way due to the conditions experienced in the journey. Allah (S.W.T) Has not left out his favors and has given the Muslim traveler privileges which include swalatul Musafir. This prayer can be performed in three ways. These are: Jamu' Taqdim, Jamu' Taakhir and Qasr.

Allah says ***“When you travel through the earth, there is no blame on you if you shorten the prayers, for fear the unbelievers may attack you: For the unbelievers are unto enemies.”*** [Q 4:101]

Jamu' Taqdim

This is to bring forward a prayer e.g. to bring forward Asr and pray it at Dhuhr time.

Muadh (R.A) narrated, *“We set out with the prophet on the expedition of Tabuk and he combined Dhuhr and Asr together...”* (Muslim)

Jamu' Taakhir

This is delaying of one prayer and performing it at the time of the next prayer. For example, delaying Dhuhr and then performing it with Asr during Asr time. Anas (R.A) narrated that: *“Whenever the messenger of Allah started on a journey before the sun had passed its meridian (before noon) he would delay the Dhuhr prayer till the time of Asr...”* (Bukhari and Muslim)

Qasr

It is the shortening of the 4 rakaats prayer to perform then in two rakats. For example, Dhuhr, Asr and Isha can all be shortened to two rakaats.



There is no reduction of rakaats for the fajr and maghrib swalaats. One has to offer them completely as he normally does.

Anas (R.A) narrated: *“We travelled with the prophet from Madina to Makka and he used to pray two rakaat prayers until we returned to Madina.”* (Bukhari and Muslim)

Other prayers for special occasions include the following;

Kusuf wal Khusuf

Have you ever witnessed either of the eclipses? What do you normally do when there is an eclipse of the sun or the moon? Are you aware that Islam has offered a clear and definite practice to be done during any of the eclipses? This is by performing two rakaat prayers.

Aisha(RA) Narrated that , *“ The messenger of Allah recited the Quran aloud during the eclipse prayer and performed a total of two rakaat ”* (Bukhari and Muslim)

Swalatul Istisqa’a

Allah (S.W.T) has created different seasons like summer, winter, spring and autumn. Some of these seasons are favourable to man while others are harsh. These seasons are associated with different conditions. Among these conditions is drought. Have you ever experienced a drought condition? What practices do the members of your community perform to ward off the drought? You will realize that most communities offer sacrifices and prayers to their ancestors and other creatures besides Allah(S.W.T). This is shirk and is totally forbidden in Islam. In the event of a drought, Islam prescribes a special prayer to be performed. This prayer is referred to as Swalatul Istisqa’a, which is a two rakaat congregational prayer is offered.

Anas (RA) narrated that, *“The messenger of Allah supplicated Allah for rain and he pointed with the back of his hand to the sky.”* (Muslim)

Swalatul Eid

There are two Eid prayers which are performed in two different occasions;

- a) Idd-ul Fitr: It is a two rakaat prayer performed to mark the end of the month of Ramadhan.
- b) Idd-ul Adha: It is a two rakaat prayer performed on the tenth of Dhul Hijja to mark the end of the activities of Hajj.

Aisha (R.A) narrated that, the messenger of Allah said, *“Breaking the fast at the end of Ramadhan is (determined) when people break their fast and Idd ul Adha (the Idd of sacrifice) is determined when*



people offer their sacrifices.” (At-Tirmidhy)

Swalatul JanaizaFuneral Prayer:

Can you recall one of the fardh al kifaya prayers which must be performed by at least one Muslim in the community? Salatul Janazah is Fardh Kafayah, that is, if one performs the prayer then all are free of the responsibility. Jamma (congregation) is not a condition for this prayer as it is sufficient even if one person prays. This is a prayer performed for the dead. When a muslim passes on, it is the responsibility of those who are around him during the time of his or her death to wash the body and pray for it. On the prayer of Janaiza, Aisha (R.A) narrated, *“By Allah, the messenger of Allah offered funeral prayer in mosque for the sons of Baida’ (Sahl and Suhail).”* [Muslim]

There are two parts of this Prayer:

- ☐ To say Allahu Akbar
- ☐ Qiyam, which has three sunna Muaqada: Sana, Durood and Duaa for the deceased

How to perform swalatul Janaza

1. Niyat: The performer should make the intention, “I make the niyyat for the prayer of this janaza for Allah, dua for this deceased, behind this imam.”
2. Takbiratul-Ihram: The performers should raise their hands to their ears and fold their hands underneath the navel as usual whilst saying Allahu Akbar and read Sana,

Sana:

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ وَتَبَارَكَ اسْمُكَ وَتَعَالَى جَدُّكَ وَجَلَّ ثَنَاءُكَ وَلَا إِلَهَ غَيْرُكَ.

Glory be to You Oh Allah, and praise be to You, and blessed is Your name, and exalted is Your Majesty, and there is none to be served besides You.

3. Then raise the hands, say Allahu Akbar and read the duroode Ibraheem;

Duroode Ibraheemi:

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ
 مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ
 إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مُجِيدٌ
 اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ
 كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ
 إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مُجِيدٌ

O Allah! Shower Your mercy upon Muhammad and the followers of Muhammad, as You showered Your mercy upon Ibrahim and the followers of Ibrahim. Behold, You are Praiseworthy, Glorious.

Oh Allah! Shower Your blessing upon Muhammad, and the followers of Muhammad as You showered Your blessings upon Ibrahim and the followers of Ibrahim. Behold, You are Praiseworthy, Glorious.

4. Then raise the hands, say Allahu Akbar and read the duaa.

Duaa for an adult man or woman:

اللَّهُمَّ اغْفِرْ لِحَيِّنَا وَمَيِّتِنَا وَشَاهِدِنَا وَغَائِبِنَا
 وَصَغِيرِنَا وَكَبِيرِنَا وَذَكَرِنَا وَأُنْثَيْنَا اللَّهُمَّ مَنْ
 أَحْيَيْتَهُ مِنَّا فَأَحْيِهِ عَلَى الْإِسْلَامِ وَمَنْ
 تَوَفَّيْتَهُ مِنَّا فَتَوَفَّهُ عَلَى الْإِيمَانِ

Oh Allah! Forgive those of us that are alive and those of us that are dead; those of us that are present



and those of us who are absent; those of us who are young and those of us who are adults; our males and our females. Oh Allah! Whomsoever You keep alive let him live as a follower of Islam and whomsoever You cause to die, let him die a Believer.

Duaa for a boy:

اللَّهُمَّ اجْعَلْهُ لَنَا فَرَطًا وَاجْعَلْهُ لَنَا آجُرًا وَذُخْرًا وَاجْعَلْهُ لَنَا شَافِعًا وَمُشَفَّعًا

Oh! Allah, make him (this child) a source for our salvation and make him a source of reward and treasure for us and make him an intercessor for us and one whose intercession is accepted.

Duaa for a girl:

اللَّهُمَّ اجْعَلْهَا لَنَا فَرَطًا وَاجْعَلْهَا لَنَا آجُرًا وَذُخْرًا وَاجْعَلْهَا لَنَا شَافِعَةً وَمُشَفَّعَةً

Oh! Allah, make her (this child) a source for our salvation and make her a source of reward and treasure for us and make her an intercessor for us and one whose intercession is accepted.

5. After the dua, say Allahu Akbar, drop the hands and then turn the head both sides for salaam.

Sijdat

Demonstration of a worshipper in the sujuud position.



Read [Q 7:206]; [Q:19:58];[Q:25:60];[Q:32:15];[Q:84:21]

Can you identify one thing that is common in all the verses you have read? It is evident that all these verses mention the word *sujdah*. Sujdah is a very important act of worship in the life of a Muslim and that is why several verses of the Quran mention it. You will also observe that sujdah is part of the obligatory steps in *salat*.

Sujdah is an act of worship which involves prostration and glorification whereby the forehead, palms and the knees firmly touch the ground facing the direction of the Qibla.

Narrated al-Bara' bin A-zib (R.A) that the messenger of Allah said, “*Whenever you **prostrate** place the palms of your hand (on the ground) and raise your elbows.*” (Muslim)

Types of Sujdahs

Besides sujdah during *salat*, there are other three types of Sujdah namely:-

- Sujdatul Tilawa
- Sujdatul Shukr
- Sujdatul Sahw

Sijdatul Tilawa

Earlier in this section, we have learnt that there are several verses in the Quran that mention the word sijda. What do you do when you come across these verses? Definitely you will have to pause and prostrate then continue with your recitation. This prostration is what is referred to as Tilawa.

There are fourteen places of prostration in the Holy Quran as agreed upon by all the Muslim religious scholars, while Imam Shafi suggests prostration at Quran 22:77 to make them a total of fifteen.

Allah says in the Quran, *“But fall ye down in prostration to Allah and adore Him.”* [Q 53:62]

Ibn Abbas(RA) narrated, *“the messenger of Allah prostrated when he recited suratul Najm [Q: 13]”*

Quotation of verses in the quran that require prostration

NAME OF SURAH	NUMBER OF SURAH	NUMBER OF VERSE	THE WORD
Al-A'raf	7	206	Walahu Yasjuduuna
Ar-Rad	13	15	Walillaahi yasjudu
An-Nahl	16	49	Walillaahi yasjudu
Al-Isra	17	107	Yakhirruuna lil adhqaani sujjadaa
Maryam	19	58	Kharruu sujjadan
Al-Hajj	22	18	Yasjudu lahu
Al-Hajj	22	77*	Wasjuduu wa'buduu
Al-Furqaan	25	60	Wa idha qiila Lahumus juduu
An-Naml	27	25	Al-la yasjuduu lillaahi
As-Sajda	32	15	Kharruu sujjadan
Sad	38	24	Kharraraaki' an
Fussilat	41	37	Wasjuduu lillaahi
An-Najm	53	62	fasjuduu lillaahi
Al-Inshiqaq	84	21	Laa yasjuduun
Al-Alaq	96	19	Wasjud



Sijdatul Sahw

Human beings have a tendency of forgetting. At times we forget and even skip certain steps during the performance of swalat. In such an eventuality, what do you do?

Whenever a worshipper omits by forgetting to perform an important pillar of swalat (Arkanu swalat) he is supposed to perform sijdatu-Sahwi (prostration for forgetfulness)

This type of sijda is usually performed in swalat before the first salaam and just like the ordinary prostration. For example, if one forgets to perform the ruku', or sijdah or any other pillar of swalat.

Imran bin al-Hussein (R.A) *narrated the messenger of Allah led them in prayer and forgot (to do something) so he made two prostrations and recited the tashahud and then said the Tasleem.* (Abu Dawoud and At-Tirmidhy)

Sijdatul Shukr

Muslims should always be grateful and thankful to Allah (S.W.T) Prostration is one of the ways of showing gratitude to Allah (S.W.T). This type of sijda is performed for the purposes of showing ones gratefulness and appreciation towards Allah after attaining any good thing e.g. passing of examinations, getting a new born baby is a way of thanking Allah. It can be performed in any place that is clean.

Abu Bakar (R.A) narrated, "Whenever the prophet received something which pleased him, he would make the Sajda in gratitude to Allah" (Related by the six Imams except An-Nasai)

5.00 ZAKAT

Meaning of zakat

Every society will have people who are well off and those who need assistance. Have you met people who may be friends, relatives, neighbours or even strangers and they needed your help? How did you react to their request? In many cases, every society will have its own way of dealing with such situations. Islam as a complete way of life has not been left behind. The plight of the poor and the needy has been well taken care of by the institution of Zakat. It is one of the major religious duties and the third pillar in Islam. Zakat was made obligatory on *Ummahs* of all prophets even before Prophet Mohammad (P.B.U.H) this is evident when we look into the Holy Quran where we see that from ancient times Salah and Zakat were ordained as compulsory. For example, there is mentioning about Prophet Ibrahim and the Prophets of his race when Allah says in the Quran:



"And We made them leaders of men. They guided the people according to Our command, and We inspired in them the doing of good deeds and right establishment of Salah and giving of Zakat and they were worshippers of Us." [Q: 21:73]

About Prophet Ismael it is said:

"He enjoined upon his people Salah and Zakat and was acceptable in the sight of his Lord." [Q: 19:55]

Prophet Moses prayed for his ummah:

"O God! Bestow upon us the well-being of this world as also the well-being of the Hereafter."

Do you know in reply to it what Allah answered?

"I shall smite with my punishment whom I will. Although My mercy embraced all things, but I shall ordain it for those who will fear Me and give Zakat and those who will believe in Our revelations." [Q: 7:156]

"And Allah said: 'O Children of Israel! I am with you, if you offer Salah, and give Zakat and believe in My messengers and support those messengers who are to come, and lend unto Allah a nice loan surely I shall remit your sins.' " [Q: 5:12]

Before Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) the last Prophet was Prophet Issa. The commandment about Salah and Zakat was given to him also by Allah, as is found in Suratul-Mariam:

"And hath made me blessed wheresoever I may be, and hath enjoined upon me Salah and Zakat so long as I remain alive." [Q: 19:31]

This shows that the religion of Islam has been established from the beginning, in the ministry of every prophet, on the two great pillars of Salah and Zakat, and it never happened that any Ummah believing in Allah (S.W.T) was exempted from these two obligatory duties.

Let us now define Zakat.

Literally the term Zakat is Arabic word which means both 'purification' and 'growth'. It refers to the purification of a believer's wealth and soul. Wealth purification denotes the mobilization of assets for



the purpose of financial growth and justified distribution. Purification of the soul implies freedom from hatred, jealousy, selfishness, uneasiness and greed. Almighty Allah (S.W.T) says, ***“And be steadfast in prayer; practice regular charity; and bow down your heads with those who bow down (in worship).”***[Q: 2:43]

Technically, it involves distributing a portion of one's wealth to those prescribed by the Quran. Other Quranic connotations also include the purification of sin. It is one of the most important principles of Islam and the third pillar.

Allah (S.W.T) says, ***“And they have been commanded No more than this: To worship Allah, Offering Him sincere devotion, being true in (faith); to establish regular prayers; And to practice regular charity; and that is the religion Right and Straight.”***[Q: 98:5]

There are three types of Zakat namely; Zakatul Maal, Zakatul-Fitr and Sadaqa.

Zakatul-maal

Zakat-ul-Maal is the obligatory charity paid by an individual to the needy from the property which he possesses. It is obligatory on an individual who possesses wealth equal to or above a minimum amount called Nisab for an entire lunar year. For the purpose of calculating Zakat, different categories of wealth are defined, this shall be demonstrated by the table (on page _____) on specific items on which Zakat is payable.

In terms of Islamic jurisprudence (Fiqh), Zakatul-Maal is an obligatory duty (Fardh) on every Muslim possessing wealth equal to or exceeding the prescribed amount of Nisab. It is a prescribed welfare-contribution from one's stored wealth. It is the right of Allah (S.W.T) on a Muslim's wealth. Paying Zakat-ul-Maal is the responsibility of the owner. If one fails to carry out this obligation, he is a sinner, consequently incurring Allah's displeasure and His punishment in the hereafter.

Zakat-ul-fitr



Zakatu-ul-Fitr is Zakat on the individual. It is a special charity paid to the needy on or before the day of Eid -ul-Fitr, which is the first day of the month of Shawwal following the month of Ramadhan. Zakat-ul-Fitr is paid as atonement for any shortcomings in the worship of Fasting during the month of Ramadan.

On the day of Eid -ul-Fitr, which marks the completion of the month of Ramadhan, every Muslim possessing an amount of food in excess of his family's need for a day (24 hours) is mandated to pay Zakat-ul-Fitr on his own behalf and for all his dependent(s). Zakat-ul-Fitr or Fitrāh is "the one full meal per person or cash equivalent to the cost of one full meal, given directly to the needy of the community before Eid-ul-Fitr prayer. Arrangements for paying Fitrāh should be made ahead of time so that it reaches the eligible recipients in time for them to make use of it on Eid day. The quantity of Zakat-ul-Fitr traditionally amounts to one Sa', which is equivalent to 2½ kilograms of food such as wheat, barley, rice, or the like.

Ibn Abbas (RA) narrated that, "The messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) enjoined Zakatul Fitr on the one who fasts in the month of Ramadhan to purify him from any indecent act or speech and for the purpose of providing food for the needy... (Abu Aawoud and Ibn Ma'jah)

SADAQAH

Sadaqah is an Arabic term widely used to cover all kinds of charity.

Although Sadaqah and Zakat are often used interchangeably, Sadaqah implies voluntary charity and is not limited to giving out money or food.

All good deeds are considered Sadaqah and are rewarded by Allah (S.W.T). These even include practices that may look simple such as removing a thorn from the path, helping the old to cross a busy road among others. Every Muslim is exhorted to give Sadaqah.

The Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) said: "*Every Muslim has to give Sadaqah.*" The people asked: "*O Prophet of Allah, what about the one who has nothing?*" He replied: "*He should work with his hand to give Sadaqah.*" They asked: "*If he cannot find (work)?*" He replied: "*He should help the needy who ask for help.*" They asked: "*If he cannot do that?*" He replied: "*He should then do good deeds and shun evil, for this will be taken as Sadaqah.*" (Sahih al-Bukhari)



Muslims practice charity and earn rewards from Allah (S.W.T) by doing good deeds all their lives. They can continue earning Allah's rewards even after their death. This is called perpetual Sadaqah (sadaqatul-Jariyah). Abu Hurayra (R.A) narrated that the Messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) said, "When the son of Adam dies, his actions are cut off except for three: Sadaqah Jariyah (on-going charity), knowledge which brought benefit, and a virtuous son who makes supplication for him." [Muslim]

Sadaqah Jariyah means Continuous Alms/Charity. A continuous charity is an action that someone does that remains active even after the person is dead. For example, if a person digs a well then people can use it for a very long time - even after the person dies. This type of charity is very effective and serves better than just giving money as the person who initiated the action will get thawab even after he dies.

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN ZAKAT AND SADAQAH

ZAKAT	SADAQA
Zakat is a pillar of Islam	Sadaqah is an act of charity.
Zakat has a nisab- (the minimum amount one must have before it becomes compulsory.)	Sadaqah has no minimum amount.
There is a fixed amount to be paid on the saved money or cash.	Any amount can be given as sadaqa.
Zakat is paid on specific and particular items.	Sadaqah is paid on anything one wish to give from.
There is fixed period within which one must pay Zakat.	Sadaqah can be paid at any time.
Zakat is payable to specific recipients mentioned in the Quran.	Sadaqah can be given to any person in need whether a Muslim or a non Muslim.



Zakat is compulsory to the Muslims who qualify to pay it.	Sadaqah is voluntary to whoever wishes to give it.
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Conditions for zakat payment

Even though payment of Zakat is a must to the able Muslims, certain conditions have to be observed.

These include the following:

- i. One paying it must be a Muslim.
- ii. One must be a free man and not a slave.
- iii. One must be of sound mind (sane.)
- iv. The giver of Zakat must have attained maturity.
- v. The wealth to be paid should have reached nisab.
- vi. The wealth or property must have been in ones possession for a full year.
- vii. Zakat-ul- Fitr should be paid before one goes for the Eid prayers.

Differences between Zakat-ul-Fitr and Zakat-ul-Maal

	Zakaat-ul –Maal	Zakaat-ul- Fitr
1	The wealth must have been in Possession for one year.	It should be given in the month of Ramadhan before one goes for Idd Prayers.
2	The rate should be calculated according to the property to be given out.	It should be given on 2 ¹ / ₂ kg of the staple food
3	It should be given to recipient prescribed in the Quran.	It can be given to any needy or destitute Muslim
4	One may also give in the form of cash.	This must represent the exact equivalent of the market value of the kind and quality of the staple food which would have otherwise been offered. e.g.



		cash, animals,minerals,fruits among others.
5	The nisab depends on the amount of wealth.	The value is determined by the number of dependants in the family.
6	It purifies wealth	It purifies saum
7	It is given at any time of the year when it is due.	Given only in the month of Ramadhan

Condition for distribution of zakat

During the distribution of Zakat, it is very important that it is done according to the sharia. The following conditions should be considered:

1. The intention (Niyyat) should be for the sake of fulfilling Allah's command and not for any other reasons.
2. It should be given to the recipients prescribed by the Quran.
3. It should be given promptly, when it is due.
4. Zakat of one place should not be transferred to another place.
5. The item payable for Zakat should not be exchanged for another item. For example it is permissible to use the nisab for animals when you are supposed to pay zakat for minerals but one can convert the cows into currency and then a rate of the currency is given out for Zakat.

Items on which zakat is payable

1. Domestic animals such as camels, sheep, oxen which are not kept as articles of trade.
2. Agricultural produce such crops and fruits of the field like wheat, barley, dates, raisins, rice, maize and vegetables.
3. Gold, silver and other mineral products.
4. Dug out treasures whose ownership has not been identified for one year.
5. Trade and merchandise (goods for trade)
6. Savings from the sale of goods should be paid for Zakat after a year.
7. Savings from the house rent and land rates.
8. Personal income.



INSERT NISAB RATES FROM INTERNET

Agricultural produce				

Items on which Zakat is not payable

Even though Zakat is an obligatory Pillar in Islam and that one has to pay, there are certain items which a Muslim is not supposed to give. These items include the following:

- a. Private houses in which the owner dwells in.
- b. Animals used for transportation.
- c. Furniture, clothing Weapons or tools for daily use.
- d. Books which are not for sale.
- e. Jewellery or ornaments which have not reached nisab.
- f. Machinery used for manufacture of goods.

(d) Recipients of Zakat

There are those people whom the Quran has singled out to be the rightful beneficiaries of Zakat. The Quran has identified a list of deserving persons to whom Zakat should be given.

Allah says ***“Alms are for the poor and the needy, and those employed to administer the (funds); For those whose hearts have been recently reconciled to the truth; and for those in bondage and in debt; in the course of Allah; and for the wayfarer:”*** (Thus is it) ordained by Allah, and Allah is full of knowledge and wisdom.” [Q: 9:60]

According to the above verse the recipients of Zakat are as follows:

1. The poor (Fuqara)



These are the Muslims who do not have any means of livelihood and material possession to support themselves and their families.

2. The needy(Masaakin)
These are the Muslims who lack sufficient means of livelihood to meet their basic requirements.
3. Zakat collectors(Aamil)
They are the Muslims who have been entrusted with the responsibility of collecting and distributing Zakat.They receive it as their source of income.
4. The new converts(Mualaf)
They are also referred to as sympathizers. They are the people who have just embraced Islam and need help to settle down and strengthen their faith.
5. The captives(Riqab)
These are prisoners of war or hostages who need to be ransomed in order to secure their freedom.
6. Debtors(Gharimin)
These are Muslims who have incurred debts through halal transactions. Zakat can be used to pay off there debts which they incurred to meettheir basic needs.
7. Those on the course of Allah(Fisabillillah)
Zakat can be used to finance any form of struggle or course for the love of Allah (S.W.T) such as aa'wa.sponsering students educational expence among others.
8. The wayfarers(Ibnu Sabil)
These are stranded travelers on lawful journey who are in difficulty and may need assistance to cater for their travel and basic needs.



Importance of Zakat.

Allah (S.W.T) has prescribed the pillars in Islam for the benefit of humankind. These benefits include social, spiritual and even economical. Let us now look at the importance of Zakat.

Spiritual Importance of Zakat.

1. A believer gets rewards by fulfilling this third pillar of Islam.
2. It is a commandment of Allah (S.W.T) and therefore must be observed by every Muslim who qualifies to give it.
3. Giving of Zakat purifies the wealth of the giver.
4. It blesses the wealth of the giver.
5. The institution of Zakat enables one to fulfill his religious obligation.
6. Develops spiritual growth and piety.

Social Importance

1. Creates good relationship between the giver and receiver.
2. Remove jealousy/ mistrust of the rich.
3. Restores hope, dignity and worthiness of the poor.
4. Reduces the gap between the rich and poor
5. Develops and fosters a healthy social relationship among members of the community.
6. Removes pride, selfishness or greed among rich.
7. Job creation for the Zakat collectors who secure employment.
8. Fighting corruption
9. Clearing debts of citizens
10. It helps foster equality among the Muslims.
11. Promotes unity and brotherhood among the Muslim Ummah.



12. It fosters love among the Muslims.

Economic importance

- a. Zakat Helps raise living standards of the poor less, fortunate and the marginalized communities.
- b. It helps the poor and needy by relieving their hardships and troubles.
- c. Helps create a self supporting community which does not require financial or economic assistance in form of food or material. This enables the Muslim community to be self reliant and independent.
- d. Zakat contributes to the national budget as it is a form of tax.
- e. It helps in the creation of job and employment opportunities.
- f. Those in debt are able to settle them from the Zakat.
- g. Zakat assists in improving the economy in the society by creating job opportunities for example the Zakat collectors and distributors, clearance of debts and establishment of social amenities.

Differences between Zakat and Tax

ZAKAT	TAX
It is the third pillar of Islam	It is a law of the government or rather the policies of state
It is only paid annually	It can be paid monthly, weekly, daily or even hourly.
The rate of Zakat is fixed till the day of judgment.	Its rate keeps fluctuating or rather it is determined by the amount of income one earns.
It is a commandment of Allah (S.W.T) Q2: 110	It is authorized by the government, King or the ruler of the state.



It is payable on one's saving	It is calculated from the gross salary or net profit.
It is rewarded by Allah and therefore cannot be evaded	It is rewarded by the state ruler or government hence one is fined for not giving it out.

The role played by Zakat in promoting integrity.

Zakat plays a very important role in the promotion of integrity in the society through the following ways:

- 1) It enhances the sense of responsibility in that the giver feels obliged to perform the acts as an obligatory duty upon him.
- 2) It also promotes loyalty which is an aspect of integrity. The giver shows loyalty to Allah who has commanded those with wealth to give it in charity. Zakat has been mentioned eighty two (82) times in the Quran.
- 3) It assists in curbing vices such as theft, by regulating the owning of resources in the society and creating a balance.
- 4) Giving of Zakat helps in minimizing vices such as jealousy and envy in that the receiver feels satisfied when he is given the share from it. And to the giver it reduces extravagance and greed for wealth.
- 5) It encourages hard work because every Muslim has an incentive to work since he is expected to give something to the needy and earn thawab.
- 6) Zakat reduces injustices such as unfair distribution of wealth in that only the rightful recipients are given.
- 7) Zakat promotes unity in the society by bringing together both the rich and the poor.

**Suggested study Questions and Activities.**

Answer the following questions in your I.R.E revision exercise book.

1. a) Describe the performance of Sijdatul Tilawa, Sijdatul Shukr and Sijdatul Sahw.

b) Identify the various methods of purification

2. a) Give the acts which invalidate wudhu.

b) Discuss the significance of shahada in the life of a Muslim.

3. a) Give the differences between Zakat-ul Fitr and Zakat-ul maal. b) Explain the items on which Zakat is payable.

Activities

1. Demonstrate the performance of udhu and identify the Sunnah acts.
2. Demonstrate the performance of swalatul Janaza.



CHAPTER 5

Akhlaq (morality)

Akhlaq refers to the standard behaviour or code of conduct which an individual is expected to uphold or observe according to his or her society. Therefore Islamic morality refers to the code of conduct prescribed by the Quran and Hadith which a Muslim is expected to adhere to

The Islamic moral system stems from its primary creed of belief in One God as the Creator and Sustainer of the Universe. Islam considers the human race to be a part of God's creation, and as His subjects. From an Islamic perspective, the purpose of human life is to worship God, by leading this worldly life in harmony with the Divine Will, and thereby achieving peace in this world, and everlasting success in the life of the hereafter. Muslims look to the Glorious Quran and the Traditions of the Prophet as their moral guides. Morality in Islam addresses every aspect of a Muslim life, from greetings to international relations. Muslims must not only be morally healthy, but also contribute to the moral health of the entire society.

The almighty Allah says: ***“You are the best of the nations raised up for (the benefit of) men; you enjoin what is right and forbid the wrong and believe in God; and if the followers of the book had believed it would have been better for them; of them(some) are believers and most of them are transgressors.”*** [Q: 3:110]

The prophet (P.B.U.H) summarized the conduct of a Muslim when he said:

“My Sustainer has given me nine commands: to remain conscious of Allah, whether in private or in public; to speak justly, whether angry or pleased; to show moderation both when poor and when rich, to reunite friendship with those who have broken off with me; to give to him who refuses me; that my silence should be occupied with thought; that my looking should be an admonition; and that I should command what is right.”

The glorious Qur'an says:



“It is not righteousness that ye turn your faces Towards east or West; but it is righteousness- to believe in Allah and the Last Day, and the Angels, and the Book, and the Messengers; to spend of your substance, out of love for Him, for your kin, for orphans, for the needy, for the wayfarer, for those who ask, and for the ransom of slaves; to be steadfast in prayer, and practice regular charity; to fulfill the contracts which ye have made; and to be firm and patient, in pain (or suffering) and adversity, and throughout all periods of panic. Such are the people of truth, the Allah-fearing.”[Q: 2:177]

This verse emphasizes the Islamic belief that righteousness and piety is based on a true and sincere faith. The key to virtue and good conduct is a strong relation with God, who sees all, at all times and everywhere. He knows the secrets of the hearts and the intentions behind all actions. Therefore, Islam enjoins moral behavior in all circumstances. It may be possible to deceive the world, but it's not possible to deceive the Creator.

Morality in Islam centers on certain basic beliefs and principles as follows:

- a) Allah (S.W.T) is the creator and source of all goodness, truth and beauty.
- b) Man is a responsible, dignified and honorable agent of his Creator.
- c) Allah (S.W.T) has put everything in the heavens and the earth in the service of mankind.
- d) By His Mercy and Wisdom, Allah (S.W.T) does not expect the impossible from man or hold him accountable for anything beyond his power. Nor does Allah (S.W.T) forbid man to enjoy the good things of life.
- e) Moderation, practicality and balance are guarantees of high integrity and sound morality.
- f) All things are permissible in principle except what is singled out as obligatory, which must be observed and what is singled out as forbidden, which must be avoided.
- g) Man's ultimate responsibility is to Allah (S.W.T) and his highest goal is the pleasure of his Creator.

Dimensions of Islamic morality

In the beginning of this chapter, we have learnt that Akhlaq involves moral values and that Allah (S.W.T) always wants us to lead a pious life.

Islamic morality is measured in two ways: Maarufat (virtues) and Munkaraat (vices)

It entirely deals with the relationship between man and the other and creatures of the universe, man and his innermost self. The Muslim's relationship with Allah (S.W.T) should be one of love and



obedience, complete trust, steadfastness and active devotion; it is this kind of behaviour that should inspire and nourish morality at the human level.

In relating to his fellow men, a Muslim should show kindness, care and respect to relatives, neighbours and strangers whatever their status in the society. He must also honor the legitimate rights of others as much as he fulfills his own.

A Muslim should also use nature for the benefit of humanity as signs of Allaah (S.W.T) without waste of humility as signs of Allaah (S.W.T) without waste or excess.

A Muslim's moral obligation is also to stand for what is right and fight what is wrong, seek what is true and abandon what is false, uphold what is wrong, seek what is beautiful and wholesome and avoid what is indignant. To him, simplicity and compassion are his trademarks, while he keeps away from arrogance and pride. A man once asked the prophet (S.W.T) on virtues and he replied.

“Ask your heart. Virtue is that which satisfies the soul and comforts the heart, And sin (evil), is that which perturbs the soul and troubles the heart even if people should pronounce it lawful.” (Ahmed & Dearani)

Islamic morality (Akhlaaq) is divided into two dimensions

- (a) Maaroofoot (The Virtues)
- (b) Munkaraat (The vices)

a) Maaroofoot [the virtues]

These are deeds or practices which are permitted in Islam. They could be in the form of actions, gestures or statements. A Muslim is encouraged to acquire these virtues. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) said: *“The most perfect amongst you in faith is the best of you in behavior.”*

Examples of Maarufat

- (i) Visiting the sick and escorting the deceased to the grave.
- (ii) Feeding the poor.
- (iii) Honoring the aged.
- (iv) Trustworthiness: Muslims have to be people who keep their words in any promise, contracts among others.
- (v) Having contentment [Qanaa] or satisfaction with whatever Allah [sw] has decreed for him/her.
- (vi) Self control
- (vii) Contentment
- (viii) Patience



- (ix) Trust in responsibility
 - (x) Truthfulness
- Mention other things that are classified as maarufat.

b) Munkaraat [the vices]

These are all kinds of bad practices or deeds that are prohibited in Islam. These vices can be in the form of actions gestures or statements. Allah (S.W.T) has prohibited all forms of Munkaraat whether practiced in the open or in secrecy.

Allah (S.W.T) says: ***“Say: The things that May Lord has indeed forbidden are: Shameful deeds ,whether open or secret; sins and trespasses against truth or reason; assigning of partners to Allah, for which He Has given no authority and saying things about Allah of which you have no knowledge.”***[Q: 7:33]

Examples of Munkaraat

- (i) Arrogance and pride.
- (ii) Slander and gossips.
- (iii) Telling lies.
- (iv) Calling one another by offensive nicknames.
- (v) Dissatisfaction and lack of contentment.
- (vi) Looking down upon others because, class or wealth, race etc.
- (vii) Wishful thinking.
- (viii) Drug and substance abuse.
- (ix) Gambling and games of chances.
- (x) All forms of sexual perversions.

Significance of Islamic morality

Islamic morality is intended to build in a Muslim a sound mind, peaceful soul and a strong personality.

- Islamic morality is meant to build in the human being a sound mind and body and a peaceful soul.
- It makes a Muslim have a distinctive Islamic personality when interacting with others.
- Islamic moral values are meant to cultivate in a Muslim the best character in the most whole some manner.



- It strengthens the bonds between human beings and Allah thus developing a strong taqwa.
- Islamic morality guards the Muslims external behaviors and his manifest deeds to be in line with Allah (S.W.T) the teachings of Islam.
- It shields a Muslims from evil since it guards his external behavior and his manifest deeds to be in line with Allah(S.W.T)
- It promotes positive thinking by guiding individual Muslims to be occupied with constructive ideas and serious pursuits of how to lead a positive life on this earth and the hereafter.
- It discourages a Muslim from practicing prohibitions such as use of intoxicants.
- The Munkaraat have been prohibited by Allah (S.W.T) for the spiritual and mental well being of man as well as for the moral and material benefit of humanity.
- It promotes peace and harmony in the society in that the prohibitions discourage vices.
- It generates affection and respect between the members of the family and the society in general hence promoting brotherhood.
- Allah has promised rewards for those who abide by the Islamic morals and avoid evils deeds.

Amr bil Ma'ruf Wa Nahy Anil Munkar. (Enjoining good and forbidding evil)

Allah (S.W.T) commanded Muslims to always enjoin good and forbid evil in the society. Commanding of good should start with self-restrain. This means avoidance of those acts which displease Allah. Being a practical religion, Islam teaches the Muslims to strive to follow the religious teachings and abide by its code of conduct and ethics.

Allah says, *“Let there arise in you a band of people inviting to all that is good, enjoining what is right and forbidding what is wrong; They are the ones to attain felicity.”* [Q: 3:104]

The prophet (P.B.U.H) also emphasize on the importance of morals in a hadith reported by Abu Sa'id Al-Khudri who says that the messenger of Allah says, *“He of you who sees an abomination should change it with his hand; if he could not, then with his tongue; if he could not, then in his heart; and this is the faintest in faith.”* (Muslim)



Islam is a complete way of life and a very practical religion. Even though it is enshrined in laws, beliefs and practices, morals form the basis of each and every act of Ibadat'. For example, Islam prohibits the use of intoxicants as they interfere with the normal functioning of the body and mind; hence one cannot attend to his religious duties.

It is also very important to keep off evil so that we can preserve the purity of the soul and have it more concentrated on performing ibadah. Muslims should keep reminding each other of the good things expected from them and talk about the evil things and how they can avoid them. And Allah tells us in the Quran, *“And remind, for indeed, the reminder benefits the believers.”*

What benefits do you get as a Muslim when you practice and remind each other of good deeds?

On the other hand, the soul of the human being is very subtle to temptations which arise from weaknesses to remain firm and steadfast in the path of Allah. The environment we stay in may also affect our morals and divert us from the good path. If for example you walk with friends who smoke, you need a very strong conviction and Iman (faith) so that you are not tempted to smoke. But in as much as you may not be smoking, it is your religious duty to command good and forbid evil. Therefore you should remind your friend of the evils of smoking.

There are various ways in which a Muslim can command well and shun evil. Examples of such ways are; observing the five daily prayers, fasting during the month of Ramadhan, speaking the truth, visiting the sick, giving out charity, advising those doing the wrong among others.

Would you wish to be among the successful on the Day of Judgment? What are the things you need to in order to attain this success?

Morality based on iman and swalihat

The good morals of anybody are shaped by the faith that he possesses and the dutifulness towards his creator. Surat ul Asr supports that:



“I swear by the time (Asr) surely man is in great loss, save those who believe and perform good deeds and exhort each other on truth and exhort each other to endurance[Q:103:1-3].

Iman thus takes the first preference before good deeds. Good deeds that are not accompanied with Iman are known to have no reward before Allah. Consider those who do good things just to be seen and praised, the corrupt people who do good things in exchange of various favors not to mention the philanthropists who give a lot of wealth for pleasure without bringing the intention of doing it for the sake of Allah. Such deeds usually may lead to actions that are forbidden according to the doctrine of Islam.

Obedience of Allah’s commandments leads to righteous deeds in that in order for you to perform them, you should first fear Allah. Iman and Swalihah cannot be separated because they are interdependent in their functioning. Therefore in Islam, faith and good deeds go hand in hand.

Abu Said Al-Khudri (R.A) narrates that he heard the prophet (P.B.U.H) says: *Whenever anyone of sees anything contrary to Allah’s approval, he should change it with his hand, or if he cannot, then by his tongue, if he cannot, then by his heart and that is the weakest faith.”*

Suggested revision Questions and class activities.

Answer the following questions in your I.R.E revision exercise books.

1. Explain the basic principles of Islamic morality.
2. Discuss the significance of commanding good and forbidding evil.

Activity

Identify the common vices you see being practiced in your neighbourhood. Suggest ways of stopping them.

CHAPTER 6

MUAMALAT

The family

Every living creation of Allah (S.W.T) belongs to a specific family. The idea of a family can be well understood if we bear in mind our surrounding environment. Let us take an example of a busy city during the day. Busy with men, women and children, moving all over. In the evening, during the rush hours, you will see everyone getting into a matatu and the streets will remain empty. Where do all



these people go to? Ask yourself why they can't remain in the streets until the next day. They must go and look for shelter, company, a good meal among other needs which are provided for within this social institution we call a family.

We now have an idea about what a family is. Can you mention the people who constitute a family? A family according to Islam is a social institution whereby members are united by the same ethical values hence have responsibilities over one another. This bond starts right from marriage and includes but not limited to all the relations from either sides of the married couples. Are there any other people who may not be staying with you but are part of your family? In Islam the concept of a family stretches far beyond the father, mother and children. The following three factors keep people together and united in an Islamic society:

- Kingship and blood ties-it involves the father /mother- child relations, brother-sister among others these are the strongest natural ties. It determines how members relate with one another thus controlling their behavior. It binds together the family and assists people to live peacefully.
- Marital commitment-It includes husband-wife relations, the in-laws of either side. This helps to keep the family together in that each member has defined roles to play.
- Faith-It is the main binding factor which enhances the achievement of family goals and interests. It goes beyond the close relatives to include all the Muslims who are brothers and sisters. We should therefore be ready to accommodate our fellow Muslims when they need our help since they form part of the larger Muslim family.

Importance of the family

We have seen who comprise of a family. These entire members are kept together by a common goal which should be directed towards benefitting the entire society. The things done within the smaller unit of the society, which is the family, will have either direct or indirect impact to all the members of the community. Let us look at the importance of the family:



- Provide room for procreation to enhance the widening of the larger society. Being a very important unit of the society, procreation forms part of the responsibilities of those who get married to ensure continuity of the lineage and general growth of the society.
- A family serves as strong founding unit or rather the first school for the children where the values habit and rites are passed to the children, preparing them to fit in the wider society. The children need to therefore allow their parents and other family members to give them guidance and ask for their advice.
- A family offers security needs and provides a sense of belonging and identity in that it bonds an individual to a respective family giving him/her confidence.
- A family serves as a foundation stone to the society. A family is founded through marriage which promotes interfamily alliance through matrimonial relation. It brings people of different social status and race together hence removing social prejudice in the society.
- A family acts as barometer to regulate the moral conduct of certain individuals in the society. This contributes to peace and harmonious as it provides a set of rules to be observed e.g. marriage shields indecency.
- A family promotes a sense of responsibility in that each member has specific roles to play in order to achieve the goals of the family for example; the husband is responsible for livelihood of his family while the wife has to fulfill the functions as motherhood such as child upbringing and household chores.
- A family is a source of stability to the society, in that stable families produce members who fit well in the wider society.
- The family serves as a learning institution. Children brought up in family are taught Islamic morals, values, norms and traditions by the parents. The knowledge learnt during the formative years is peculiar to the home environment. It happens that children brought up from different environment will end up with different moral behavior. This is due to the socialization skills taught in individual families or the moral and traditional practices that may be seen in the two environments. Are there things that you learnt in your childhood and are different from your friend's? Mention some of them.

Nikah (Marriage)

Definition of Marriage (Nikah)

What is marriage? Nikah is an Arabic term used for marriage which means a contract. Marriage is a mutual contract or legal union between a man and a woman, sane and mature who have expressed



their willingness to stay as a husband and wife in order to become a pious family and a society. The contract must be guided by the Quran and Sunnah of the prophet (P.B.U.H)

Marriage in Islam

Marriage is a vital part of a Muslim's life. In fact marriage is so important in Islam that it is declared to be a half of a Muslim's faith. As a Muslim one should live in accordance with the Islamic Jurisprudence in the way shown by the Holy Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H).

Allah (S.W.T) says, ***"Marry those among you who are single or the virtuous ones among your slaves male or female: if they are in poverty, Allah will give them means out of His grace: for Allah encompasses all, and He knows all things."***[Q: 24:32]

One can see from the above verse that the Creator of mankind has ordered us to marry. The Prophet married and also encouraged others to marry

Ibn Mas'ud (R.A) narrated that the messenger of Allah (h.B.U.H) said to us, *"O young people! Whoever can marry among you should marry, for that will help him lower his gaze and protect his chastity. Whoever is not able to marry is recommended to fast and that will be his shield."* (Bukhari and Muslim)

Purpose of marriage

The basic objectives of marriage in Islam are:

To fulfill Allah's (S.W.T) command. Marriage is a commandment from Allah (S.W.T) which must therefore be fulfilled by every Muslim who is able. It is considered as completing half of one's religion and we therefore earn Allah's rewards.

Secondly, marriage secures a comfortable atmosphere for both the husband and the wife. A Muslim couple who follow the teachings of the Holy Quran will always be a source of comfort for each other. Their relationship should go beyond that of mere sexual enjoyment and should be based on a cordial friendship accompanied by mutual understanding. The Holy Quran says: ***"One of His signs is that***



He created for you spouses of your own species, so that you might find comfort with them. And He put mutual love and affection in your hearts. Surely in this there are lessons for the thinking people." [Q: 30:21]

The other purpose is for procreation. Through marriage, a new generation of healthy, faithful and virtuous children is born. The family is the school for morals. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) said. "As soon as a suitor, who is religious and who has manners that satisfy you comes to you asking for a matrimonial alliance, take action to join in marriage with him. If you do not do so, you will have deviated from the right path and may be faced with a great crisis."

It ensures financial competence in the community. A Muslim man must provide means of living to his wife and children, even if the wife is wealthy or earns a salary.

The fourth reason is for companionship. Marriage provides close interaction between the man and the woman in mutual sharing of responsibilities and ideas. This relationship makes the husband and the wife to live together harmoniously. For example, in our homes our parents consult each other on matters related to our welfare like paying of our school fees, buying of our cloths among other responsibilities.

Marriage helps to safeguard one's Iman (faith). It prevents one from committing immoral acts. Sins such as intermingling with members of the opposite sex or having sexual relations outside marriage are not acceptable in Islam because it creates immorality and immodesty.

It promotes inter-family alliance. Through marriage, family ties are strengthened between the families of the couple who become relatives. This promotes peace, harmony and friendship in the society.

The other purpose of marriage is to safeguard the legitimacy of children who if begotten through marriage are entitled to inheritance.

Marriage improves the couples' social status through earning respect and dignity in the society.

Conditions and regulations of marriage

We have seen that the family begins with marriage. A marriage is valid only if the following conditions are observed:



The formula (Al-Ssigha')

This is the formula of marriage which includes the offer (Ijab) and the acceptance (Qabul).

The offer may be presented directly or through an agent which then gives room for the acceptance. In this case, the process begins with the man's proposal which presents his full identification and intention. On the other hand the woman has to state clearly her wishes and has the liberty to accept or decline the offer. This first stage enhances familiarization to instill confidence.

The contracting parties (al-Aqidaan)

This refers to the bride and the groom who must satisfy conditions of marriage such as:

- Be of sound mind
- Have attained maturity
- Must give their consent Abu Huraira(R.A) narrated that the prophet (S.A.W) said, "A woman without a husband shall not be married until she gives consent, nor a virgin be married till her consent is sought. They asked: How shall be her permission? He said, If she remains silent." (Agreed upon)
- They should not belong to the prohibited degrees of marriage.

Witnesses (as-shuhud)

The issue of witnesses has been given great importance in Islam and therefore the marriage should be contracted before two male Muslim witnesses whomust be mukhalaf (mature and sane). In addition, they must understand the language in which the marriage ceremony is being conducted. Regarding the witnesses, Ibn Abass reports that the prophet (S.A.W) said, "The fornicatresses are those who marry by themselves without witnesses." (At-Tirmidhy)

Guardianship(Al-Wilayat)

The guardian is in charge of giving consent or permission for the marriage to proceed. Abu Musa (R.A) narrates that the prophet said, "There is no marriage without a guardian." (Ahmad, At-Tirmidhy, Abu Dawoud, Ibn Majah) The Shariah gives the father the first position as the guardian. In the case that the father is absent, then the guardianship will take the following order of merit:

- The grand father
- Full brother

- Uncle (the father's brother)

In case the guardian declines to give consent for a reason which is not valid according to the Sharia, then the Kadhi acts as the guardian.

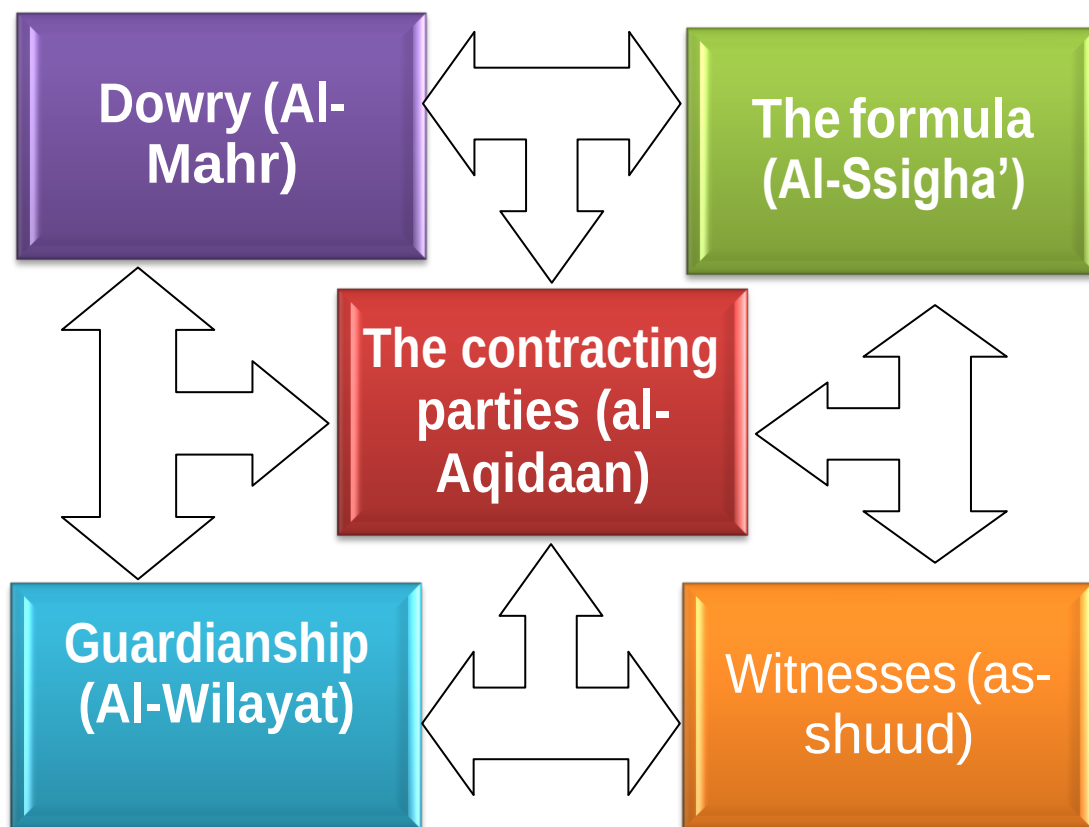
Dowry (Al-Mahr)

Allah (S.W.T) says in the Quran, “And give the women (on marriage) their dowry as a free gift, but if they, of their own good pleasure emit any part of it to you, take it and enjoy it with right good cheer.” [Q: 1:1]

Dowry is the obligatory gift given to the woman in marriage. It can either include a service or other material things like money, property or any other assets. This can be paid either in full or partially on the day of Nikah. The woman is given the right to request for whatever dowry she wants. This should be done on measurable terms without over burdening the groom. In the event where the woman asks for divorce she is obliged to return the dowry.

The following diagram represents the components of an Islamic marriage.

Summary of the conditions for marriage:





The Muslim marriage ceremony

The actual Muslim wedding is known as a *nikah*. It is a simple ceremony, in which the bride does not have to be present so long as she sends two witnesses to the drawn-up agreement. Normally, the ceremony consists of reading from the Qur'an, and the exchange of vows in front of witnesses for both partners. No special religious official is necessary, but often the Imam is present and performs the ceremony. He may give a short sermon. **Let's now briefly look at what should be included in the sermon:**

The Sermon

The assembly of nikah is addressed with a marriage sermon (khutba-tun-nikah) by the Muslim who is officiating the marriage. This should be done by a state appointed Muslim judge (Qad'i) who also keeps the record of the marriage contract. However any trust worthy practicing Muslim can conduct the nikah ceremony. The documents of marriage contract/certificate are filed with the mosque (masjid) and local government for record.

The Prophet (S.A.W) made it his tradition to have marriage sermon delivered in the assembly to solemnize the marriage. The sermon invites the bride and the groom, as well as the participating guests in the assembly to a life of piety, mutual love, kindness, and social responsibility.

The Khutbah-tun-Nikah begins with the praise of Allah. His help and guidance is sought. The Muslim confession of faith that "There is none worthy of worship except Allah and Muhammad is His servant and messenger" is declared. The three Quranic verses (Quran 4:1, 3:102, 33:70-71) and one Prophetic saying (hadith) form the main text of the marriage. This hadith is:

'By Allah! Among all of you I am the most God-fearing, and among you all, I am the super most to save myself from the wrath of Allah, yet my state is that I observe prayer and sleep too. I observe fast and suspend observing them; I marry woman also. And he who turns away from my Sunnah has no relation with me". (Bukhari)

The Muslim officiating the marriage ceremony concludes the ceremony with a supplication (Dua) for bride, groom, their respective families, the local Muslim community, and the Muslim community at large (Ummah)

it is important for us to note here that marriage is considered as an act of worship (ibadah). It is therefore virtuous to conduct it in a Mosque keeping the ceremony simple. Islam advocates simplicity in ceremonies and celebrations.

There are certain things which are basic to all Muslim marriages. Marriages have to be declared publicly. They should never be undertaken in secret. The publicity is usually achieved by having a



large feast, or *walimah* - a party specifically for the purpose of announcing publicly that the couple are married and entitled to each other. Aisha (R.A) narrated that the prophet said, "hroclaim this marriage and solemnize it in mosques and beat aafs over it."(At-Tirmidhy-Rare Hadith)This is usually held after the consummation of the marriage. The relatives, neighbours, and friends are invited in order to make them aware of the marriage. Both rich and poor of the family and community are invited to the marriage feasts. It is recommended that Muslims attend marriage ceremonies and marriage feasts upon invitation.

Prophet Muhammad (S.A.W) said:

"...and he who refuses to accept an invitation to a marriage feast, verily disobeys Allah and His Prophet". (Ahmad & Abu Dawood)

POLYGAMY

The word "holygamy" may not be a familiar one although it is the commonest type of marriage in most cultures and traditions. Polygamycomes from two Greek words, namely "*poly*" meaning many or more than, and "*Gamy*" which stands for marriage or a sexual union.Thus polygamy means marrying more than one wife.

Islam permits polygamy and it should be clearly understood that it is a Sunnah practiced by the prophet and his predecessors. This means that marriage to more than one wife is a continuation of the practice established by the previous religions.For example; prophet Yaqub had four wives, Prophet Ibrahim had two wives and Prophet Suleiman had several wives.

Islam polished and reformed the old practice that was there before the advent of Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) that had a lot of violation brought in by pagans who had come after the previous prophets.This was done by setting up certain rules and regulations to control this important feature in the social life of Muslims.

Conditions for polygamy

It should be noted with great care that it is not compulsory that one marries more than one wife but it is permissible under very strict conditions.These conditions have been laid because of the challenges that arise in the polygamous family. What are some of the disadvantages that you may have seen in your society as a result of having more than one wife? Due to the reasons that you have mentioned, the shariah has restricted polygamy to the following conditions:-

- i. The number of wives must not exceed four at any one given time.



- ii. The husband should be equally fair to all his wives in relation to life's daily needs such as providing them with clothing, feeding and housing without favor or discrimination to any one of them. Also on the basis of emotional side such as spending the same number of nights with each one equally.

It should be noted that for a man to favor emotionally all of his wives is sometimes beyond the human ability; however, one should not abuse this fact by unjustly mistreating any of the wives.

Abu Huraira (R.A) narrated that the prophet (P.B.U.H) said: *"Whoever has two wives and inclines to one of them, will come on the day of judgment with one of his sides paralyzed." "If one of you had two wives and did not treat them equally according to others justly, he would come at the Day of Judgment walking lamely."* (Related by Ahmad and the four Imams with a sound chain of narrators)

If this condition is not fulfilled, then polygamy is absolutely forbidden because in such a case it would bring injustice and means for misbehaving.

- iii. One should be in a position to fulfill the wives conjugal rights before he commits himself to another one, because one of the main objectives of marriage is fulfillment of sexual desires.
- iv. One should be financially able to sustain and support the wives and the children because it is the man's responsibility to provide for the family.

Failure to observe the above conditions, a Muslim man is not encouraged to marry a second wife because Allah (SWT) says:

"...And if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly with the orphaned girls marry other women of your choice, two, three or four, but if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly (with them), then only one or (the slaves) that your right hand possess. That is never to prevent you from justice...." [Q: 4:3]

Reasons for polygamy

We have already discussed the conditions of polygamy. We shall now focus our attention on the following reasons for the institution of polygamy.

- i. If the wife is unable to bear children after years of marriage and it has been medically proven that the wife is barren and there is nothing wrong with the husband then the husband is permitted to marry another wife. It is however recommended that the first wife be provided for



by the husband and given all the rights she deserves. the first wife continues to enjoy her rights such as support and maintenance.

- ii. The population of women is higher than that of men therefore polygamy provides an opportunity to the otherwise would be unmarried women to get married. This safe guards the society against social evils like adultery and prostitution.
- iii. If the wife suffers from contagious or other terminal illness which prevents her from honoring her conjugal obligation, plurality of wives serves the purpose for the man.
- iv. For the sake of preservation and maintenance of the Muslim society. When men die either naturally or in a battle and widows are left behind, it becomes necessary that they should be taken care of. The sharia therefore provides room for polygamy so that they can be married and offered support and protection.
- v. To increase the Muslim population through pro-creation.
Anas bin Malik (R.A) narrated that the Messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) used to command us to get married and would very strictly prohibit us from remaining in celibacy and say, 'Marry the woman who is child bearing and loving for I shall over all the nations by your number on the day of resurrection.' (Ahmad bin Hanbal. Ibn Hibban graded it as Sahih)

Marriage of Prophet Muhammad (p.b.u.h)

Prophet Mohammad (P.B.U.H) underwent a marriage life and it is from him that we emulate the best practices of marital life.

By the time of his death, he had nine wives, however, this should not be perceived as a violation of Allah's (S.W.T) instructions as he was the only one who had been permitted to do so by Allah (S.W.T) due to the following reasons:-

- i. To continue with the practice that Allah had prescribed to his predecessors' like prophets Ibrahim, Yaqub and Suleiman (A.S)



- ii. To eradicate the Quraish traditions and prejudices. That's why the prophet married from different ethnic groups, clans and among the Quraish tribe. Before this, the Quraish used to see themselves as superior beings to other tribes.
 - iii. To establish and implement the Islamic law. Allah (S.W.T) ordered the prophet (P.B.U.H) to marry Zainab bint Jaash who had been married by his adopted son Zayyid bin al-Harith so that He could put to an end the Arab practice of referring to adopted sons their own.
 - iv. For protection and security of the widows whose husbands had died in jihad wars. For example his marriage to Saudah bint Zamah (widowed by Sakran bin Amro) and Zainab bint Khuzaimah (widow to Abdullah bin Jaash).
 - v. To foster good relations between Muslims and non Muslims. For example his marriage to Jurawriya bint al Harith who was the daughter of a tribal chief of Banu Mustaliq clan of Arabia, Swafiyyah bint Huyay and Ummu Habibah.
 - vi. To disseminate Islamic knowledge and in particular enforce domestic laws. He married Aisha Bint Abu Bakar (R.A.) and Ummu Salamah (R.A.) who memorized a number of hadith and used to train the other women on religious and family matters.
- The prophet (P.B.U.H) married twelve wives whom the Muslims refer to as mothers of the believers (Ummahaatul Mu'uminiin). The prophet's wives have been given this honor because of the love, dedication and support they showed to the prophet (P.B.U.H)

The prophet's Wives

- 1). Khadija bint Khuwaylid - She was twice widowed and was a wealthy merchant who commanded respect, honor and dignity among the Quraish. She was the prophet's wife for nearly twenty years and bore him four girls; Zainab, Ruqayyah, Ummu Kulthum and Fatimah, as well as two sons; Qassim and Abdulla (both of whom passed away in infancy).
- 2). Saudah bint Zaynab - She was a widow whose husband passed on while returning from exile in Abyssinia (Ethiopia).
- 3). Aisha, the daughter of Abu-Bakar as-Siddiq (R.A) - She was a scholar of prophet's Sunna (Hadith) and other sciences.
- 4). Hafsa bint Umar bin al-Khattab (R.A) - She was a widow. Her husband was martyred in the battle of Badr. She married prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) in the second year of Hijra.
- 5). Zainab bint Khuzaimah - She was known as the 'mother of the poor' because of her kindness and special empathy to the underprivileged.



- 6). UmmuSalamah (Hind bint Abi Umayyah bin Mugheerah) - Her father was one of the famous Quraish leaders. Her husband was martyred in the battle of Uhud.
- 7). Juwairiyyah bint al-Harith: - She was among the hostages during the battle between the believers and Banu Mustaliq. Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) married her so as to save her from humiliation. Her name was Barrah before her marriage to the holy prophet (P.B.U.H)
- 8). ZainabbintJa'sh - She was the daughter of the prophet's paternal aunt and the divorced wife of his adopted son, Zaid bin Al- Harith.
- 9). Ummu Habibah - She was the daughter of Abu Sufyan. Her husband denounced Islam after migration to Abyssinia. When he later died the prophet (P.B.U.H) married her to alleviate her from the problems she was facing.
- 10). SwafiyyahbintHuyay - She was a daughter of a Jewish chief of Banu Nadhir. Her father was one of the greatest opponents of Islam. Later their tribe was banished from Madina after the fall of Khaybar in the seventh year of Hijra. She was among the captives who converted to Islam and prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) married her.
- 11). Maimunah bint al- Harith - She was the daughter of Harith of the Khawazin tribe. She was a widow in Makkah and married the prophet (P.B.U.H) in the seventh year of Hijra. .
- 12). Mariyya al- Qibtwiyyah – She was the last wife of the prophet (P.B.U.H). She was presented to the prophet as a gift by the King of Egypt after the prophet had sent an invitation to Egypt and other countries to join Islam. She was the only one after Khadija to bear the prophet (P.B.U.H) a child called Ibrahim who also died in childhood.

Rights and duties of family members

The bond in the family involves mutual expectation of rights and duties that have been prescribed by the religion and enforced by the Islamic sharia. This implies, therefore, that every family member has certain commitments to meet over the other. The role of each member depends on their position in the family. Let us now look at the rights and duties of each family member.

Rights of the parents:

These are the duties which should be performed by the children towards their parents.

Allah says in the Quran, “eour Lord Has decreed that:

1. They should be treated with kindness.
2. Children should take care of them when they get old or need their help.
3. They should remember them in the prayers.



4. Do not turn away from them in case they need you.
5. Obey them in whatever they ask you and are in accordance with the sharia.
6. Pay their debts when they pass on.
7. Show them a good send off when they die.
8. Children should continue praying for their parents even after they have died.

Duties of the husband: Rights of the wife.

Islam honours the husband as the head of the family. Infact Allah (S.W.T) emphasizes in the holy Quran thus; ***“Men are the protectors and maintainers of women because Allah has given the one more strength than the other and because they support them from their means...”*** [Q: 4:34] There are certain duties which as a husband you have to observe towards your wife. They include the following:

1. He should protect his wife from any social, physical or psychological harm.
2. He should consult with his wife in kindness in matters relating to the family.
3. He has the full responsibility of financially and materially supporting and maintaining his wife.
4. He must be faithful to his wife and not keep any marital secrets from her.
5. He should respect the feelings of his wife and treat her with love, sympathy and understanding.
6. He should fulfill the wife’s matrimonial needs.
7. He should establish a rich Islamic atmosphere in the home.
8. He should keep the marriage life a secret.

Duties of a wife: The rights of the husband

Allah (S.W.T) says in the Qur’an: ***“And those who pray, ‘Our Lord! Grant unto us wives and off springs who will be the comfort of our eyes, and give us (the grace) to lead the righteous.’”*** [Q: 25:74]



Anas bin Malik (R.A) narrated that the prophet said, *“If a woman says her prayers, fasts her month (Ramadhan), guards her private parts and obeys her husband, she may enter paradise by any door(gate)”. (Related by Abu Nu’aim).* The wife is therefore expected perform the following duties;

1. She should not observe any Sunnah fast when the husband is present except with his permission.
2. She should not allow anybody in the house without his permission.
3. She is answerable to her husband in ensuring that duties of worship are observed by all family members in the house.
4. She should fulfill the conjugal rights of the husband.
5. She should not leave the house for visiting friends and relatives without her husband’s permission.
6. She should keep herself neat and clean to guard her husband from external temptations.
7. She should not take advantage of her sexual obligation to manipulate her husband.
8. She should not receive gifts or favors from other men without the consent of the husband.
9. She should take care of the husband’s property.

Rights of the children: Duties of the parents

Just as the children should observe certain obligations towards their parents, so should the parents to their children. Some of these duties include the following:

1. They should be provided with both religious and secular education.
2. They should be given good names.
3. The parents should provide them with the basic needs like food, shelter and clothing.
4. They should be given security and protection from external danger and influence which may lead to misguidance or injury.
5. They have a right to be loved and shown affection.
6. They have a right to inherit from their parents after they have passed on.
7. They have a right to legitimacy and know his rightful father and mother.



Rights of extended family members

1. They should be assisted when they are in need.
2. Muslims should be kind and treat them with gentleness.
3. We should protect them from external attacks.
4. We should show them love and affection and talk to them nicely.
5. We should freely interact with them so that they can get a sense of belonging.

Suggested study questions and activities.

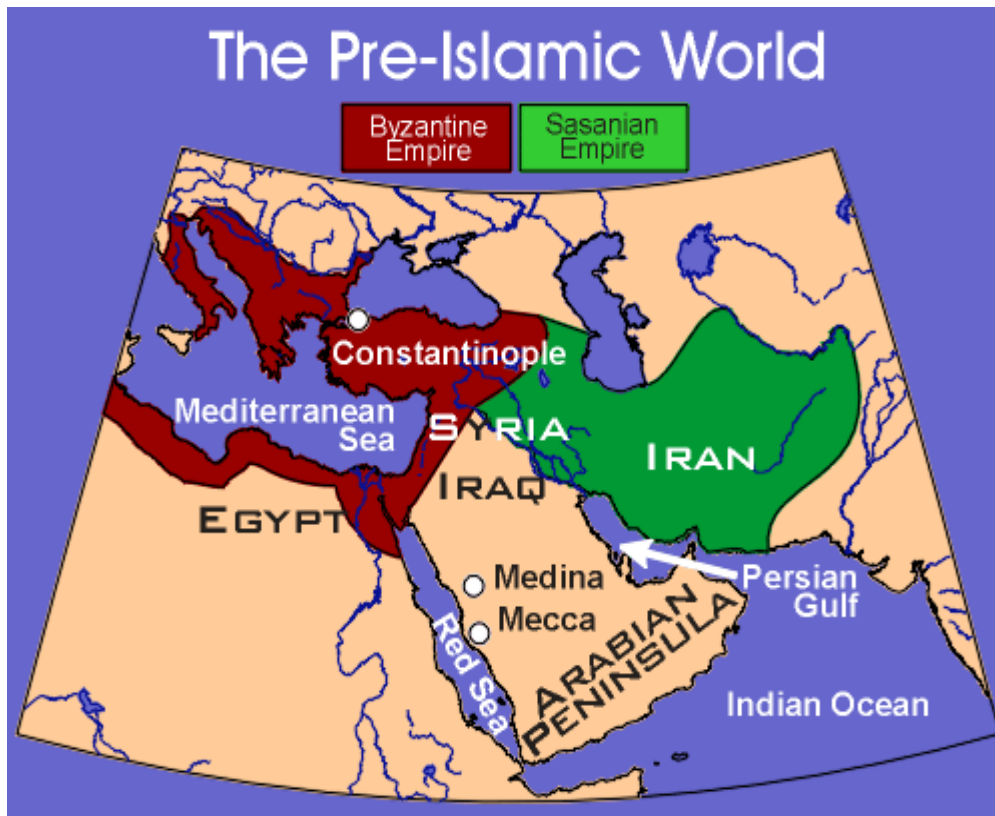
Answer the following questions in your I.R.E revision exercise books.

1. a) What is Nikah (Marriage) in Islam?
b) Explain the purpose of Marriage in Islam.
- c) Give reasons why the family is the basic unit of the society.
2. a) Highlight the conditions and regulations of marriage.
b) Discuss the roles of each family member in the society.

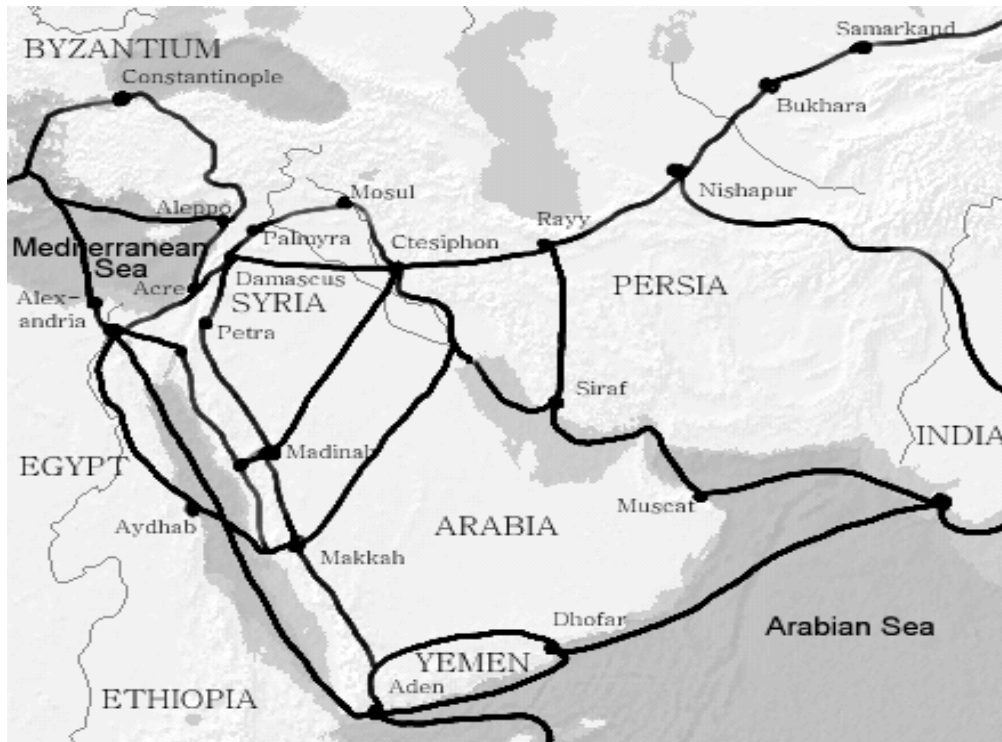
Activity

Visit your local Kadhi's office and find out how an Islamic marriage is conducted.

Map of Arabia before the advent of Islam



Map of Arabia showing the major trade routes during the pre Islamic Arabia



CURRENT MAP OF ARABIA





CHAPTER 7

HISTORY OF ISLAM

PRE- ISLAMIC ARABIA

Pre Islamic Arabia refers to the period before the prophet started preaching Islam. This period was characterized by acts of Jahiliya which means the age in which ignorance, barbarism, darkness from God's guidance were witnessed in the Arabian peninsula before the introduction of Islam.

The lives of the Arabs can be discussed in the following areas: Religious, social/moral, economic and political.

1. Religious Conditions

The following religious groups and worship practices prevailed in Arabia during the pre-Islamic era;

- a. Idolatry (Idol worship) Most of the Arabs were idolatrous. They used to carve idols from wood and stone which they used to worship. Each clan had its own idols to worship. They offered sacrifices to them and sought their blessings and guidance. There were 360 idols in Makkah alone. The leading idols were Al –Lata, Uzza, Manata and Hubbal.
- b. Christians. These were the followers of Prophet Issa (A.S) and had settled at Najran and followed the teachings of the Injil.
- c. Magians. These were the people who worshipped fire. These fire worshippers originated from Persia.
- d. Hanifs or Hunafaa. These were the followers of prophet Ibrahim (A.S). These people worshiped and believed in one God as they embraced the teachings of prophet Ibrahim and Ismail. Most of them accepted Islam when the prophet started preaching.
- e. Jews who practiced Judaism. These were the followers of prophet Musa (A.S) and were the descendants of Israel (Banu Israil). They followed the teachings of the book of Taurat which was revealed to prophet Musa (A.S) They mostly dwelt in Yathrib and Khaybar.



2. Social and moral conditions.

During pre-Islamic Arabia, the following social conditions were evident:

- a. The Arabs engaged in leisure activities such as drinking, intoxication and gambling. These activities were done mostly during social gatherings.
- b. Women were denied their rights such as inheritance from their parents and husbands but instead were inherited as property and when a man died his son would inherit all his wives except his own mother.
- c. Women were denied the right to life since baby girls were buried alive because they were considered as weak and could not be able to defend their community from external aggression.
- d. The women were also forced into sexual pervasions like prostitution and subjected to rape. They were also forced to marry more than one husband (polyandry).
- e. Women were taken as articles of trade as they could be sold and be exchanged with goods or merchandise in the market.
- f. The art of poetry was highly cherished by the Arabs. They organized poetry competitions in open places where poems with vulgar language were recited.
- g. The Arabs practiced polygamy without any limits and they would marry and divorce women at will.

3. Economic conditions

- a) They practiced Agriculture near the oasis where they used irrigation. This was done in areas of Yathrib, Taif and Southern parts of Arabia.
- b) Tourism. Makkah had many historical sites which included the Kaaba. People from several parts of the world toured those sites making the Arabs earn profit.
- c) Nomadism: During this period the Arabs lived a nomadic life and wandered in the desert with their animals in search of water and pasture. Most of them kept sheep, camels and goats as their source of livelihood.
- d) Barter trade. Those who settled in the town (town dwellers) practiced barter trade. They used to exchange goods and commodities.

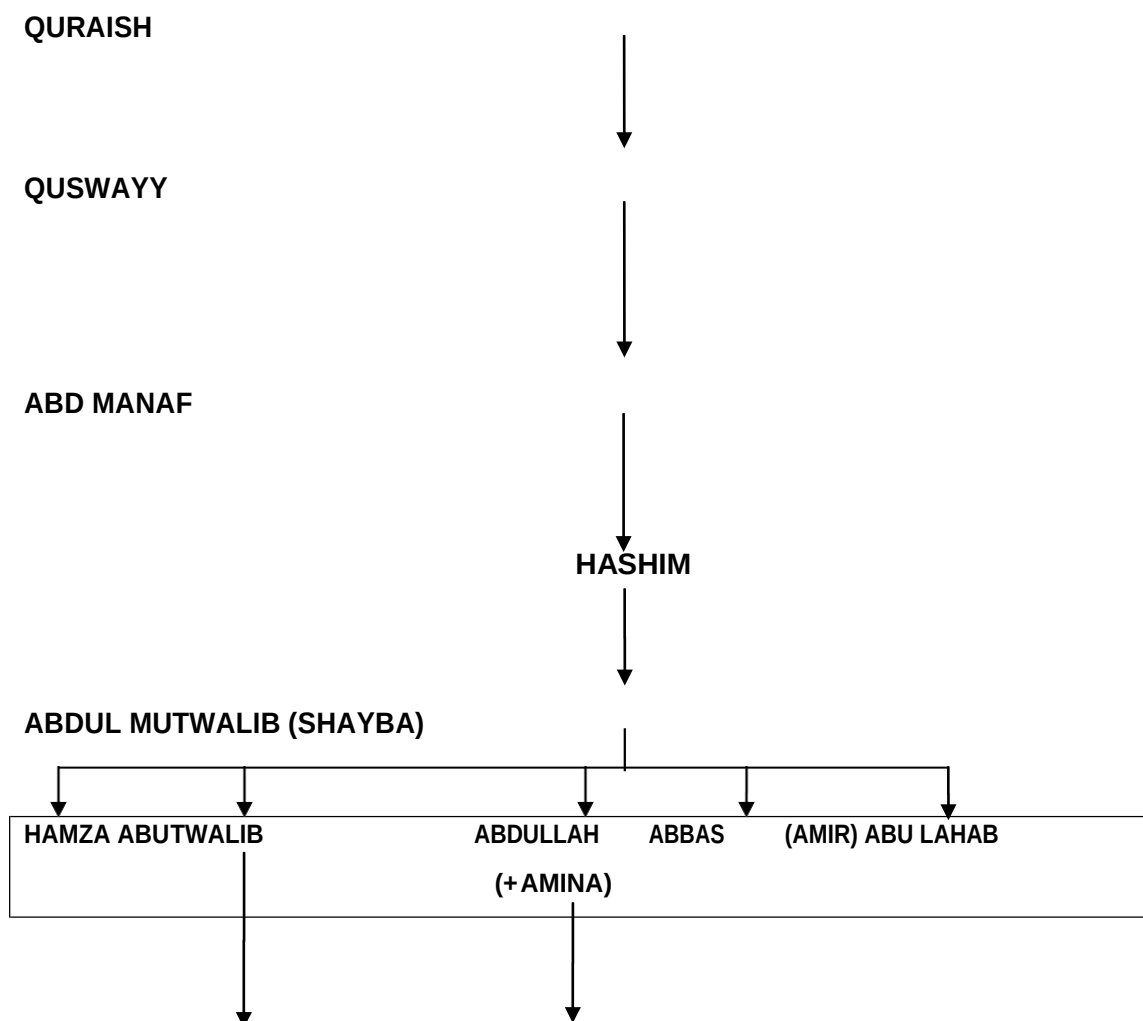
4. Political Conditions

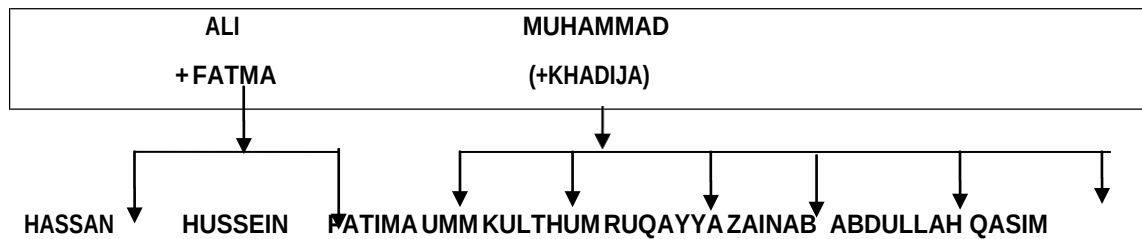


Arabia did not have a centralized government. There was a chieftainship political system where each tribe was led by a tribal chief. The tribal chief was appointed on the basis of merit while age was considered as one of the important factors. This was because the Arabs associated old age with wisdom and experience. The Bedouins who were in the desert led an independent life under tribal leaders. Tribal clashes were very common among the Arabs of that time. Most of the conflicts were as a result of revenge missions. In some of the parts, there were Kings who ruled their subjects.

Life history of Prophet Mohammad

FAMILY TREE OF THE PROPHET





It is important to note that apart from Khadija, the prophet married other wives as we have seen in the previous chapter. Among them Marria al Qibtiyya bore him a son by the name Ibrahim who died at infancy.

The Year of the Elephant

The coming of the settler to Kenya and other parts of East Africa brought several changes to the country. Some of which were adopted while others were unfriendly to the natives who reacted to them leading to the struggle for independence. The country wanted to govern itself and control its resources without any interference from the foreign countries like Britain. It so happened that in the year the prophet was born, Makka had been known as a center for pilgrimage in the entire Arabian peninsula. The city was therefore growing rapidly which caused the neighbouring territories to start envying it.

The Ethiopian governor of Yemen, Abraha al-Ashram was among those who envied the fame of the Ka'aba among the Arabs. He therefore constructed a big cathedral in Sanaa (the capital of Yemen) and ordered the Arabs to go there for pilgrimage instead. The order was ignored and this angered Abraha who in fury decided to demolish the Ka'aba. He set off with a large army of 60,000 soldiers and 13 elephants towards Makka.

He was riding on a huge elephant. It was an animal which the Arabs had not seen before, thus the year came to be known as 'Amul-Fil (the year of the elephant), and it started an era for reckoning the years in Arabia.



When news of the advance of Abraha's army reached Makka, the people of Makka were frightened by the large well, equipped army and of course the elephants which they had never seen before.

Abraha sent a message to Banu Hashim who were the custodians of the Kaaba at that time led by Abdul Mutwalib and advised them to demolish the Kaaba or he would destroy the whole city. 'Abdul-Muttalib replied to this ultimatum in these words: "By Allah, we do not want to fight him. So far as this House (the Ka'bah) is concerned, it is the House of Allah; if Allah wants to save His House, He will save it, and if He leaves it unprotected, no one can save it."

On the second day, Abraha ordered his army to enter the Holy city of Makka and destroy the Kaaba. 'Abdul-Muttalib told the Makkans to leave the city and to seek refuge in the surrounding hills. But he, together with some leading members of Quraish, remained within the precincts of the Ka'bah.

Abraha advanced with his army. Seeing the walls of the Ka'bah, he ordered its demolition. No sooner had the army reached near the Ka'bah than a dark cloud of small birds (known in Arabic as Ababil) overshadowed the entire army of Abraha. Each bird had three pebbles: two in its claws and one in its beak. A rain of the pebbles poured down from the birds, and in a few minutes, the whole army was destroyed. Abraha himself was seriously wounded; he fled towards Yemen but died on the way.

Allah (S.W.T) explains this event in the following chapter of the Quran:

Have you not seen how your Lord dealt with the companions of the Elephant? Did He not make their treacherous plan go astray? And He sent against them birds in flocks, striking them with stones of baked clay, so He rendered them like straw eaten up. [Qu'ran, 105]

Birth and early life of the prophet

Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was born on 12th of Rabiul-Awwal/22nd April 570 CE in Makkah in the year of elephant. He belonged to the Banu Hashim clan of the Quraish tribe. Abdul Mutalib, his grandfather was the chief of Makkah at that time. He had five sons: Hamza, Abu Talib, Abdullah, Abbas and Abu Lahab. The prophet's father was Abdullah Ibn Abdul Mutalib. He died a few days before the prophet's birth in Makkah while he was coming from a business journey in Syria. His mother was called Amina binti Wahab of the Banu Zuhra clan of Madina. She died on



the return journey from Madina where they had gone to visit the grave of the prophet's father at a place called 'Abwa' when he was six years old. After a few months, according to the age-long custom of the Arabs, the child was entrusted to a Bedouin woman Halima Bint Dhuib by name, of the tribe of Bani-Sa'd, for his upbringing. It was the practice of the Arabs to send their children to the country-side so that they would grow up strong, healthy and learn the refined language of the Bedouin. He lived with the Banu Sa'd clan for four years before his mother took him back under her care.

After the death of his mother, he was raised by his paternal grandfather 'Abdul Muttalib who was 80 years of age. 'Abdul-Muttalib died two years later at the age of 82, leaving the care and custody of the orphaned Muhammad (P.B.U.H) to Abu Talib his uncle who showed him affection even more than his own children. He always kept the child in his company and travelled with him through the caravan routes to Syria and Egypt in the north and northwest and Yemen in the south. It was during one of this trade journeys that a Christian monk by the name Bahira noticed an applelike seal of prophet hood below the shoulder of Muhammad (P.B.U.H). He advised his uncle to take great care of the young Muhammad who was only twelve years and take him back to Makkah.

As a young boy he looked after his uncle's herds and he was also fond of sitting in the circles of the elders to gain wisdom unlike other youths who indulged in social evils. Muhammad was popularly known as 'al-Ameen' for his unimpeachable character by the Makkans and visitors alike. The title Al-Ameen means the Honest, the Reliable and the Trustworthy, and it signified the highest standard of moral and public life.

Marriage to lady khadija

Upon hearing of Muhammad's good character, Khadija Bint Khuwaylid, a rich merchant widow, asked Muhammad (P.B.U.H) to take some merchandise for trade to Syria. It is written that in the trade caravans, her merchandise usually equaled that of the whole tribe put together.

She was the daughter of Khuwaylid ibn Asad ibn 'Abdul-'Uzza ibn Qusayi. Soon after this trip Khadija realized that Muhammad had brought more profits than she had been getting previously. Muhammad was twenty-five when Khadija proposed marriage to him through her friend Nafisa who immediately went to inform him. He accepted the proposal and requested his uncle to discuss the matter with Khadija's uncle Umar ibn Asad. At that time, Khadija was twice widowed and forty years old. They got six children; four daughters and two sons. His first son Qassim died at



the age of two. His second son Abdullah died in infancy. The four daughters were: Zainab, Ruqayyah, Umm Kulthum, and Fatimah (R.A)

Baath and first revelation

The hrophet's life attracted everybody's respect and honor. He won the confidence of Khadija, his wife, as well as other people in Makka from his positive character. For the next fifteen years, he dedicated his life to meditation and worship contrary to the norms of social evils practiced at that time. Unknowingly, he was protected by Allah (S.W.T) from the evils that prevailed and occupied the culture of the people.

He used to go to the cave Hira at Jabal Nur (Mt. Nur) in the outskirts of Makka. In this place, he would pray to Allah (S.W.T) for deliverance from the dirty practices that were common and the darkness of worshipping idols. Every aspect of creation gave him the hope of a way of life that would exclude him from the immoral practices. He would stay there for a number of days before going home. This practice continued and became part of his programme.

One night during the month of Ramadhan, at the age of forty, while in the cave, Jibril (S.A) came in human form and told him, "I am Jibril, and you are Allah's messenger ...". Then he told the hrophet, "Read!" The prophet answered him, "I cannot read," Jibril squeezed him hard and repeated the same words while the prophet gave the same answer. On the third time the prophet asked, "What shall I read?" Jibril told him:

"Read in the name of your lord who created

Who created man from a clot.

Read: And the Lord is the most Bounteous,

Who teaches by the pen,

Teaches man that which he knew not... [Q: 96:1-5]

Muhammad repeated the words until they permanently stuck in his memory before the disappearance of Jibril (A.S). These verses marked the first revelation of the Quran that would continue for the next twenty three years of his life.

After the sudden disappearance of Jibril (A.S), he could still re-visualize him and could recall the words. A mixture of fear and shock had engulfed him. He could not stay in the cave, so he went back home while still having this vision his mind. At home he related what had happened to Khadija. She



had a strong belief that her husband could neither be injured nor harmed by evils and spirits because of the record of virtues that he practiced. He was quite depressed by the occasion. More often he would see Jibril in his vision wherever he was and he would tell Khadija, “dathiruni i.e. cover me up.”

There was a duration in which the revelation paused after the first verses of Surat ul Alaq this period is known as Fatra, but still the prophet would see the vision of Jibril (A.S) and say, “dathiruni i.e. cover me up.” After a while Jibril appeared again, and this time with the first seven verses of Surat ul Mudathir:

“O you wrapped up (in a mantle).

Stand and warn (the people) Arise and deliver thy warning!

And thy Lord do you magnify!

And thy garments keep free from stain!

And all abomination shun!

But for thy Lord’s (cause) be patient and constant...” [Q: 74:1-7]

This was an indicator of a turning point to the life of Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) from an ordinarily viewed Muhammad of the Banu Hashim clan, to a globally esteemed and divinely distinguished role model in the service of Allah (S.W.T). Unlike the other men of Makka, he had been anointed as the last messenger of Allah (S.W.T.), an opportunity that never before or after would be shared with, or seized by any other creature. He had received the honor of undertaking the divine responsibility of leading others in the worship of Allah (S.W.T). He had a mission of delivering the rest of mankind from idolatry and directing them towards the worship of Allah (S.W.T). The shape of the moral pattern of life lay in his effort as per the will of Allah (S.W.T). It was inclusions of his name into the chain of prophets of Allah (S.W.T), and above that a seal of that chain of Prophet Hood. Above all, he had been bestowed with the great honor of receiving the Quran, which is the seal of the divine books of Allah (S.W.T), for the guidance of mankind and a testimony to all creatures.

Early Muslim community

After receiving Wahyi, the prophet’s mission was to preach Islam to the entire Ummah. It was his obligation to preach the oneness of Allah to the Quraish who were worshipping Idols and offering



sacrifices to them. Most of the people were unbelievers and practiced polytheism. The prophet started preaching in secret and mostly to his family members and close friends.

He managed to get a few followers who accepted to convert to Islam. Among the very first people to convert came from his family household. These included Khadija Binti Khuwaylid (hrophet's first wife), his cousin Ali bin Abi Talib (RA), and Abubakar Assidiq (R.A), the prophets dearest friend and Zaid bin Harith (R.A), his adopted son.

Several other people in Makka embraced Islam and strengthened the religion making it gain popularity. The first early converts included among others; Uthman Bin Affan, Saad Bin Abi Waqas, Zubeir Bin Awwam, Talha Bin Ubaidullah, Abdurrahman Bin Auf and Az-Zuhri. After three years of preaching the religion in secrecy nearly forty people had converted to Islam and accepted to follow the Islamic teachings. Allah (S.W.T) commanded the prophet (P.B.U.H) to preach to the people openly and warn them against polytheism.

Almighty Allah (S.W.T) says, ***“Therefore expound openly what you are commanded, and turn away from those who join false gods with Allah.”*** [Q: 15:94]

After the prophet was commanded to preach openly, he gathered the Makkan people at Mount Safa and addressed them on the Oneness of Allah (S.W.T). The hrophet thus said, “eou see if I were to tell you that there were some horse men in the valley planning to raid you, will you believe me?” They said: “ees, we have only witnessed the truth from you.” He said, “I am a Warner to you before a severe torment.” Although the people had known the prophet as a very honest person, they refused to accept him as a prophet. His own uncle called Abu Lahab cursed the prophet by telling him, “May you Perish this day. Have you called us here for such a thing (believing in one God) that you made us to gather here?” Allah was angered by Abu Lahab's remarks on the hrophet (h.B.U.H) and a Surah was revealed called Suratul- Lahab. In this surah, Allah the Almighty condemned Abu Lahab together with his wife.

Allah says in the Quran,

“Perish the hands of the father of flame! Perish he!

No profit to him from his wealth, and all his gains!

Burnt soon will he be in a fire of blazing flame!

His wife shall carry the (cracking) wood as fuel!

A twisted rope of palm leaf fibre round her (own) neck!”[Q: 111]



Persecution

What do you understand by the word persecution? In your live experience, have you undergone any hardships? Mention a few of these situations to your friend. Persecution refers to the subjection of pain to an individual or group of people in order to discourage them from carrying out their endeavors.

The Quraish were not pleased to see that several people were embracing Islam. They held meetings to plan how they would stop the prophet and his companions from preaching and practicing Islam. Under the leadership of Abu Lahab, the prophet's own uncle, plans were put in place to stop the spread of Islam. The new and weak converts were to be subjected to intimidation, threats and physical torture. Several other methods were used to punish and discourage the Prophet of Allah and his companions for accepting Islam as the true and only religion.

Methods of persecution

Each of the leaders among the Quraish began persecuting any one in their clan who was following Islam. They used various methods among them were the following:

- The prophet and the early Muslims were pelted with stones as they walked in the streets of Makka.
- Abu Lahab forced his two sons who had married Ruqayyah and Ummu Kulthum (daughters of the prophet) to divorce them.
- Ummu Jamil Bint Harb, who was Abu Suffiyyan's sister and the wife of Abu Lahab, used to tie bundles of thorns with ropes and place them on the prophet's path.
- The Makkan's used to rebuke the Muslims and abuse them whenever they saw them.
- UmmulJamil recited the following words of disrespect; "We have disobeyed the dispraised one, rejected his call and alienated ourselves from his religion."
- Uqbah bin AbiMu'ait put the intestines of the camel on the shoulders of the prophet while he was in Swalat.



- Walid ibn Mughira would speak ill about the prophet's character Allah (S.W.T) says, ***“Heed not the type of despicable man, ready with oaths, a slanderer going about with calumnies, (habitually) hindering (all) good, transgressing beyond bounds, deep in sin.”*** [Q:68:10 – 12]
- The Quraish barred the prophet and the Muslims from offering prayers in the public and in the Kaaba.
- Some companions of the prophet like Bilal bin Rabah and Ammar bin Yassir were tied on donkeys and dragged through the town in the scorching sand.
- In other cases, iron armors were put on the companions who would then be left in the hot sun to fry. This happened to Bilal bin Rabah.
- Female slaves like An-Nahdiyah and Zanirah were mistreated by their masters and denied food for embracing Islam until Abubakar paid for their freedom.
- Khabbab bin Al-Arath, who was a slave would be dragged by her hair, and her neck was twisted then she was thrown into the fire until her back was burnt.
- Muslims were also killed cruelly. Summaiya was bayoneted with a red hot iron by Abu Jahal until she died.
- Ammar and his parents were forced to repeatedly lie on burning sand as they were severely beaten.
- Bilal bin Rabah was severely beaten by his master Umayyah bin Khalaf. He would be dragged through the streets on bear chest. A heavy stone was placed on his chest to force him to denounce Islam.
- Uthman bin Affan used to be wrapped in a mat of palm leaves then fire would be set under him.
- Mus'ab bin Umair was denied food and water by her mother and when she saw that he was not ready to denounce Islam, she expelled him from her house.

Migration to Abyssinia (615 C.E)

Abyssinia is the current Ethiopia. Islam was getting many converts day by day despite the torture they got from the Quraish. When the persecutions became unbearable to the newly converted Muslims, the prophet (P.B.U.H) advised them to migrate to Abyssinia. It was a Christian King called Negus (Najash Ash-ham) who was known for his tolerance and knowledge about religious issues and was very hospitable.



Abyssinia was a peaceful country and far away from Makkah. This would help the Muslims to settle down and continue with their new faith. Fourteen men and one woman sneaked through the rough desert and fled to Abyssinia. Each day the number of the asylums gradually increased. The prophet (P.B.U.H) was left behind to continue with the propagation of Islam. The Makkans were infuriated by the news of the Muslim's migration to Abyssinia. They sent delegations to the court of King Negus to ask him to hand the Muslims back to them. This was in the year 615 C.E. King Negus was a good listener, wise and just. He listened to both parties and disapproved the Quraish allegations against the Muslims and gave the Muslims freedom of staying in Abyssinia for as long as they would not interfere with the peace.

Results of the Muslims migration to Abyssinia

We have seen that after several persecutions, the prophet advised the Muslims to migrate. This migration was a sigh of relief for them and the following were the results:

1. Muslims lived peacefully in Abyssinia.
2. There was intermarriage between the Abyssinians and the Muslims.
3. Many Abyssinians converted to Islam at that time.
4. Trade flourished in Abyssinia.
5. Muslims were able to practice their faith freely and peacefully.
6. The disappointed Quraish decided to look to intensify their persecutions against the prophet and the Muslims who had been left in Makkah.

Boycott of the Banu Hashim (617-620 C.E)

The pagans were not happy to see the Banu Hashim protecting the Prophet. In their struggle to get rid of the prophet they met at a place called Wa'di-l Muhassab, an oath was taken and an agreement written by Bagheed bin Amir bin Hashim was signed. It contained the following rules:

- The other Arab tribes should not conduct any business dealings with the Banu Hashim.
- No inter-marriage was to take place between them and any other tribe.
- There should be neither social relations nor interactions like visiting them.
- There should be no communication whatsoever.
- The Banu Hashim should not enter the Kaaba.



- Food and water supply was not allowed to reach them.

This boycott took place between 617-620 C.E and the Banu Hashim and the sympathizers of the prophet were confined in a mountainous valley known as Shi'b Abu Talib which was hostile for human habitation. This lasted for a period of three years. The agreement was attached at the Ka'aba. The prophet cursed him and his hand got paralyzed

As time went by, the Makkans developed mixed feelings and some started sympathizing with their expelled kinsmen. A special group was formed to campaign for abolishing the agreement. Abu Jahal was consulted several times but he refused. After a hot argument, it was discovered that the whole piece of paper on which the agreement had been written had been eaten by ants. The boycott was therefore lifted and the Muslims were allowed to come back to Makka.

Circumstances that led to the Boycott of the Banu Hashim

1. Failure of the Makkans to convince the newly converted Muslims to go back to their traditional religion.
2. Failure by the Makkans to bring back the Muslims from Abyssinia.
3. Islam was against the Makkans religion.
4. Makkans were alarmed by the increasing number of Muslims.
5. The Makkans failure to stop the prophet from preaching Islam.
6. Failure of the Makkans to persuade Abu Twalib, who had persistently promised to protect the prophet, to stop his nephew from preaching Islam.
7. The Makkans were alarmed by the conversion of Umar bin Khattab to Islam.
8. Islam was rapidly spreading beyond Makka e.g. Abyssinia.

Effects of Boycott of the Banu Hashim

1. It resulted in the death of Khadija and Abu Twalib (the strong pillars of the prophet P.B.U.H).
2. Spread of Islam came to a standstill for sometime in Makka.
3. The Muslims suffered economic hardships.
4. It inflicted mental torture to the prophet and the Muslims were psychologically affected.



5. The Muslims became weak due to hunger and starvation.
6. Others became seriously sick while others died.
7. The attention of the prophet was diverted from preaching to attending to the welfare of the Muslims.
8. It restricted the prophet's audience to outsiders since they would not move outside the cave.
9. It strengthened the prophet's determination to continue with his mission.

The Year of Sorrow (A'm-ul Huzn)

How do you mourn a bereavement or a loss? It may be loss of money or any other important item in life. It is normal for any human being to feel a sense of loss once someone close to him or her dies. This was no exception for the prophet when he lost two pillars of support; that is, his dear wife, Khadija who gave him financial and moral support, and his uncle Abu Talib who always protected him from the malice of the Quraish. The prophet as a human being was bereaved, depressed and tensed. Therefore Allah (S.W.T) granted him a miraculous journey to uplift his spirit towards Islam. We shall now look at the miraculous journey also known as Isra wal Mi'raaj.

Israai wal mi'raaj (620 C.E)

This episode is in two parts starting with the Israai. This term literally means a night journey. It is the famous miraculous night journey embarked by the prophet (P.B.U.H) escorted by Angel Jibril (A.S) from Makkah to Jerusalem in Masjidul Maqdas. Allah (S.W.T) says:-

“Glorified be He who carried His servant by night from the inviolable place of worship (Makkah) to the far distant place of worship (Jerusalem) the neighborhood where of we have blessed that we might show him of our tokens! Lo! He only He is the hearer, the seer.” [Q: 17:1]

The second part which is Mi'raaj literally means a ladder. This is the ascension of the prophet (P.B.U.H) from Jerusalem (Baitul Maqdis) through the space to the seventh heaven during. This remarkable journey took place in the year 620 C.E

Reasons for Israai wal Mi'raaj



- Allah wanted to console the Prophet (P.B.U.H) from the hardships he had been experiencing from the Quraish in terms of persecutions.
- Allah (S.W.T) wanted to give the prophet (P.B.U.H) an opportunity to experience His great power and Might so as to fill his heart with full confidence, belief, faith and reliance on Him.
- To prepare the prophet (P.B.U.H) for the great mission that was ahead of him such as migration (Hijra) and the everlasting confrontation with polytheism (Kufr).
- To give the believers hope and courage to look forward to better days ahead from their noble religion of Islam.

Significance of Israai wal Mi'raaj

- It signified that prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was the leader of the two Qiblas i.e. Baitul Maqdis and Masjidul Haraam in Makkah.
- It showed that prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was a true successor of the messengers before him.
- Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was declared as the leader (Imam for the generations to come).
- It pre-ordained that Islamic religion was to stay up to the end of time (Yaum-ul-mahshar).
- It clearly indicated the finality of prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H)
- It distinguished between the true believers and false ones. Some Muslims denounced Islam after the episode of Israai & Miiraaj when Abu Jahal doubted about the journey, the prophet (P.B.U.H) confronted them in the morning with facts about his whole journey.
- It clearly strengthened the faith of Abu Bakr who was the first to believe in the prophet when he came back.
- It signified the position and the status of Masjid Aqswaa to Muslims and as the gateway to Masjid Haraam.
- It shows the prominence of Swalat and its position in a Muslim's life. It was in the journey of Miiraaj that the prophet was given the five daily prayers.
- The journey highlighted the penalties for certain social evils in the society such as backbiting, fornication (Zinaa), denying orphans their wealth, those who desist from paying Zakat; among other evils.
- The journey underscored the importance of Masjid Aqswaa as a holy or sacred trust to all Muslims and it is their religious obligation to guard it from any form of destruction.
- It signifies how Allah honors the prophet by bestowing upon him such a miraculous journey.



The Prophet's Mission in Madina

Beginning of the Muslim Mission

Madinatu-Rasool (the city of the prophet) is the name of the settlement originally referred to as Yathrib. It was inhabited by the Arab tribes of Aws and Khazraj as well as certain Jewish tribes. The two tribes of Aws and Khazraj used to visit Makka during the pilgrimage season and also to attend to business affairs. The prophet (P.B.U.H) used to preach to every group that came for pilgrimage or for business in his quest to present Islam to them. It was during these visits that he met with six people from the tribe of Khazraj who accepted Islam. The prophet then asked them if they would support him in propagating Islam in Yathrib as his base. Due to the clashes between Aus and Khazraj, this group agreed with the prophet on people who would go and preach the message of Islam and peace to the other tribes in Yathrib. They requested the prophet to postpone this request till the following year. When they reached Yathrib, Allah (S.W.T) had willed the spread of Islam in Yathrib and the tribes of Aus and Khazraj sorted out most of their differences. At the end of the year, they returned to Makka with a group of ten Khazrajites and two Aws. They agreed to meet the prophet at the valley of Aqaba which is in Mina. The Yathribites then promised the prophet and Muslims their support to Yathrib- a journey referred to as *Hijra*.

Terms of the First Covenant of Aqaba (621C.E)

Have you been involved in any agreement with your friend? What were some of the reasons that led to the two of you entering into this agreement? This could be termed as a covenant. It is an agreement usually formal entered into by two or more persons to do or not to get involved in something. It may contain some set of rules which we refer to as 'terms' that govern the conduct of those involved. This happened when the prophet met some Yathribites at the valley of Aqaba. They agreed on the following:

- i. They should worship one God.
 - ii. They should abstain from evils.
 - iii. They should obey the laws of Allah (SWT) and His prophet.
- After their discussion, the prophet chose Mus'ab bin Ummair and Abdullah bin Umm Makhtum to teach the Yathribites more about Islam. When these people returned to Yathrib, they propagated Islam to such an extent that Islam was the only topic in every home.



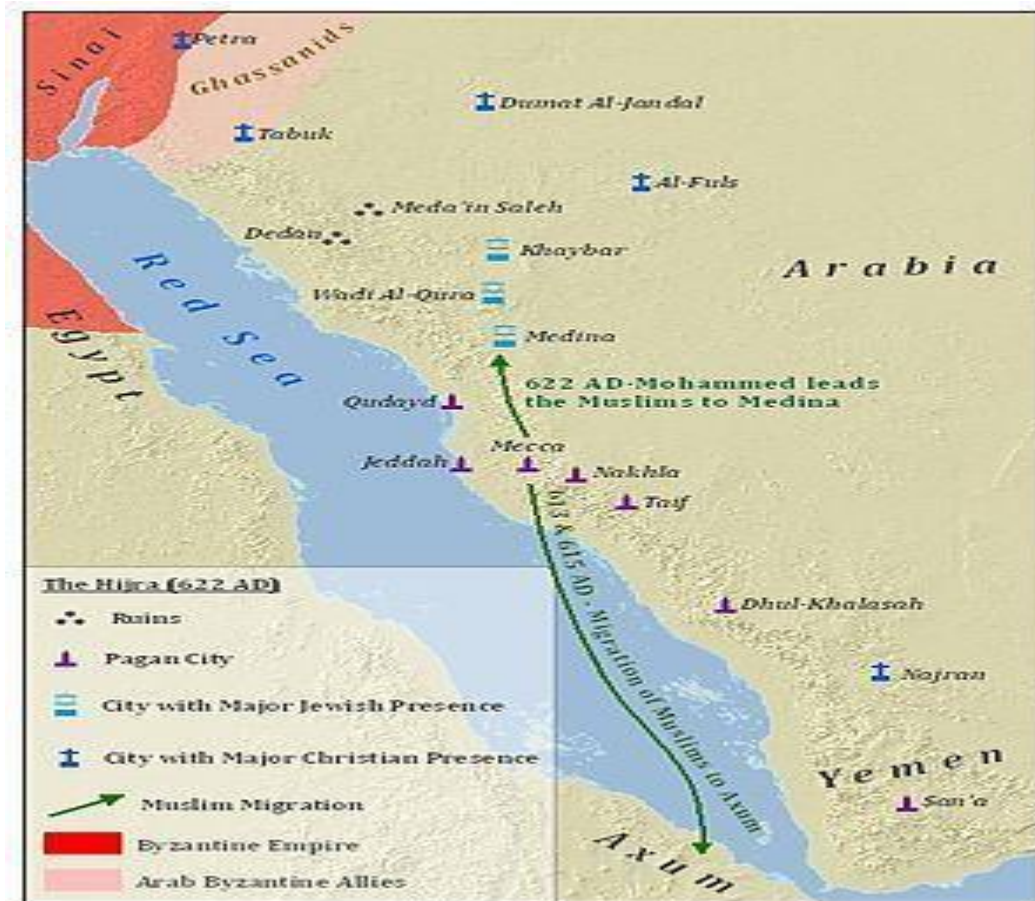
The Second Covenant of Aqaba (622 C.E)

In the year 622 C.E, during the next pilgrimage, a group of 72 Yathribites including two women came to Makka. They met the prophet and his uncle Abbas at Aqaba, who addressed them thus, “My nephew has always been regarded as the noblest and held in high esteem by his people. If you wish to take him to Madina, first, be sure that you are able to uphold the agreement, fulfill your covenant, and protect him against his enemies. If you are unable to do so, then do not take this responsibility and leave him with his people instead.” The leader of the eathribites replied: “We are taking full responsibility. In fact this is the very reason we are pledging this allegiance to him.”

They, therefore, promised to defend him fully and were prepared not to break this agreement under any circumstance. They also swore to worship one God and leave according to the teachings of Islam. The prophet accepted their offer to migrate to Yathrib and he appointed twelve leaders from among them saying, “eou are responsible to your people just as the disciples ofIssa bin Maryam were responsible to him and I am responsible to my people. The twelve agreed to represent the prophet in Yathrib until his arrival.

Muslim Emigration to Madina

The following map illustrates the route that was used by the Muslims during Hijra.



You must have learnt in History about migration of people from one region to another. For example, the Bantu speaking people are said to have originated from Shungwaya in the Congo basin to come and settle in the parts of East Africa. What are some of the reasons that may lead to such migration? In History of Islam however, the reasons you have given may not apply. The prophet had the responsibility of ensuring that Islam spread far and wide and had to protect the few who had converted to Islam.

This started when the Quraish learnt of the pledge of Aqaba and intensified their torture against the Muslims. As a result of this the prophet permitted the Muslims to secretly start migrating to Madina. The noble swahabas (companions) obeyed immediately and they started migrating. Among the first to migrate were Abu Salama, his wife and son. However, Ummu Salama was prevented by her



family members from migrating until a year later. Meanwhile, the other Muslims continued leaving in small groups. They travelled for several days through the rocky and dusty villages until they reached the first village, known as Quba' which is 1 km south of Makkah. They were received warmly by the Yathribites and they stayed here for a period of two weeks. The Yathribites welcomed them into their homes selflessly and this earned the Yathribites the title *Ansaar* which means 'helpers.'

Abubakar (RA) and Ali (RA) were not among this first group that arrived in Yathrib. This is because the prophet had planned that Abubakar should migrate with him. Upon learning this, Abubakar purchased two camels in preparation for the journey.

Migration of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) to Madina

The Quraish sensed more danger when they realized that over one hundred Muslim families had already settled in Madina. They were afraid that the Muslims would join forces with the two tribes in Madina i.e. Aus and Khazraj and become very powerful. Therefore, they called for a meeting at Dar-un Nadwa to discuss measures that would be taken against the prophet. In the meeting, the following three suggestions were put forward:-

- i. The prophet should be tied in chains and imprisoned behind strong bars.
- ii. The prophet to be banished from Makkah.
- iii. The prophet to be eliminated by way of murdering him.

After a long discussion, they all agreed on Abu Jahal's advice that the prophet should be killed. In order that no single person or clan could be blamed, they chose one man from each of the twelve tribes to participate in the murder. However, Allah had already informed the prophet about the evil plan of the pagans and through Angel Jibril He instructed him to Madina the same night they had plotted to kill him. He therefore, asked Abubakar to prepare for their departure.

Meanwhile, the prophet's house had already been surrounded by a number of youth from the various tribes of the Quraish. The prophet asked Ali (R.A) to stay behind and lay on the prophet's bed and in the morning return all the valuables that had been kept under the custody of the prophet to their owners. The prophet then emerged from his house and flung a handful of sand in the direction of the pagans while reciting the opening verses of Surat Yasin. This resulted in them falling asleep and they did not see the prophet leave for Abubakar's house. They then emerged from the backdoor of



Abubakar's house and headed towards the cave of Thaur. They entered and hid in the cave. The prophet immediately went to sleep because of the long journey they had gone through. He was woken up by the tears of the Abubakar who was feeling pain because he had been stung by a poisonous insect. The prophet then immediately used his saliva to apply on Abubakar's foot and the pain stopped immediately.

Meanwhile the Quraish leaders were very upset upon learning that the prophet had escaped and left Ali on his bed. They dispatched search parties all around Makka and promised a hundred camel reward for whoever captured the prophet dead or alive. The Makkans were motivated by the reward and they started combing the entire area until some group entered the entrance to the cave. They even employed a Bedouin fortune teller who had the skills of tracing footsteps. He trailed the Prophet and Abubakar until he reached the entrance of the cave of Thaur. Abubakar was afraid that they might be caught but the prophet comforted him by reminding him that Allah was with them. Allah hid them from being seen by the pagans when he inspired a spider to weave a web across the entrance of the cave. (This is referred to as the miracle of the cave). Furthermore a pigeon laid an egg at the entrance by the will of Allah and then a nearby tree bent its branches until they covered the entrance into the cave. Finally, the group carrying out the search with the advice of Umayyah bin Khalaf left the place without entering the cave after arguing that there were no traces of anyone having gone into the cave. This miracle of the cave teaches us that:

- Islam is the true religion chosen by Allah(S.W.T)
- Muslim should always rely on Allah (S.W.T) for their protection.
- All creations obey the command of Allah(S.W.T).

They remained hidden in the cave for three days. During this period, Abdullah, the son of Abubakar used to update them at night with the news of Makkah while Asma bint Abubakar brought them food. By the end of the three days, the Makkan troupes had already given up their search. On the fourth day, the freed slave of Abubakar brought them the two camels that had been bought by Abubakar. He was accompanied by Abdullah bin Ariqet who was to guide them through a secret route to Madina.

The prophet's arrival at Quba

The Ansaars were eagerly awaiting the prophet's arrival. They kept checking every day in the plains but there was no sign until one day when one Jew who had been ascended a high tower spotted the



approaching group. He then shouted, “He for whom you have been waiting has arrived.” The prophet was then hosted by Banu Aws. He remained at Quba for a few days in which the Muslims undertook the task of constructing the first mosque called ‘the mosque of piety.’ The prophet worked in participation with other Muslims until the mosque was completed. Ali (RA) joined them while they had camped at Quba.

Arrival in Madina

The prophet and the Muslims set out for Madina on a Friday of Rabiul Awwal 622 C.E. The inhabitants of Madina woke up early awaiting the arrival of the prophet (P.B.U.H). As he entered the city his camel was surrounded by excited Ansaar as they called out Takbeer in joy. Each of the families tried to tag at the camel’s reins so that it would stop at their homes. They were offering their homes, wealth and lives to the prophet (h.B.U.H). The prophet thus said, ‘Leave the camel as it is, for it is guided by Allah (and will stop wherever it is ordered to stop).’ Finally the camel sat down in the home of Abu Ayub Khalid Al Ansaari in an area inhabited by Banu An-Najjar. He stayed in this home until a house was built for him. The people of Yathrib agreed to change its name to Madina tun Nabi which the city of the prophet or Madinatul Munawwara; The city of light. Upon arrival in Madina, the prophet had the following tasks to perform:

i. Construction of a Mosque

Have you been involved in the construction of any building? What are some of the materials that must be available during any such construction? Among the things you have mentined is the palce where the construction has to take place. When the Muslims came to Madina, they did not have enough land to carry out all their activities. This therefore prompted Abubakar to purchase the piece of land on which the prophet’s camel had rested when they first arrived in Madina. It belonged to two orphans who had decided to give it free of charge but the prophet insisted that they had to be paid. The construction of the prophet’s mosque began immediately with both the Ansaar and the Muhajirun taking up various tasks. The prophet actively took part by carrying bricks as he recited various verses of the Quran and Dua. One of the duas he said was, “O Allah! No bliss is there but that of the hereafter I beseech you to forgive the immigrants and the helpers.” The ninety square meter mosque was completed by



an additional two rooms to accommodate his family and a place was also reserved to the North to cater for the homeless.

ii. **Rehabilitation of the Muhajirun from Makkah**

It was the main test of the prophet in ensuring that Islamic brotherhood was going to be established. The Ansaar had been taking care of the Muhajirun who left most of their belongings in Makka. The prophet united both the Ansaar and Muhajirun and the former were to continue sharing their wealth with the latter. They even adopted some of them into their homes and built homes for others. Employment was provided to them from large plantations while financial support was given to others to start up small businesses. This was a very unique and historical bond and it came to be referred to as '*Muwakhaat*'. The prophet had achieved in establishing the Muslim brotherhood within a few months.

iii. **Fostering Unity Among the Tribes of Madina**

The prophet had an important task of regulating the lives of all the citizens of Madina who included the Jews, Christians, the pagans, the two Arab tribes of Aws and Khazraj and the Ansaar and Muhajirun in order to foster unity and harmony. He therefore it was necessary for him to establish the Madinan charter which constituted a set of rules and regulations meant to govern all the citizens of Madina and is commonly known as "The Madinan constitution."

Relationship between the Ansaar and Muhajirun

1. The Ansaar and Muhajirun were united by the bond of Islamic brotherhood.
2. The Ansaar showed charity by sharing their wealth with the Muhajirun.
3. The Ansaar also adopted their fellow brother into their homes.
4. They even built houses for others.
5. Some found jobs for them to do on the plantations.
6. Others gave the Muhajirun in support in starting their own businesses.



Madinan Constitution

Any organization will always have its own rule and regulations to govern them. It is because of the individual differences of the members of the society or country that it becomes necessary to formulate laws that will harmonise all the operations of the organization. These set of rules or laws are included in the document we call a constitution. A constitution can be defined as a law determining the fundamental political principles of a government or an organisation. In Kenya, for example, we had a referendum in 2007 to vote for the new constitution which was passed by the Kenyans. It consists of a set of fundamental principles or established precedents according to which a state or other organization is governed. These rules together make up or constitute, what the entity is. When these principles are written down into a single collection or set of legal documents, those documents may be said to comprise a written constitution.

The Madinan constitution therefore was an agreement between the Muslims and the other Arabian tribes in Madina, the Jews, Christians and Polytheists to regulate relations and ensure peace between all of them. It was a written agreement and the first political agreement between Muslims and non Muslims whose principles were based on the Quran and Sunnah. It's also the first constitution and the greatest political document ever known in History.

We shall now look at the major terms of this document:

As we have mentioned above, any constitution will comprise of rules to govern those who agree to adhere to it. The Madinan constitution also had its terms as follows:

The Ansaar and Muhajirun shall constitute one group of Umma to the exclusion of others.

All Muhajirun shall take the 2. responsibility of their own wards, shall pay blood among them and shall also ransom their prisoners in the event of war.

The people of Banu Aws and 3.

the six other tribes will be



Importance of the Madinan Constitution

- a. It was an attempt to bring reconciliation of all the tribes and prevent the Madinan tribes from frequent tribal wars.
- b. It outlined the principles for establish good relationship between the Muslims and non Muslims.
- c. The prophet's position as the supreme leader and controller of all affairs of Madina as a state and arbitrator of any dispute so as to bring peace was declared.
- d. The constitution summarized the rights of all the Madina citizens such as; freedom of speech thought and worship.
- e. It ensured protection of life and property and discouraged all types of crimes like murder, stealing among others.
- f. The Muslims and Islam were protected against the plots of the Jews and the hypocrites.
- g. It proved the Prophet as a great leader. He was able to organize Madina and free it from tyranny, tribalism, selfishness and dictatorship.



Challenges in Madina

Even though the prophet was welcomed in Madina, his stay was not peaceful because of the mayhem caused by the Quraish of Makka and a few tribes in Madina. They include the following:

1. A clan of Khazraj headed by Abdullah ibn Ubayy who had been expecting to take over as a king of Yathrib. He therefore pretended to revert to Islam together with his supporters (Munafiqun). They had not been happy with the prophet's advancement and started causing mischief among the believers.
2. The Jews staying in Madina also opposed the prophet when the verse came directing Muslims to change the Qibla from Jerusalem to Makka. (Read Q: 2:146) They secretly contacted the Makkan Pagans and started to work against the interest of the Muslims. They also rejected Prophet Mohammad because the messenger they had expected to come was to be from their tribe.
3. The Quraish started sending troops to kill the prophet and his companions.
4. Often, they interfered with business activities by looting the towns and destroyed the Arab trade in the region by paralyzing all business activities.
5. They also sent raiding parties with the intention of destroying fruit trees, plantations and carrying away animals.
6. The Makkans conspired with the Munafiqun to rebel against the prophet and Muslims.
7. The Quraish went ahead to form alliances with other tribes with the aim of to dislodging Islam and the Muslims.
8. The Quraish leaders spread negative information about the prophet i.e. they said that he was a seeker chased from his motherland in order to discourage people from embracing Islam.

Despite all these challenges, the prophet remained patient awaiting Allah's command

Hijra as a Turning Point in the History of Islam

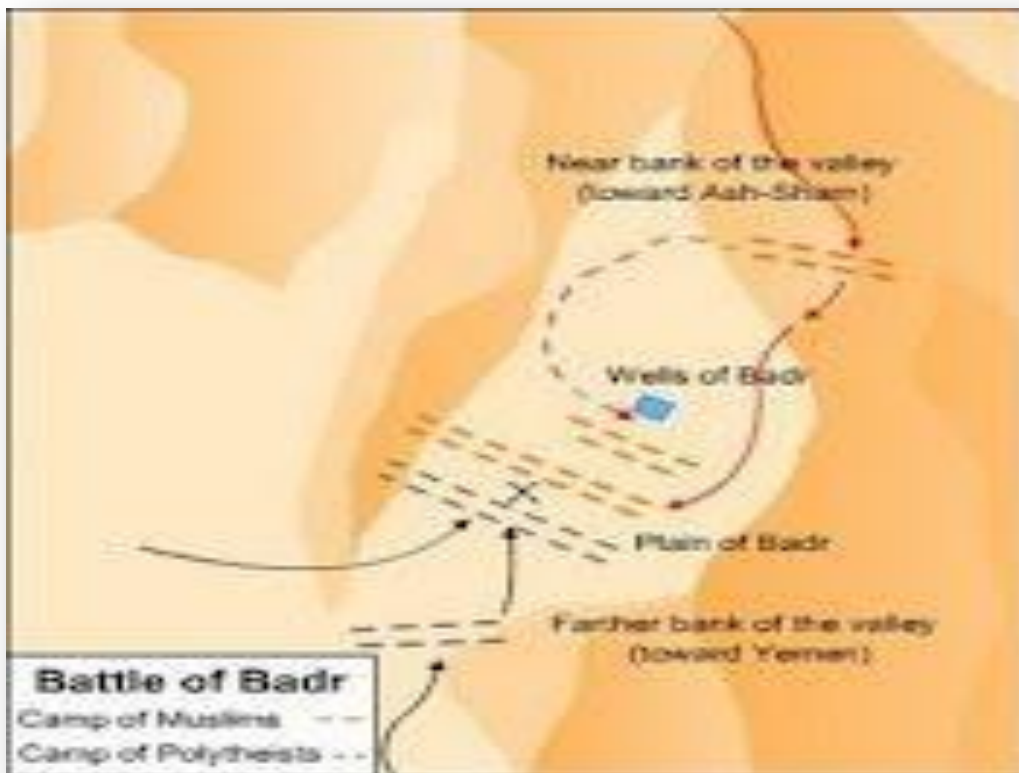
1. The prophet received a warm welcome from the people of Yathrib who were eager to learn Islam as compared to the Makkan Quarish who used to persecute Muslims.
2. There was rapid spread of Islam after Hijra as opposed to earlier on.
3. After Hijra, Islam came to triumph over the pagan religions and was soon the religion for the whole of Arabian Peninsula and even expanded further.
4. Muslims were able to conduct their affairs peacefully in Yathrib Madina resulting in the expansion of trade and an organized army.
5. The first mosque "Masjidul Quba" was constructed and Muslims could pray freely.



6. Muslims were able to fight in defense of their religion and won in most of the battles because of the strength they built after travelling to Madina.
7. Hijra marks the beginning of the Islamic Calendar at the time of Umar al Khattab
8. Muslims got a city of their own and changed the name Yathrib to Madina.

Importance of Hijra in the history of Islam

1. There was rapid spread of Islam outside Makka since the Muslims were no longer in fear of Quraish attack.
2. Islam came to triumph over the pagan religion and was soon considered the religion for the entire Arabian Peninsula.
3. Muslims were living in peace and could therefore conduct their affairs without interference. This resulted in expansion of trade and consequently stabilizing their economy.
4. Due to the prevailing peace, the prophet was able to organize the Muslim army in readiness for the defense of the religion.
5. The first mosque (Masjidul Quba) was constructed and thus the Muslims were able to freely worship.
6. The prophet got ample time to teach the new Muslim community Islamic laws and regulations to guide the affairs of the Muslim state.
7. The prophet and the Muslims got a city of their own and changed the name Yathrib to Madina.
8. The year of Hijra i.e. 622 AD marked the beginning of the Islamic calendar.



The Battle of BADR(2A.H/624 C.E) 17th Ramadhan

The prophet's effort to enter into peace treaties with the Jews and other tribes while in Madina was an attempt to have a community that was founded on security, harmony and freedom. However, this did not go well with the Quraish who were bitter about the migration of the prophet and his companions.

They were not happy to see the Muslims settle in Madina where they were becoming famous in their ways of life while the Islamic faith was becoming more prominent.

Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul had been previously promised leadership by the Aus and the Khazraj of Madina. However, with the migration of the prophet in Madina, majority of the inhabitants voluntarily became Muslims and preferred the leadership of the prophet over anybody else. This made Abdullah bin Ubayy together with his sympathizers to be Muslims but not absolutely dedicated. They became enemies of Islam from within. They pretended to be Muslims but actually did everything to spoil Islam and secretly oppose it. These people came to be referred to as the Munafiqun (hypocrites). They collaborated with the Quraish to give important information and also help them weaken the Muslims.



The Quraish, promising support to the Munafiqun, encouraged them to get rid of the Muslims in Madina by all means.

Abdullah bin Ubayy, driven by the failed attempt for leadership, complied with the Quraish and organized themselves to fight the Muslims, but without success.

The people from Madina were threatened when they went for Umra because of the presence of Muslims in their land. Verbal and written provocations were sent to the Muslims in Madina with all sorts of threats and hatching of plans to expel the Muslims from this important geographical position i.e. the passage to Syria.

Finally, permission to fight was given to the Muslims by Allah when the ayats were sent down that:

‘To those, against whom war is made, permission is given to (fight), because they were wronged-and verily, Allah is Most powerful for their aid.’[Q: 22:39]

Reasons that made the Quraish fight in the battle of Badr;

- The Quarish were angry because the Muslims had escaped from them.
- Islam challenged the old religion of the Quarish so the Makkans did not like the spread of the new faith.
- The Quarish feared that Muslims would block their caravans to the North.
- Confrontation between the Makkans and the Muslims who had been send to defend the caravan.
- The Makkans were jealousy of the conversion of prominent people like Hamza and Umar bin Khattab to Islam.

Muslims fought in the battle so as to:-

- a. Assert their might and instill fear among the Quarish who had always seen them as weak.
- b. Compensate for the loss the Muslims had gone through while they were in Makka.
- c. Cut off the access of the Quraish traders to Syria.



Events of the Battle

Madina was a trade link to Syria used by all the traders. In the year 624 C.E the prophet was informed of a large caravan belonging to Quraish led by Abu Sufyan that was travelling from Sham (Syria) with worthy goods and was to pass through Madina.

The prophet then told the Muslims, “Here is the caravan of the Quraish well loaded with wealth and merchandise. This is an opportunity which we cannot afford to miss” The prophet thus led to attack the caravan in revenge of what the Quraish had done to them. The prophet left Abdullah Ibu Ummi Makhtum and Lubaba Bin Abdumundhir to take care of the Muslim affairs in Madina. There were only forty people guarding this caravan.

The Muslim did not manage to intercept the caravan because the news of the Muslims plan had reached Abu Sufyan who managed to use a different route. He even informed the Quraish through a letter that he had managed to escape using the sea route but Abu Jahal insisted by saying that the Arabs should see, hear and understand that we are powerful people. The Quraish had set out more than 1000 people with 750 camels, 100 horses, 600 of the men were wearing iron armours.

When he learnt about the plan of the Quraish, he then consulted with his companions and they agreed to go ahead and fight the Quraish army. Muslim army had only 313 men armed with swords, 76 camels and two horses. The prophet said to his companions, “Allah promised me one of the two either the caravan or the army.” This was justified by the following revelation:

‘Just as your Lord ordered you out of your houses in truth, even though a party among the disbelievers dislike disputing with you concerning the truth after it was made clear, as if they were being driven to death and they (actually) saw it. Behold God promised you one of the two parties (enemy), that should be yours; you wished that the one unarmed should be yours but God willed to justify the truth according to his words and the roots of the unbelievers.’ [Q: 8:5-7].



The prophet then received Wahyi permitting them to fight thus:

“To those against whom war is made permission is granted to fight because they are wronged and verily God is most powerful for their aid. They are who have been expelled from their homes in defiance of right (for no cause) except that they say “Our Lord is our God” [Q: 22: 29-40].

“Fight in the cause of God those who fight you, but do not transgress limits, for God loves not transgressors. And slay them wherever you catch them, turn them out from where they have turned you out for tumult and oppression are worse than killing but fight them not at the sacred mosque unless they first reward of those who suppress faith. But if they cease, God is oft-forgiving, most merciful” [Q: 2: 190-192]

The tribes of Bani Adiy and Ibn Zuhra after learning that their trade caravans were safe, they did not participate in this battle. The prophet sent Ali Bin Talib, Zubeir Bin Awwam and Saad Abi Waqqas to the wells of Badr to find out about the Quraish army. They found out that it consisted of Utba and Shayba sons of Rabia, Hakim Ibu Khizam, Tuamin Bin Adiy, Nufalah Bin Khuwaylid, Abdul Baghtary bin Hisham, Iraath Bin Amr, Annadhar Bin Aswad, Umayyad Bin Khalaf and Amr Bin Hisham (Abu Jahal). This was a very strong army but the Muslims had to go for war. Habbab Bin Mundhir suggested that they should camp at the water source to deny the Quraish access. When the Quraish reached Badr, they rushed for water but the Muslims stopped them. The prophet allowed them access to the water, a move which touched Hakim Bin Hazath who suggested to Utba Rabin to give up the battle. However Abu Jahal opposed him.

Traditionally the Arab battles used to start with a combat between a few pairs were appointed from the two armies before the main battle; this is referred to as a duel. In this battle it involved Hamza Bin Abdul Muttalib, Ali Bin Abu Twalib and Ubeid Bin Harith from the Muslim's side, against Utba bin Rabia, his brother Shayba bin Rabia and Utba's son al Walid from the Quraish. Shayba was defeated and killed by Hamza; Walid was also killed by Ali. Ubeid and Utba drew each dealt a death blow to the other but Ubeid died on the way back while Utba died on the sport.



As the Quraish army was advancing Prophet raised his hands and prayed to Allah (S.W.T) and said, “O Allah! Should this group (of Muslims) be defeated today, you will no longer be worshipped.” As a result of this dua, Allah sent angels to assist the Muslims. Allah says in the Quran thus: ***“Remember you implored the assistance of your Lord and He answered you; I will assist you with a thousand Angels ranks on ranks.”*** [Q: 8:9]

The Quraish saw the number of Muslims increasing and they started retreating. The Muslims fought with courage and emerged victorious in this battle. The Muslims considered their victory as having come from Allah. It is said in the Quran by Allah (S.W.T), ***‘It is not you who slew them; It was Allah: When you threw (a handful of dust) it was not your act but Allah’s: In order that He might test the believers by a gracious trial from Himself: For God is He who hears and knows (all things.)’*** [Q8:17]

By the end of the battle, 70 enemies were killed and 70 others taken as captives. Only 14 Muslims were killed. The relatives of the 70 captives were told to pay a ransom or the captives should teach Muslims how to read and write in order to get their freedom.

Importance of the Battle

- a. It dealt a big blow to the dignity and honor of the Quarish who had considered themselves superior for many years.
- b. It is considered as a symbol for success of the power of truth over falsehood.
- c. The assistance that Muslims got from Allah (S.W.T) strengthened their faith.
- d. The victory of the Muslims gave assured continuity to Islam which would have come to an end had they been defeated.
- e. The prophet’s position as a spiritual and a state leader was confirmed by the Muslims victory.
- f. It strengthened the spirit and moral of the prophet to continue with his mission of preaching Islam.

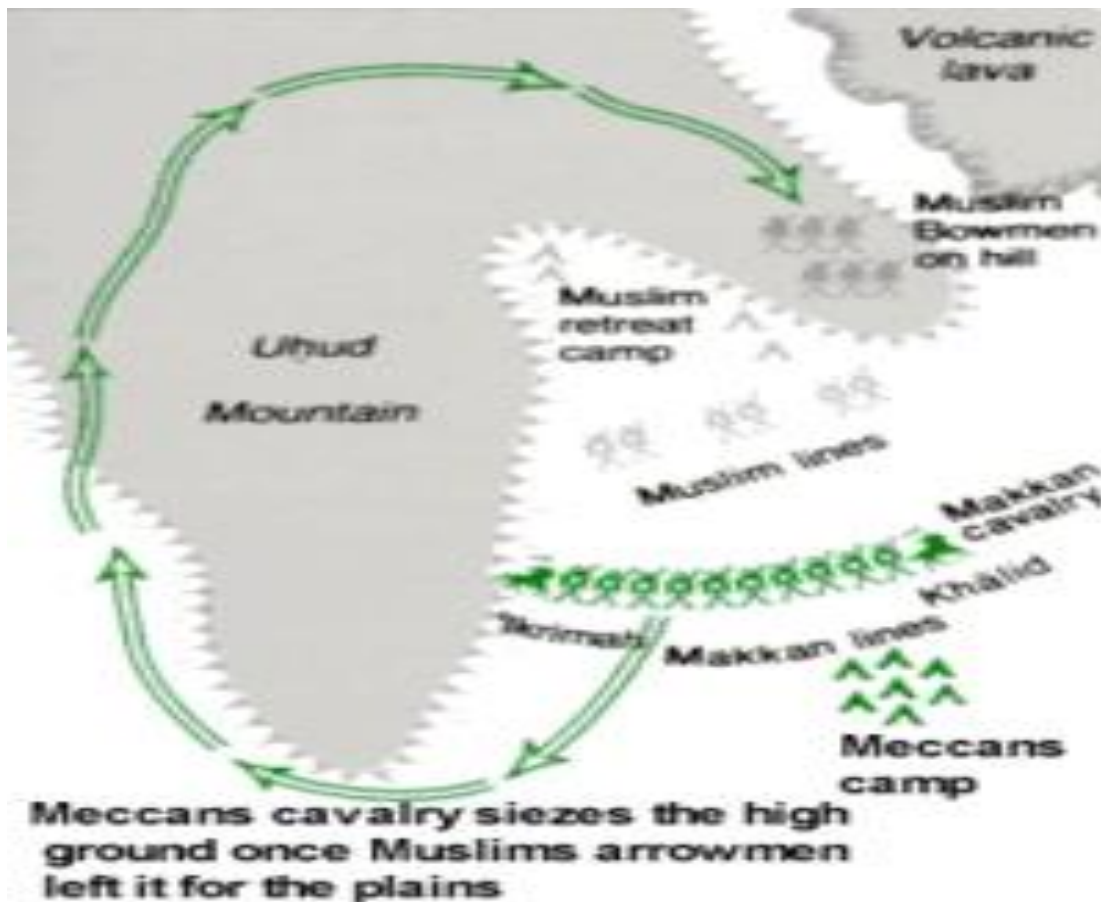


Reasons for the Muslims victory

- They had complete faith and confidence in Allah despite their number being few. On this Allah (SWT) says, ***‘O ye who believe! If you will aid (The cause of Allah) He will aid you, and plant your feet firmly.’*** [Q: 47:7]
- Unity of opinion within them. The prophet would ask for advice from the Muslim army before they decided on any matter.
- They showed obedience, love and respect to the Prophet as their leader.
- Muslims love for the hereafter gave them courage to keep fighting, since they knew of Allah (SWT) promise for those who fight for His cause
- They were courageous, determined and zealous to win over the Quraish.
- Muslims were fighting for a proper reason that to ensure that the truth triumphs over falsehood.

The battle of uhud: (3 a.h/625 c.e)

Map of the battle of uhud



This battle took place by the hill of Uhud which is about three miles outside Makka. The Quraish advanced towards the Muslims in this battle due to the following reasons;

1. They wanted to revenge against the Muslims after a humiliating defeat at the battle of Badr.
2. The Quraish wanted to re-establish their supremacy among the Arabs which they had lost during the battle of Badr.
3. They wanted to kill the prophet and bring Islam to an end before it was too late.
4. The Quraish wanted to guarantee the safety of its caravan route to Syria which had been the main cause for the battle of Uhud.

Events of the battle

Abbas, the prophet's uncle informed him of the plan by the Quraish to attack the Muslims. The prophet preferred to remain in Madina to wait for the Quraish to attack but after consultation with the majority. A force of 1000 men set out for the battle. The Quraish had gathered 3000 men, well equipped and better trained than their first army. This army was being led by Abusufian. They also brought several women to cheer them as they fought.



Just before the battle began, Abdullah bin Ubayy the leaders of the hypocrites pulled out with an army of 300 men and returned to Madina in the pretence of protecting Madina from within. As usual, the battle began with single combats who were involved then the general attack developed. The prophet placed 50 archers to protect the entrance into the hill with clear instructions not to leave their outcome.

When the Quraish were being defeated, they started running away leaving their booty behind, the Muslims soldiers became greedy of the booty and they left the entrance unguarded and went for the left booty.

Khalid bin Walid, the commander of the Quarish army saw the unguarded passage and instructed a section of the enemy to make a surprise attack from behind the hill of Uhud. This sudden attack caused confusion among the Muslims such that they thought the prophet had died until when he shouted, "I am Mohammed Bin Abdullah. I am the messenger of Allah. I have come with the truth." These words gave courage to the companions who started fighting again. Sayyiduna Abu-Bakr and Ali ran to the prophet and protected him from being killed. He was hit on the face by falling rocks and spears and he lost two teeth.

When the Muslims turned the tide of the battle, the Quarish started fleeing out of fear of defeat. The Muslims suffered a great loss in this battle. Seventy Muslims lost their lives among them Hamza the uncle of the prophet. His body was mutilated and Hind the wife of Abusufian ate his kidney. The prophet vowed to revenge the death of his uncle but Allah (S.W.T) sent the following verse:

"And if you punish, inflict the same punishment as has been afflicted on you. But if you bear patiently, it is certainly better for those who are patient; be patient for the reward of your patience is from Allah (S.W.T). do not feel sad nor distress yourself because of their plotting." [Q: 16:127]

Only 22 Quarish were killed. Following this verse, the prophet was patient and did not revenge.

IMPORTANCE OF THE BATTLE OF UHUD

1. It showed the significance of the Muslims to follow their leaders' commands i.e. the archers left the entrance unguarded disregarding the prophet's not to leave the passage.
2. It awakened the believers to their responsibility as protectors of their divine mission
3. It taught Muslims to bear hardships in their mission.
4. It explains the status of the prophet as the believed messenger of Allah and the love and mercy Allah had towards the Muslims.
5. The Muslims learnt that they shouldn't be greedy for wealth
6. They learnt that victory and defeat are in the hands of Allah
7. They learnt never to under estimate an enemy.



8. The Makkans regarded it as their first defeat over the Muslims.
9. Muslims learnt to be patient and a verse was revealed telling the prophet to show patience to the martyrs of his uncle Hamza.
10. It clearly differentiated the hypocrites like, Abdullah Ibn Ubayy from the true Muslims.
11. Muslims learnt that Allah doesn't grant victory without a proper cause.
12. Muslims learnt the importance of consultation.
13. It teaches leaders to accept the opinion of the majority.
14. Women are allowed to participate in battles as long as their presence doesn't cause an alarm e.g. Ummu Ammarah who was injured while protecting the prophet.

The Battle of Khandaq (The Trench)

This is also called the battle of Al Ahzab (tribes) because it was planned by the Jewish tribes together with the Makkans in 5 A.H (627 C.E). The defeat of the Muslims at Uhud had lowered their prestige with the Arab tribes. Some tribes which had previously supported Muslims started drifting towards the Quarish. They even started attacking the different small Muslim groups.

The Jews, despite the treaty (Madina Constitution) with the Muslims were still very bitter and showed it openly. They had expected a prophet who would give them dominion and wealth, not one who would equate them to the Arabs. When they learnt that they could not use the prophet for their own ends, they tried to shake his mission and seduce his followers. They even declared the pagan religion as superior to Islam. They then joined forces with the Makkans and broke the treaty. The prophet had thus to take action and he expelled the two Jewish tribes; Banu Nadhir and Banu Qaynuqa from Madina.

A grand plan was now hatched to finish the Muslims. The Jews and Makkans incited all the tribes to raise arms against the Muslims in Madina. They also joined forces with the Jews of Oasis Khaybar and Banu Quraizah and had gathered an army of 24,000 men, led by Abu Sufyan. This was to bar any entrance into the city of Madina by the attacking Quraish.



The messengers from Banu Khuza'a reached the prophet after four days, warning him of the armies that were to arrive in a week. The Muslims could not be able to fight such a big army in the open field.

The prophet therefore gathered the Madinans to discuss the best strategy of overcoming the enemy. Meeting the enemy in the open, and waiting for them inside the city were both suggested. Lastly, the outnumbered Muslims opted to engage in a defensive battle by digging deep trenches to act as a barrier along the northern front. This suggestion was introduced by Salman al Farsi, a Persian. Every capable Muslim in Madina including the prophet himself contributed to the digging of large and deep trench in six days. It was dug on the northern side only to obstruct any entry into the city. The other parts of Madina were surrounded by Rocky Mountains and trees, impenetrable to large armies. Muslims established their headquarters at the hillock of Sala' a position which would give them an advantage in case the enemy crossed the trench. The final army that would defend the city from the invasion consisted of 3,000 men, and included all inhabitants of Madina over the age of 15, except the Banu Quraysh who had supplied the Muslims with some instruments for digging the trench.

When the attacking army reached Madina, they found the 15 inch ditch obstructing. They made several attempts to cross but they could not and thus they decided to lay a siege for about 27 days. At last continuous failure and increasing difficulties like lack of food, created distrust among the allies. On the 27th day of the siege, a terrible cyclone with heavy rains created havoc in the enemy. They decided to raise the siege and return to their homes.

Results of this battle

1. Muslims became victorious over the Quraish in this battle.
2. Islam established itself as the absolute master of Madina.
3. Muslims were able to take full control of Madina without interference from the Makkans
4. It gave more prestige to the prophet and the Muslims making the Arab tribes to have an admiration of Islam.
5. Swafiyyah, the daughter of the Jewish chief (a tribe which had bitterly opposed the Muslims) was married by the prophet (P.B.U.H) after this battle thus decreasing the differences between the Jews and the Muslims.



6. The power of Munafiqun was finally broken and the Arabs all over the provinces started admiring the Muslims.

The Treaty of Hudaibiyah (6th Dhul Qad 6 A.H/628 C.E)

The next year after the battle of Khandaq, the prophet together with 1400 Muslims left Madina for Makka to perform Umra (lesser pilgrimage). Muslims were instructed by the prophet not to carry any weapons except swords since it was purely a religious journey. Due to the strenuous relationship with the Makkan Quraish, they could not enter Makka directly. Therefore, they camped at the valley of Hudaibiyah, a few miles away from Makka and sent word to Makka that they had come for Umra and not to wage war. The first messenger Kharash bin Umayya was arrested immediately but later released; his camel's legs were chopped off. Uthman was sent as a second emissary but he was locked up in a room full of smoke for three days. Due to this, a battle almost started between the two but was suspended when Uthman was released unharmed. At night, the Makkans used to sneak into the Muslims army to spy but they learnt that the Muslims were carrying out their activities very peacefully. This finally convinced the Quraish leaders that the Muslims had not come for war and they agreed to send representatives led by Suhail Ibn Amir to sign a truce with the Muslims in which the following terms were agreed:-

- There should be no hostilities between the Muslims and Makkans for ten years.
- The prophet and the Muslims was to return to Madina that year without performing pilgrimage
- Makkan Muslims who left their people without permission were to be returned to Makka and never be allowed to stay in Madina while Muslims who escaped from Madina to Makka would be welcomed and never returned to the Muslims.
- No arms apart from swords would be carried by the Muslims when they go to Makka the following year
- Any Arab tribe was free to befriend itself with the Muslims or pagan Quarish.
- None of the terms would be changed for the next ten years.

Most of the terms of the truce were friendly to the Quarish and there was a general dissatisfaction among the Muslims until when Allah (S.W.T) revealed the following verse about the treaty,

“Lo, we have given you (Mohammad) a signal victory that Allah (S.W.T) may forgive you of the sin that which is past and that which is to come, and may perfect his favors unto you and may guide you on a right path, And that Allah (S.W.T) may help you with strong help” [Q:48:1-3]



This verse proved to be true by the events which followed the treaty of Hudaibiyah i.e.

1. Muslims got a break of rest from the Makkan attacks.
2. Muslims were able to mix freely with any tribe they wanted.
3. There were many Makkans who got a closer view of Islam through the interaction and were able to embrace Islam e.g. Khalid bin Walid, Suhail bin Amir, Amr bin al'As.
4. It showed that the prophet was a great leader.
5. The Prophet was able to send teachers to other parts of Arabia.
6. The prophet had enough time to concentrate on his divine mission because there was peace and tranquility.
7. It assured safe access of the Muslims to Makka their holy city the following year.
8. It made the Makkan Quarish recognize Islam as an equal power with them as they withdrew from the war arena.

Lessons from the treaty of Hudaibiyah

1. Allah (S.W.T) is always on the side of those who are sincere.
2. Muslims should always have faith in Allah (S.W.T).
3. Victory always comes from Allah (S.W.T) especially to those who are pious and determined.
4. Muslims should always aspire to spread peace despite intimidation
5. Muslims should be patient at all times and in all situations.
6. Muslims can't enter into agreement with non-Muslims for sake of peace
7. The prophet was a recognized, wise and an able leader
8. Forgiveness should be fostered in the hearts of Muslims

The Prophet's Invitation of Foreign Rulers to Islam

With peace having been established in Arabia after signing the treaty of Hudaibiyya, the prophet decided to concentrate more on his divine mission. He started by sending envoys to the following areas:

a) Abyssinia.

The prophet sent Amr bin Umayyah Ad-Damri to the Negus of Abyssinia by the name Ashamah. This delegation was warmly received and treated well. Some sources say that the king embraced Islam secretly since Abyssinia was a Christian country. He replied, "In the name of Allah the Most Gracious the Most Merciful. O prophet of Allah! And mercy and blessings from Allah beside whom there is no god. I have received your letter in which you have mentioned about Jesus



and by the Lord of the heaven and the, Jesus is not more than what you say. We fully acknowledge that which you have been sent to us and we have entertained your cousin and his companions. I bear witness that you are the messenger of Allah true and confirming (those who have come before you). I pledge to you through your cousin and surrender myself through him to the Lord of the worlds.” When this Negus later died in Rajab 9 A.H the prophet announced his death and observed the funeral prayer in absentia for him. He was succeeded by another King to whom the prophet sent a letter but however it is not confirmed as to whether he accepted Islam or not.

b) Persia

Abdallah Ibn Hudhaifa was sent with a letter to Perevez the emperor of Persia inviting him to Islam..The king was arrogant and proud and after reading it he got infuriated and mistreated the envoy. He thought that the language in the letter was too harsh for an emperor and also the prophet’s name should not have appeared above his, he therefore tore the letter into pieces. He then sent his men to arrest the prophet and bring him to his palace. When the envoy reported back to the prophet, he prayed for the Persian Empire to disintegrate. No sooner had the Persia emperor’s envoy reached Madina than the Prophet (P.B.U.H) received divine inspiration that Perevez had died. His successor was unable to maintain the unity in the empire leading to its complete disintegration.

c) Roman Empire.

Dhiya bin Khalifa al-Kalbi was sent to king Heraclius of Byzantine. He welcomed him well, read the letter but did not embrace Islam, however he sent them with many presents to take to the prophet. The tribe of Judham intercepted the convoy at a place called Husma and robbed them. When the prophet heard of this, he dispersed an army and inflicted heavy losses on those people. One the prophet ordered that all the captives and spoils of war be returned.

d) Egypt.

Hatib bin Abi Baltaah was sent to the king of Egypt (Muqawqis) called Juraij bin Matta. He read the letter and accepted the message though he was disappointed that the prophet did not come from Syria as it was expected. However he sent presents two maids from noble Coptic families, Maria, and Syrin; clothing, and steed for riding on but he did not accept Islam. The prophet married Maria who bore him Ibrahim while Syrin was married to Hassan bin Thabit al Ansaari.

Find out more other leaders to whom the prophet sent emissaries.



The fall of Khaybar (7 A.H)

Khaybar was a strong fold of the two Jewish tribes of Banu Nadhir and Banu Qainuqa. It is about 200 miles from Madina. These Jews with the help of neighbouring Arab tribes were planning to attack Madina. They had joined forces with the Bedouins of Ghatafah. The prophet learned of their plot and gathered 1,400 men including 200 horse men. When the Muslims reached Khaibar and saw their opponents, the prophet prayed, "O Allah, we wish prosperity and we seek your refuge from evils there from".

The Muslims stopped at a place 150 miles in the valley of at Raji to prevent the men of Khaibar from reinforcing the Jews. There were eight fortresses at Khaibar all garrisoned with armed men. They included; the fortresses of Na'im, Ubai, An-Nizar, AZ-Zubair, As-Sa'b bin Mu'ath, Al Watih, As-Sulalim and Al- Qamus. A fierce fight took place around these fortresses and in a few days the Muslims had captured all of them. This was after a siege of 20 days. The booty was shared among the victorious Muslims. The Jews were however allowed to retain their lands on condition that they would pay half of the produce to the Islamic state. The prophet then married Swafiyyah a daughter of a leading Jewish chief in order to strengthen the friendship with the Jews.

The conquest of Makka. (20th Ramadhan 5.A.H)

When Islam was well established in the hearts of the Muslims, Allah decided that the time had come for His Messenger and his community to enter Makkah. They would purify the Ka'bah so that it would be a blessed place of guidance for the whole world. They would restore Makkah to its previous status and the sacred city would offer security for all people once again.

The terms of the treaty of Hudaibiyah had given freedom of association to both Muslims and the Quraish. The Muslims befriended the Banu Khuza'ah while the Quraish allied with the Banu Bakr. These two tribes had been enemy since the Pre Islamic time but now they were to respect the terms of the treaty of Hudaibiyah and stop attacking each other.

For some years, the Quraish respected the treaty of Hudaibiyah until when the Banu Bakr attacked the tribe of Banu Khuza'ah which was allied to the Muslims at a place called Al-Wateer. The Quraish supported the tribe of Banu Bakr with men and arms. They attacked the Banu Khuza'ah at night who had to take refuge in the Holy sanctuary. This event led to the aggrieved Banu Khuza'ah to seek for justice from the Muslims. As a result the prophet laid down three conditions for the Quraish:



1. To pay blood money for the victims of Banu Khuza'ah.
2. To end their friendship with Banu Bakr.
3. To consider the truce of Hudaibiyah to have been nullified.

Out of the three conditions, the Quraish accepted the cancellation of the treaty.

The prophet then gathered 10,000 armed men and headed for Makkah. As they were advancing towards Makka, more and more tribes joined them on the way. At Juufa, Al Abnas bin Abdul Mutwalib came to join them. The army marched and camped at Marr a Zahran. When Makkans heard of the news, they sent Abusufian to spy on the Muslim's camp. He was however detected by Abbas the uncle of the prophet and Muslim guards presented him to the prophet. The prophet did not punish him but made him stand on a high ground to see the spectacle of the Muslim army marching towards Makkah.

The prophet divided his forces into different groups with each having its leader. Abu ubaida bin jarrah led the Muhajirun accompanied by the prophet himself. Zubeir Bin Awwam was on the left moving in a parallel column. The western entrance of the city was controlled by Saad Bin Ubaid while Khalid Bin Walid with the Bedouin contingent was to circle the whole city on the west and enter it from the south.

The uncle of the prophet Abass, who had embraced Islam, was escorting Abusufyan. He advised him to embrace Islam which he did. Abusufyan had wanted negotiations but the Muslim army refused and entered Makkah. The prophet instructed them not to shed any blood. In order to realize this goal, and conquer Makka peacefully, he made the following announcement; "Those who shelter in the kaaba are safe, those who shelter in Abu Sufyans house are safe and those who stay in their own houses are safe."

Despite the peaceful entry of Muslims into Makka, a group of Makkans rushed and attacked the Muslim group under Khalid bin Walid. As a result two Muslims and twelve non believers were killed.

The prophet then entered the Kaaba and cast down all idols while reciting the following verse of the Quran,

"The truth has come and false hood gone, verily falsehood is ever vanishing."

[Q: 17:81]



A green flag was hoisted on the Kaaba and Bilal bin Rabah then made the Adhan and the prophet led a thanks giving prayer (SwalatulShukr). The prophet then addressed a huge gathering and said, “There is no god except Allah .No one can be associated with him. He has fulfilled his promise. He has helped his servant and has shattered all bands alone. All the prides, all the prices of the family are under my heal. All the men are descendants of Adam and Adam was made of clay”.

The Makkan leaders who had been oppressing the Muslims were among the crowd and the prophet asked them, “ao you know how I am going to treat you?” They replied, “eou are a noble brother and noble nephew we expect nothing but good from you.” The prophet said, “There is no revenging against you today and you are all free.” The prophet then climbed on the hill of swafa and gave a sermon to all the Makkans to swear loyalty to Islam. Men and women came to accept Islam. Hind, the wife of Abu Jahal was among the women. The prophet forgave her. He also forgave Ikrimah Bin Abu Jahal who also accepted Islam. The prophet remained in Makkah for 15 days. After the conquest of Makka the prophet organized his troupes to go and attack the Roman Empire at Tabuk and the Banu Khawazin and Banu Thaqif.

Significance of the conquest of Makkah

1. It showed the purity of the Kaaba as the house of Allah and a place for monotheism.
2. Victory meant the supremacy of the Great Lord rather than ambition for power. This is why the prophet first thanked Allah and then purified the Kaaba.
3. By the Prophets act of forgiveness, he was laying emphasis on the noble Islamic principle of brotherhood and peace.
4. Many Makkans embraced Islam and even women pledged to worship non but Allah and to lead a clean life.
5. It singles out the hrophet’s unique character of patience and wisdom.

Question: compare and contrast the conquest of Makka and the unsuccessful attack by Abraha in the year of the elephant.

The Battle of Hunain

The conquest of Makka triggered mass conversion of Arabs to Islam in many parts of the Arabian Peninsula. Although a large number of Makkans and neighboring tribes embraced Islam, some only



accepted Mohammed as a ruler of Arabia but didn't believe in his prophet hood. Among the tribes that were opposing the Muslims included: Khawazin, Thaqif, Jusham, Saad Bin Bakr and Bani Hilal. The prophet was informed that the tribes of Khawazin and Thaqif were preparing to fight the Muslims. The prophet at once proceeded towards them with an army of 12,000 men including recently converted Muslims and about 2000 non Muslim of Makka who had accompanied them as allies. The enemies were 4000. The Muslims were over confident because this was the biggest army they had ever raised.

The battle took place in the field of Hunaian on Saturday 19th of Shawwal about nineteen days after the conquest of Makka. The enemy marched at night towards the Muslim army under their leader Malik bin Auf and strategically hid in the valley. The next day in the morning, the prophet was organizing his forces for the battle not knowing that the enemies' troupes were hiding in the nearby valley. The enemy then longed a surprised attack which disorganized the Muslim who scattered in all directions looking for safety passing the prophet unaware. Abass ibn Abdul Mutwilib shouted loudly unto the Muslims.

"O Ansaar, O Muhajirun O men who pledge their allegiance under the tree, where are you going? The messenger of Allah is here. Come back to him." The Muslims were gripped with shame over their cowardly conduct since they had always pledged to die with the prophet. They came back shouting "At your command!" They launched a counter attack. Soon the enemy realized they would face complete defeat and they started fleeing leaving behind their children, women and property.

Even though the Muslims were victorious, they paid dearly a number of Muslims were wounded and twelve killed. The victory however brought supremacy to the Muslims. The enemy ran and took refuge at the city of Thaqif the capital of the tribe. The Muslims decided to lay a siege on the city. When the help of Aws, the Muslims bombarded Taif, their Orchard were destroyed until the enemy sent an appeal to the prophet to stop the destruction upon which he temporarily withdrew the Muslim army.

The Muslims then went to share the booty of the Khawazin. Some of the enemies surrendered and embraced Islam. Those converts requested for the release of their women and children a request which was granted by the prophet. This gesture of mercy pleased them so much that more and more embraced Islam.



The prophet then sent the Khawazin to go and tell Malik bin Auf that if he converted to Islam, his family would be given back to him and an additional gift of 100 camels. He happily converted and the prophet fulfilled his promise to him.

The following verses were revealed following the events of Hunain, 9:25-28 “Assuredly Allah did help you in many battle fields and on the day of Hunain: Behold! Your great numbers elated you, but they availed you not; the land, for all that is wide, did constrain and you turned back in retreat. But Allah did pour His calm on the Messenger and on the believers, and sent down forces which you saw not: He punished the unbelievers, thus does he reward those without faith”

The Muslims learnt that victory is in the hands of Allah and that number is not significant to victory. They also had to be faithful to their leaders and show trust in Allah.

In this battle, 6000 men were taken as captives. It so happened that Bani sa'ad was among the prisoners. This was the tribe which had suckled the prophet, a woman who claimed to be Shima and had been a foster sister to the prophet 60 year ago reminded the prophet of the scar (white mark) he had caused her when she was carrying him on the back. This memory touched the prophet and he freed all the prisoners from BanuThaqif and Banu Sa'ad. Later on he released all the other prisoners the prophet then went back to Madina.

The farewell address

At the age of 63 years, the prophet (P.B.U.H) went to perform pilgrimage in 10 A.H. This is called Hijatul Widaa (The farewell pilgrimage) More than one hundred thousand Muslims came for Hajj on the 9th of ahul Hijja at the valley of Arafat. This was to be the prophet's last pilgrimage. It was during this Hajj that Sura al Nasr was revealed which was received as an announcement of the prophets approaching death. After the pilgrimage, the prophet then made his farewell address in which he said:

“O people, listen to me for I do not know whether you will find me amongst you next year. O people, verily, your blood, your property and your honor are sacred and inviolable until you appear before your Lord, as this day and this month is sacred for all verily you will meet your Lord and your will answerable to your action.

Have I not conveyed my message? Allah is my witness. He who has any trust on him should restore it to the person who deposited it with him. Beware; no one committing a crime is responsible for it



but himself. Neither the son is responsible of the crime of the father nor is the father responsible for the crime of the son. O people! Listen to my words and understand them. You must know that a Muslim is a brother of the Muslim and they form one brotherhood. Nothing of his brother is lawful for a Muslim except what he himself allows willfully. So you should not oppress one another.

Behold all practices of paganism and ignorance is under my feet. The blood revenges of the days of ignorance are remitted. Usury is forbidden but you will be entitled to recover your principal. Do not wrong and you shall not be wronged. Be kind to your women folk verily they have got certain rights over you.

Verily I have left among you the book of Allah (S.W.T) and the Sunna of his apostle which if you hold fast you shall never go astray. And feed your slaves; and cloth them with the clothes that you yourselves wear.

Behold, worship your lord; offer prayers five times a day, observe fast in the month of Ramadhan, make pilgrimage to the house, pay readily the Zakat on your property and obey whatever I command you only then will you get into the heaven.”

What lessons do you learn from this farewell address?

Demise of the prophet.(12th Rabiul-Awwal 11 A.H/632 C.E)

After the farewell address, the prophet returned to Madina at the end of the month of Dhul Hijja. On Monday 12th Saffar the prophet felt a severe headache and his health started deteriorating. During this period of illness, he spent most of his time in the house of Lady Aisha. Occasionally, he would go out to meet the Muslims, advice them and ask for the congregations forgiveness. When his condition grew worse and he could not lead the Muslims in prayer, he requested Abubakar to take charge of the religious duties. On the last day of his life, the prophet could be heard saying, “With those on whom you have bestowed your grace, with the prophet and the truthful ones, themartyrs and the good doers. O Allah, forgive me and have mercy upon me and join me to the most exalted companionship on high” He repeated the last words three times. During all this time, Aisha (RAA) was sprinkling water on his forehead until when finally the prophet passed on at the age of 63. His body was washed and then a grave dug at the very place he had died and the prophet was burried.



ACHIEVEMENT OF THE PROPHET

a) Brotherhood and equality of mankind

Islam is the religion of the Unity of God and the Equality of Mankind. Lineage, riches and family pride are accidental things; virtue and the service of humanity are the real matters of merit. Distinctions of colour, race and creed are non-existent within the bounds of Islam. All humans comprise one family. Islam has succeeded in welding the 'black' and the 'white' into one fraternal whole. The strict rule of brotherhood is set firm with the following saying of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H): "*No one of you is a believer in God until he loves for his brother what he loves for himself.*"

b) Elimination of racism

Racism is one of the severe diseases eating up the human society in this day and age. Everyone remembers how black Africans were transported across the oceans, packed in specially designed ships, thought of, and treated like livestock. They were made slaves, forced to change their names, religion and language. They were not entitled to hope for true freedom, and were denied the least of human rights: basic needs. Even though among some Western people, the attitude to non-Westerners has fortunately changed little in modern times, the political and social condition of black people often remain the same, even where they live amid the native Westerners as theoretically equal fellow-citizens; that of despised inferiors.

When Allah's Messenger, (h.B.U.H) was raised as a prophet, the same kind of racism, under the name of tribalism, was prevalent in Makkah. The Quraish considered themselves as peculiar, and Arabs in general, thought they were superior to all the other races of the world. Allah's Messenger came with the Divine Message and proclaimed that no Arab is superior over a non-Arab, and no white is superior over black and superiority in the eyes of Allah (S.W.T) is by righteousness and fearing Him alone (Surat Al-Hujurat, 49:13). He also declared that even if an Abyssinian Black Muslim were to rule over Muslims, he should be obeyed.



Allah's Messenger eradicated the problem of racial discrimination so successfully that superiority is not by birth or colour or blood, but by God-fearing and righteousness.

The message of Islam is for the entire human race. According to Islam, Allah (S.W.T) is the God of the entire world and Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) is a messenger for the whole of mankind. Islam unites the entire human race under one banner without any kind of discrimination.

Allah (S.W.T) says ***"O Mankind! We have created you from a male and female, and made you into nations and tribes, that you may know one another. Verily, the most honorable of you in the sight of Allah is he who has most Taqwa among of you. Verily, Allah is All-Knowing, All-Aware."***[Q: 49:13]

Allah (S.W.T) says, ***"And one of His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth and the diversity of your tongues and colors; most surely there are signs in this for the learned."***[Q: 30:22]

With this verse, Islam declares equality among people as one human race, one humanity, that is because Islam respects a person as a creation of Allah(S.W.T) and not for any other reason; Islam does not distinguish between two races, or two groups of people, or between two colors, and the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) addressed the people signifying that concept during the farewell pilgrimage, saying: "O People! Your God is one; your father is one; no preference of an Arab over non-Arab nor of a non-Arab over an Arab or red over black nor black over red except for the most righteous. Verily the most honored of you is the most righteous."

c) Eradication of slavery

Apart from giving the slaves their rights, Islam also took a step ahead and discouraged slavery from being practiced. It is seen in history that slaves were mistreated in the non-Islamic world. Not only were they verbally abused, but also physically hurt. During the period of his prophet hood, Muhammad worked diligently to do what he could to cut down on their numbers. Islam closed most of the doors leading to slavery and encouraged the freeing of slaves in many ways. He constantly exhorted those who owned slaves to treat them kindly and well. He insisted that they must treat the slaves fairly and with mercy. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) says:



If the owner of a slave beat his slave or abused him, the only compensation that he could make was to set the slave free. (Sahih Muslim)

The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) always encouraged and devised ways of freeing slaves on every pretext. He said:

“If a person owning a slave sets him free, God will, in recompense save every part of his body. Corresponding to every part of the slave’s body from the torment of Hell.” (Sahih Muslim)

Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) with Divine Inspiration from Allah (S.W.T) forbade such acts. Masters could not abuse their slaves and had to give them the same food as they ate and dress them in the clothes they wore.

Narrated by Al-Ma'rur, “I met Abu ahar who was wearing a cloak, and his slave, too, was wearing a similar one. I asked about the reason for it. He replied, "I abused a person by calling his mother with bad names." The Prophet said to me, 'O Abu Dhar! Did you abuse him by calling his mother with bad names you still have some characteristics of ignorance. Your slaves are your brothers and Allah has put them under your command. So whoever has a brother under his command should feed him of what he eats and dress him of what he wears. Do not ask them (slaves) to do things beyond their capacity (power) and if you do so, then help them.' “[Bukhari, Vol.1, Book 2, #29]

In another Hadith, The Prophet said, "Your servants and your slaves are your brothers. Anyone who has slaves should give them from what he eats and wears. He should not charge them with work beyond their capabilities. If you must set them to hard work, in any case, I advise you to help them" (Al-Bukhari).

d) Improvement of status of women

The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was very serious in improving the condition of women in society and on securing for them a position of dignity and fair and equitable treatment.

Just before his death, one of the injunctions he addressed to Muslims and laid stress upon was that they should always treat women with kindness and consideration. Holy Prophet (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) said: “If a man has daughters and he makes arrangement to have them educated and takes pains with their upbringing, aod would save him from the torment of Hell.” (Tirmidhi)



Before Islam, women were sold as personal commodities. Female children were buried alive because they were considered as curse for family. It is Islam that gave every respect and honor to women, and brought them at the level of men; otherwise women were mistreated in every sphere of life. Islam always provides equal rights and equal opportunities for men and women, as the Holy Quran says:

Surely, men who submit themselves to God and women who submit themselves to Him, and believing men and believing women, and obedient men and obedient women, and truthful men and truthful women, and men steadfast in their faith and steadfast women, and men who are humble and women who are humble, and men who give alms and women who give alms, and men who fast and women who fast, and men who guard their chastity and women who guard their chastity and men who remember Allah much and women who remember Him—Allah has prepared for all of them forgiveness and a great reward. (Holy Quran, 33:36)

Islam also permits equal opportunities to women to seek knowledge with men. It is entirely a wrong notion; such concept is never presented by Islam. The Holy Prophet (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) says in this regard, “It is the duty of every Muslim man and Muslim woman to seek knowledge”.

The Holy Quran says:

He it is who created you from a single soul and made there from its mate, that he might find comfort in her. And when he knows her, she bears a light burden and goes about with it. And when she grows heavy, they both pray to Allah, their Lord, saying, ***‘If thou gives us a good child, we will surely be of the thankful.’*** [Q: 7:190]

In connection with the respect, honor and status of woman as a mother, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) has a great regard. *Once, a Companion consulted him to seek advice to participate in a war, when he asked, “Do you have a mother?” He said, “Yes.” Then Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, “Be with her, because paradise is under her feet.”* (Nasa’i)

“Paradise lies under the feet of your mothers.” This indicates the outstanding status of woman in Islam far superior than granted by any other religion of the world. No other religion comes close to the prominence given to women by the Holy Prophet of Islam.

Once a companion of the Holy Prophet of Islam asked, “O Apostle of Allah! To whom should I show kindness?” He replied, “Your mother, next your mother, next your mother, and then comes your father, and then your relatives in order of relationship.” (Abu Aawud)



e) Religious Tolerance

Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was a role model for religious freedom, for instance when the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) entered the city of Medina, he made a formal constitution with the large Jewish population of the city, and indeed, this was a historic moment and in this constitution it guaranteed religious freedom for those who were and weren't Muslims. Once the people of Mecca said to Prophet Muhammad that if god did not want them to worship idols then why He does not forcefully prevent them from doing so. Then God sent the following message:

“(O Muhammad) This is not a new excuse; those who left before them made, the same excuses. Is there anything upon the messengers except the duty conveying of the message” [Q: 16: 3]

The Qur'an clearly says that religion cannot be forced on anyone. It says,

"There is no compulsion in (accepting) the religion (of Islam)..."

Why? Because: ***"truly the right way has become clearly distinct from error." [Q: 2:25]***



Suggested study questions and activities.

Answer the following questions in your I.R.E revision exercise book.

1. a) Narrate the early life of the prophet.
b) Identify the methods of persecutions experienced by the early Muslims.
2. a) Give reasons why Muslims migrated to Abbysinia.
b) Outline the lessons Muslims learn from the battle of Uhud.
3. a) How did the treaty of Hudaibiyya prove a success for the Muslims?
b) Write down ten teachings we learn from the prophet's farewell pilgrimage.
4. a) Explain the lessons the Muslims learnt in the battle of uhud.
b) Discuss the challenges faced by the Muslims when they first arrived in madina.

Activities.

1. Compare the practices of todays Muslims with that of the Arabs during the Jahiliya. Are there any similarities?
2. Dramatize how the battle of Badr was fought.
3. Compare and contrast the conquest of Makka with the unsuccessful attack by Abraha Ashram during the year of the elephant

CHAPTER 8

MUSLIM SCHOLARS

In every society we have prominent people whose prominence may be due to their leadership positions or their general role towards the improvement of the society. Most of these personalities are our heroes and we get motivated by them and have them as our role models. Do you know of any such people in our contry? How have you been inspired by them? In the history of Islam, several challenges have been met by the champions of Islam. In every century, we had leaders who spereheaded the reforms and struggle for spread of Islam. We are therefore going to study some of these schorlars in our secondary syllabus. In each form, two scholars will be studied starting with Sheikh al Amin Ali bin Mazrui and Abdallah Swaleh al Farsi.Let us now look at the Sheik al Amin Ali bin Mazrui.

Sheikh Al Amin Mazrui (1891AD-1974 AD)



His birth and early life.

His full name was Sheik Al-Amin bin Ali Abdallah al Mazrui from the Mazrui family. This was the family which had been given the guardianship of Mombasa town after the expulsion of the Portuguese by the Sultan of Oman since they originated from Oman. His grand father, Abdallah al-Mazrui was an Islamic scholar belonging to the Shafi School of law. He was born in Mombasa 1891 on 15th Jamadu-Thani 1380 A.H/27th January 189. His father passed away when he was four years old and thus his paternal Uncle Sheikh Suleiman bin Ali-Mazrui took the responsibility of raising him who later married him off to his own daughter. He died on 1st April 1947 having left behind three children, among them two sons (Harith Al-Amin Al-Mazrui-former Liwali of Lamu and Professor Ali Mazrui-Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology) and a daughter.

His Educational background.

He started his elementary education under his Uncle Sheikh Suleiman bin Ali who was a great scholar of that time and had studied various branches of knowledge. This branches included; Quran, Arabic language, Fiqh among others. His great thirst for knowledge made him travel to Zanzibar to further his education under the eminent scholars of Zanzibar like Sheikh Abdallah Mohammad bin Salim Bakathir and Sayyid Ahmed Bin Abu Bakar bin Sumeyt. He later went to Lamu and graduated from Riyadh mosque under the supervision of re-known scholars of that time. He was a brilliant student and outstanding in all the subjects and he used to emerge top of the class. He was able to bring reforms in some of the Islamic scholarly works across the world.

Among the Muslim scholars who greatly influenced him are the following:

1. Sheikh Jamaluddin Al-Afghani
2. Sheikh Muhammad Abdul
3. Sayyid Mohammad Rashid – Ridha

His works

1. He wrote Hidaayatul Atfaal (Guidance of children) which is an introductory book to Islam for the children.
2. He book entitled 'Masomo ya dini' (religious studies) is essential for the Swahili speakers.
3. Majmaul Bahrayn (The meeting of two seas) is another essential publication in the study of Islamic religion.



4. He wrote a weekly paper known as Al-Islah which constituted both Islamic teachings and political issues in Kiswahili and Arabic using the Arabic script. The message in this paper was aimed at positively changing the societal way of thinking.
5. He translated part of the Quran into Kiswahili, that is Sura al Fatiha, Al Baqara and a few verse of Al-Imran.

Achievements and Contributions of Al Amin Ali bin Mazrui.

- He authored many publications. Typical among them being,
- He was the first to write books in Kiswahili to cater for the learning needs of his immediate community.
- He established Madrassatul Ghazali-l Islamiyya, a learning institution in which he taught Islamic studies to students from all over East Africa.
- He donated most of his scholarly works to the libraries at the coast.
- Became the Kadhi of Mombasa in 1932.
- He gave many Islamic lectures in the mosques other Islamic institutions.
- He became the Chief Kadhi of Kenya in 1937 after the death of his uncle Suleiman bin Ali al Mazrui.
- He is known for his efforts in propagating Islam all over East Africa. He used move all around East Africa giving lectures.
- He was a writer, poet and editor of Kiswahili and Arabic languages.

Sheikh Abdullah Swaleh al-Farsy

Birth and early life

He was born on 12th of February, 1912 at Jongeani village in the Island of Zanzibar. He came from a large and well established family; respected for the services they used to provide in both educational and civil life to the citizens of Zanzibar and Pemba. He was the eldest child in this family. He studied Quran recitation from Fatma Hamid Said who was a student of a renowned scholar, Sheikh Amin Ahmed.

At a very young age, Sheikh Abdullah memorized the Quran with its correct recitation and a large portion of Hadith. He did not engage in leisurely activities as the other young people. At the age of twenty years he was so fluent and competent in Arabic Grammar and Nahwi that he could write poems in Arabic.



Educational back ground

After completing the first phase of Islamic traditional education at Masjid Barza, Sheikh al-Farsy joined the first government school in Zanzibar at the age of ten; the Central Primary School of Zanzibar. He was so dedicated to attaining religious and secular education and he made use of both the afternoons and evenings to study. He was always seen engrossed in any new Islamic book and spent most times in his home library reading.

Zanzibar had retained some of the centuries old Islamic educational institutions. He therefore learnt from intellectual scholars like Sheikh Abubakar bin Abdullah Bakathir, Sheikh Ahmed bin Muhammad Al- Mlomry who taught him twenty five books and Sheikh Sayyid Alawy bin Abdul Wahab who taught him twelve books on Fiqh and Arabic. He then went to Kenya to seek more knowledge where he studied tafsir under Sheikh Al Amin bin Ali. He also studied Risalatul Jamiaat, a book on basic principles of Fiqh from Sayyid Hamid Maasab.

While he was in the secular school, he always emerged ahead of the other students in every subject. His excellence led him to completing eight year primary education in five years. He then joined a Teachers' Training college from which he graduated in 1932.

He became a primary school teacher between 1932 and 1947 and, following a series of promotions for his good work, he was appointed the Inspector General of primary schools in Zanzibar and Pemba between 1949 and 1952. He later became the principal of Muslim Academy between 1952 and 1956, before being appointed the head teacher of the Arabic Medium School. In 1960, he went to perform Hajj after which he left the ministry of education in 1967 and became a teacher at the Teacher's Training college.

In 1960, he was appointed the chief Kadhi of Zanzibar, a post he held for seven years. It was after the bloody CRUSADE incident in the name of Zanzibar Revolution in 1964 that he migrated to Kenya. He was hosted by Sheikh Muhammad Kassim Al-Mazrui his former class mate in the class of Al-Amin Ali Mazrui. Since his reputation as a scholar had reached far including Kenya, Sheikh Muhammad Kassim Al-Mazrui recommended him to the late Jomo Kenyatta for the post of Chief Kadhi of Kenya. He accepted the appointment and served for fourteen years until his retirement in 1980.



In addition to teaching and preaching, he was a prolific writer. He used *mwongozo wa Zanzibari* to translate the Qur'an and answer questions from the masses. He wrote the biography of the prophet and that of Imam Shaffi. He also wrote a Kiswahili translation of the Qur'an in order to counter the translation of Dr. David Living Stone and Fr. Godfrey Dale of the University Mission to Central Africa (U.M.C.A) church of Zanzibar who had written a very shallow translation that was used by the preachers to defend Christianity. This Quran translation was also to clarify the misconception of the Qadianis who preached of the coming of another Prophet after Muhammad by the name Mirza Gulam Ahmad from Qadiani village in India.

Sheikh Abdullah Swaleh al Farsy passed on (died) on 9th November, 1982, just eight months after he had left Kenya to join his family in Muscat, Oman.

His works

1. He translated the Qur'an in Kiswahili i.e. "Qurani Takatifu." Its first copy was published in 1969.
2. He wrote the biography of the prophet.
3. He also wrote the biography of Imam Shaffi.
4. His Kiswahili publication was *sura za swala na tafsiri zake*.
5. He also authored *upotofu wa tafsiri ya Makadiani*.
6. He used to write the translation of the Qur'an in the weekly *Mwongozo wa Zanzibar* Magazine.
7. He wrote a book entitled *Bid'a* in which he fought against innovations (Bid'a).
8. He wrote a book on mirath (inheritance).

His achievements and contributions

1. He served in the field of education as a head teacher in Muslim Academy, Secondary School and Arabic Medium School.
2. He was appointed the Inspector General of primary schools in Zanzibar and Pemba to spearhead the quality of education in these states.
3. He proposed that community schools be staffed with Islamic teachers who should be paid by the government.



4. He travelled to Nyasaland (Malawi) and Southern Rhodesia (Zimbabwe) to give lectures on Islamic Religious Education.
5. In his position as a Chief Kadhi of both Zanzibar and Kenya he lodged defence against all accusations directed to Islam and Muslims.
6. He called for the establishment of separate schools for the Muslims.
7. He wrote books strongly supporting provision of education and saw illiteracy as a menace to both the government and its citizen.
8. He urged the East African Muslims to adhere to the teachings of the Qur'an and the Sunnah of the Prophet. As a result a number of young men became interested in studying Islam.
9. He used the voice of Kenya radio to aireducative programs about Islam.
10. He wrote several religious books in both Arabic and Kiswahili that enlightened Muslims about their religion.
11. He travelled throughout East Africa giving public speeches and lectures about Islam which resulted in many embracing Islam.
12. He volunteered free services to the Radio of Zanzibar to propagate Islam.
13. He started campaigns against Bid'a (innovations) and refused Qadianism.
14. In Kenya, he was exposed to public debate where he criticized some of the traditional beliefs including shirk and traditional dances.
15. He became a catalyst to the young men by giving mosque seminars.

Suggested study questions and class activities

Answer the following questions in your I.R.E revision exercise books.

1. Describe the early life of Sheikh Abdallah Swaleh Al-Farsy.
2. Explain the contributions made by Abdallah Swaleh Al-Farsy to the spread of Islam in East Africa.
3. Discuss the contribution made by Sheikh Al-Amin Mazrui in promoting education in Kenya
4. Outline the literary works left behind by of Al-Amin Ali Mazrui.

Activities

1. Compare the achievements and contributions of Sheikh Al Amin bin Mazrui and Abdallah Swaleh al Farsy.
2. Find out from your immediate community some of the prominent Muslim scholars and identify the common factors that can be attributed to their success in the field of Academics.